

The Sixty-First Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous

*We Are Responsible for A.A.'s Future—
Let It Begin With Us*

2011
Final Report

Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York, NY May 1-7, 2011

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Confidential — full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

■ 61ST GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

The 61st General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada met May 1-7, 2011 at the Crowne Plaza Times Square, New York City; the theme was "We Are Responsible for A.A.'s Future—Let It Begin With Us."

The 134 Conference members consist of 93 delegates from the Conference areas of the U.S. and Canada; 20 trustees of the General Service Board; 6 A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Board directors; and 15 General Service and Grapevine staff members.

The Conference was official opened Sunday with the roll call by Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O. general manager, followed by Greetings from delegate chair Leon Arps, Nebraska, and the Keynote Address, given by Southwest regional trustee Conley Byrd.

Sunday evening the Opening Dinner was followed by an Open A.A. meeting, chaired by Spencer Richie, Maine, chair of the Conference Agenda Committee; the leader was Steven Hildeman, Northern Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan, alternate chair of the Agenda Committee. Speakers were: Jean-Claude Cormier, New Brunswick/PEI; Marsha Slane, New Mexico; Mary Cumings, G.S.O. staff; Donald Cusson, Eastern Canada regional trustee; and Bill Noonan, A.A.W.S. director.

This year's Conference was chaired by Ward Ewing (nonalcoholic), chairman of the General Service Board; Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O.'s general manager, and Leon Arps, delegate chair. Adrienne

Brown, G.S.O. staff member, was Conference coordinator.

Conference week is an exceedingly busy one, filled with long, activity-packed days, informative presentations, board reports, area service highlights, stimulating discussions and committee meetings, and laborious, conscience-searching decisions, some of which eventually result in Conference Advisory Actions.

Guest observers to this year's Conference were Oscar Calle Briolo (nonalcoholic) and Jesús César Pérez Sosa from the General Service Structure of Peru. Two guests from the General Service Structure of Great Britain were Sheila Davis and Martin Black.

Another Conference guest was the Grapevine's famous Victor E. A lifesize cutout of Victor "hung out" all week, beside the display of Grapevine literature, with a balloon over his head suggesting that A.A. members try the newly designed Grapevine Web site, aagrapevine.org. A creation of Grapevine editor Jack Morley in 1962, Victor E. has been a symbol of victory over alcoholism for over 49 years.

Tuesday afternoon Conference members and their guests took the subway uptown to visit the General Service and Grapevine offices. There, amidst streamers, balloons and desserts, they toured the offices, visiting various departments. As usual, one of the most popular spots was G.S.O.'s Archives, where there is currently a display on "Women in A.A." Another display case shows reports and photos from the first General Service Conference in 1951.

There were other activities during the week, as well. The Serenity A.A. Group met Monday through Friday at 7:30 am. The meeting was chaired by Dean Bahr, South Dakota; secretary/treasurer was Chazz Collette, Vermont. A Seventh Tradition basket was passed each morning, and at the end of Conference \$701.00 was contributed to the General Service Office.

New York Intergroup hosted a Hospitality Suite for early arrivals on Saturday, and during the week local A.A. members accompanied Conference members' spouses and guests sightseeing, shopping, to A.A. and Al-Anon meetings and various New York City events.

Wednesday afternoon at the trustees elections, Clayton Vandivort of Sikeston, Missouri, was elected Southwest regional trustee. J. Gary Lutz of Bethlehem, Pennsylvania, was elected Northeast regional trustee;



and Barbara Kelly, of Oakwood, Ontario, will become the new trustee-at-large/Canada. Nancy Haynes of St. Helena, California, will become the general service trustee on the Grapevine Board.

Alan Hennesy, Oklahoma, was elected Delegate Chair for the 62nd General Service Conference; Estelle Falardeau, Northeast Quebec, will be the alternate chair.

Late Friday afternoon rotating delegates (Panel 60s) lined up at the mikes for a two-minute farewell. After Ward Ewing's closing remarks the Conference was officially closed with the Serenity Prayer in three languages, lead by: English Deb Domack (H/M/B New York); French, Jules Roussy (SW Quebec); and Spanish, Ino Fernandez (Puerto Rico).

Conference members met once more at the Saturday morning closing brunch where the rotating trustees gave their goodbye talks: Conley Byrd, Southwest regional trustee; Dorothy Hurley, general service trustee; John Kane, Northeast regional trustee; and Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada. This bittersweet time was lightened when the Southeast regional delegates showed up all wearing bow ties—a tribute to their trustee, Conley Byrd.

Then the delegates returned home, to give their reports, visit the groups, and get the pulse of A.A. in their areas. The work of the Conference goes on 365 days a year, and next April the Conference will convene again to express A.A.'s collective group conscience and reinforce the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Greetings

My name is Leon Arps and I am an alcoholic. It is an honor to stand before you as the delegate chairperson for the 61st General Service Conference. I welcome the delegates, trustees, General Service Office and Grapevine staff, and also our visitors from the General Service Boards of Peru and Great Britain. It has been quite a trip to come from a place where I thought I did not have a problem, to someone that has the opportunity and responsibility to represent my area at the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

When I first started attending meetings of Alcoholics Anonymous I was not happy to be there. I mostly stayed off by myself and just tried to make it through the meeting. After some more meetings I started to hear the laughter before and after the meetings. I still was not sure that I belonged there. When I was able to hear the message, I was not sure I needed that message.

The members of those A.A. meetings allowed me to find my way. First I was invited to coffee after the meetings; then I was asked to help set up the meeting space, I was asked to read from our Big Book to start the meeting, and I finally found a sponsor. It still took me two years before I really believed that I was in the right place.

Prior to last year's Conference, past delegates from my area tried to tell me I was prepared for my first General Service Conference. As the Conference progressed I was not sure they were right. I found myself feeling unprepared, overwhelmed and inadequate. This subsided as we moved into the committee discussions. I finished the Conference feeling that I was privileged to have been involved in something important to Alcoholics Anonymous.

When my name was drawn from the hat for delegate chairperson, I stood in shock and disbelief. I thought I had maintained a low enough profile to go unnoticed. My Higher Power does have a sense of humor.

Last year's Conference at Rye had some long hours; however, we managed to get through fifteen Floor Actions, and we all survived.

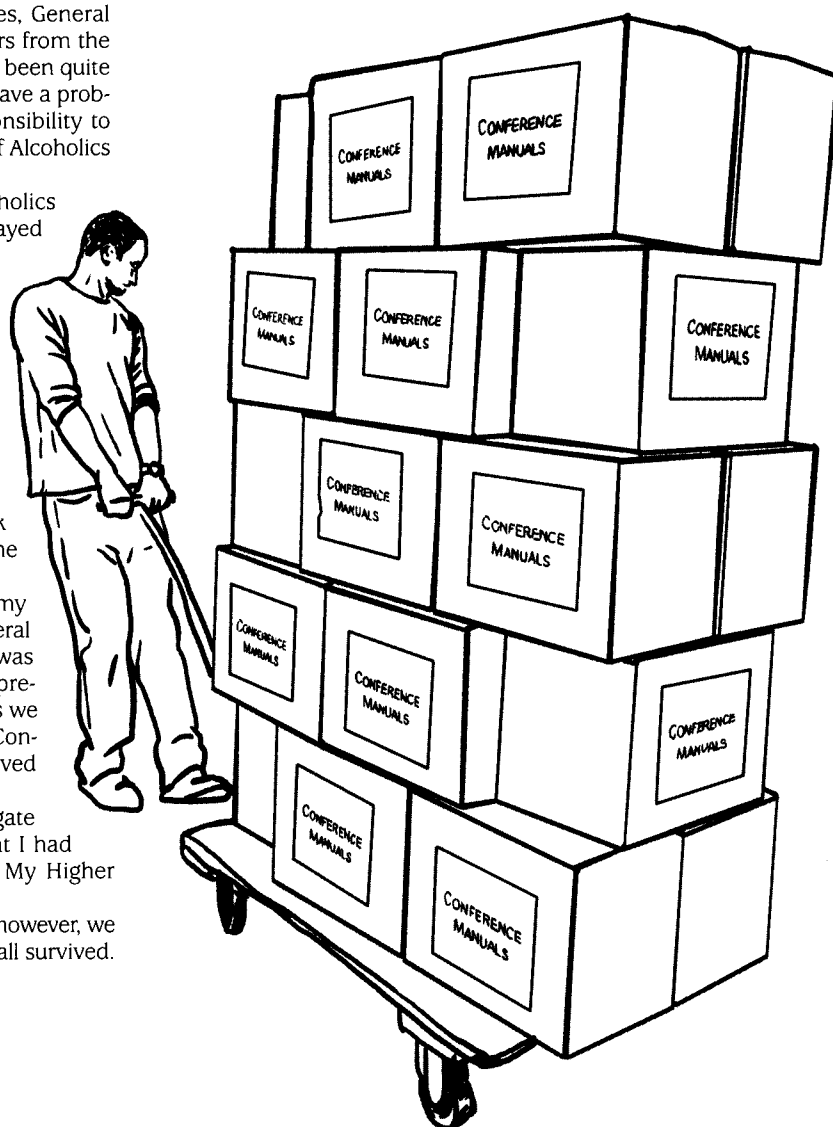
This year's theme, "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us," speaks to me on a personal level. Our program is facing dilemmas from within and without, including everything from the cure of the month on late night television, the promise of a new drug, the influx of new military veterans, younger and younger members looking for help, meetings on the Internet, social networking sites, literature from outside sources, and meetings that do not talk about A.A.'s Steps and Traditions.

We are challenged to be responsible, but it is too much for a few individuals to accomplish. We need all the help we can get, and with the tools of our literature and an involved Fellowship, I believe that we can accomplish even this task. I have learned that handing a newcomer a pamphlet and walking away serves little purpose; I need to explain and share my experience, strength, hope, and phone number before I let them leave.

I believe that everyone here today is doing everything they can to make Alcoholics Anonymous stronger and better. I also understand that we all can have a different idea of what defines "stronger" and "better." This week we will test our theories and we will come to some difficult decisions. We may not agree on all that happens, but we can still return to our areas and groups with the ability to help them be better informed.

I look forward to meeting more of you as this week passes and hope you will have the best Conference experience. I believe that the 61st General Service Conference will be remembered by those in attendance for many twenty-four hours ahead.

Leon Arps, Nebraska



Keynote Address

Greetings! I want to express my appreciation to Adrienne for the loving invitation to address you this morning as we start the 61st General Service Conference with its theme "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us." In considering this theme and reflecting on what is my last Conference I discovered I have more questions than answers.

So, why are we here? Is it because Bill carried the message to Dr. Bob? Or is it that Roland H., the American businessman, talked to Dr. Jung and subsequently carried the message through Cebra and Shep to Ebby? Or that Dr. Silkworth shared the grave nature of alcoholism with Bill after his brother-in-law, Leonard Strong, and his mother, Emily, paid for Bill to go to Towns Hospital? Maybe it was Sam Shoemaker's involvement with the Oxford Movement and Calvary Mission that housed Ebby in New York? Or was it Lois's and Anne's devotion? Not only were there a series of coincidences where God chose to remain anonymous that brought them together, but I would suggest that each one of us has had our own series of miracles that brought us here this week.

So, why are we here? Maybe it was the beginning of the Conference and the subsequent acceptance of our permanent Conference Charter in 1955 at St. Louis where our groups delegated to the Conference the effective conscience and empowered it to be the actual voice of A.A.? Could it be the sacrificial labor and dedication of a series of delegates, Class A and Class B trustees, non-trustee directors, and staff through the years that has passed on the authority, responsibility, and leadership to us this week?

In Concept I Bill wrote that he was confident that we can rely on Tradition Two, our group conscience and its trusted servants. "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority — a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 562) How do we ensure that God will show up? When might He express Himself in our group conscience? Is it when we make a decision after a discussion, or is it more likely to happen when there is an informed group conscience? Is it more likely to happen when we all actively participate with each other by having the opportunity to discuss, vote, and subsequently achieve substantial unanimity? Or is it when we listen patiently to the minority who has the courage to express their opinion when the substantial majority has voted against them?

When are we trusted servants? When and how do we express that trust, and to whom? Is it in our Conference process? When we use our committee system? Our vetting of agenda items before we arrive? Is it in the thoroughness in which we have reviewed the background material? Is it in our discussions on the floor of the Conference as we deliberate each item forwarded by the Conference Committees? Does this expression of trust include how we handle Floor Actions?

When and how do we serve? How do we serve those alcoholics and Conferences that have sacrificed before us? When do we serve the alcoholics at home at the top of our upside down triangle? What about those alcoholics who haven't made it here yet? What do we owe the future members of Alcoholics Anonymous? Do we actually owe them anything? Can we survive if they don't come? What will they find? Will what we did here make a difference in their lives? What about those who never have the opportunity to make it to A.A.? Will it be something we did or failed to do that prevents them from having the opportunity each of us has enjoyed?

What sorts of issues will we be dealing with this week? Some may be routine housekeeping issues, but someone has to do it. Others will have a broader policy reach, including topics like: Anonymity — should full face be allowed, and if so, when? Do we need a written Concept V Right of Appeal? Are we capable of tak-



ing an inventory of the Conference itself, and if so, when and how? Are our checks and balances in place? How inclusive should our spiritual literature be? Have we selected the full complement of leadership to ensure our future? Do we need a Special Needs pamphlet? How are we going to receive our literature in the future? Is the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña still an integral part of our World Services, and if so how can we best ensure its survival? How are we going to maintain self-support? Have we undertaken the activities we need to function today? Tomorrow? Next year? Over the next five to ten years, or more? At the end of the week will we have fulfilled our obligations to the members and groups by adhering to all of our Principles in all Three Legacies? Will we have observed the spirit of our Traditions as the guarantor of the Warranties in all our proceedings?

My sponsor taught me that we need to say our collective, as well as my individual, "Please" and "Thank you." He said when we repeat the Serenity Prayer at the beginning of our meetings we are inviting the *God of our understanding* into our deliberations. During the rest of the meeting we are to listen for His voice as each of our members share. At the end of our meetings, he suggested, when we close with a prayer of gratitude we give thanks for His having been here with us and for sharing the knowledge of His will for us, and more importantly asking for the Power to carry that out when we leave and return to the rest of the world. He suggested that it was my responsibility to do that not only at each meeting but also each morning and night, every day of my life. So as my sponsor assured me, I look forward to hearing God express Himself through each of us this week. My pledge to you at this, my last Conference, is that I will endeavor to let it begin with me. I hope you will now join with me in repeating our Responsibility Statement: "I am Responsible . . . When anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible."

Conley Byrd, Southwest regional trustee

■ Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2011 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

- 1 The 61st General Service Conference express its appreciation and gratitude for the French-language magazine "La Vigne," and the value it has for French-speaking members of Alcoholics Anonymous and the respect "La Vigne" has shown for the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 2 The theme for the 2012 General Service Conference be: "Anonymity: Our Spiritual Responsibility in the Digital Age."
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2012 General Service Conference:
 - a) Carrying the A.A. Message:
 - 1) Still Our Primary Purpose.
 - 2) Social Web Sites.
 - 3) Young People in A.A.
 - 4) Importance of Sponsorship.
 - b) Change — Essential to A.A.'s Growth:
 - 1) Service: Our Third Legacy.
 - 2) Spirit of Rotation.
 - 3) Diversity — Let's Keep Our Doors Open for any Who May Suffer from Alcoholism.
 - 4) Archives — Where the Past Meets the Present.
- 4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2012 General Service Conference: "Safety in A.A.: Our Common Welfare."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 5 The following changes to the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities":

That the text in the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" in the section on "Meetings," which reads,

"Since the Twelve Steps are the basis of our recovery in A.A., many groups hold Step meetings. The leader might share a

bit of his or her story and talk briefly about a particular Step and then throw the meeting open for discussion. Each type of meeting serves a different purpose; all are needed."

Be replaced with:

"Many groups also hold Step meetings, Tradition meetings or Big Book studies. Each type of meeting serves a different purpose; all are needed."

And that the heading and text of the section "Step meetings," which reads,

"Step meetings

"In addition to a leader sharing his or her experience with a Step, some groups might read from Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, followed by a discussion. Many groups find listening to cassette tapes on the Steps helpful. (Tapes are available from the General Service Office.)"

Be replaced with:

"Step meetings, Tradition meetings and Big Book studies

"Since the Twelve Steps are the basis of our recovery in A.A., many groups hold Step meetings. Some groups read passages from the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* or the Big Book, followed by a discussion.

"Groups may also read and discuss the Twelve Traditions, the best answers we have found to the questions "How can A.A. best function?" and "How can A.A. best stay whole and so survive?"

"Since the Big Book contains not only directions for how many of our members practice the Twelve Steps, but also a brief history of our Fellowship's beginnings and personal stories to help newcomers identify with other alcoholics, many A.A. groups devote meeting time to the study of this basic text.

"Audio recordings of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* are available from the General Service Office. The pamphlets "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" and "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" may also be helpful."

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 6 The following changes be made to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix:":
 - "AND" be replaced with "OR" between the pie charts that start on page 12 and an additional "OR" added after the second pie chart.
 - Insert an additional blank pie chart and distribution text as follows to the beginning of the pie chart examples:



District	_____ %
Area Committee	_____ %
G.S.O.	_____ %
Intergroup/Central Office	_____ %
Other A.A. Service Entities	_____ %
Other A.A. Service Entities	_____ %

- Other minor editorial changes.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

- 7 In the spirit of being self-supporting, while also protecting our Traditions of attraction, anonymity, and non-affiliation, A.A. Grapevine be permitted to utilize digital channels and current (commissionable) support and distribution technologies, such as, but not limited to, smart phones, tablets, e-readers, applications and commissioned online stores for the sale and distribution of magazines, books and products. The committee requests that the Board ensure that all contracts protect our Traditions, with the option to discontinue any and all contracts at any time. The committee requests that a status and financial report be submitted to the 2012 Grapevine Conference Committee.
- 8 The A.A. Grapevine Board, in consultation with the A.A. World Services Board and under the guidance of the General Service Board chairman, continue to investigate what efficiencies and objectives can be accomplished by combining services and sharing resources, including reviewing Concept XI, while still maintaining editorial and corporate independence.
- 9 The editorial revisions made by the A.A. Grapevine staff to "The A.A. Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print" pamphlet be approved with minor suggestions.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 10 The revised pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved.
- 11 The trustees' Literature Committee continue to develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee expressed support for the trustees' efforts to develop a pamphlet which reflects the wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members and asked that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration.
- 12 The following text under "When you're a G.S.R.," in the pamphlet "G.S.R. General Service Representative" which currently reads:
"You are linking your home group with the whole of A.A. Back in 1953, when the "group contact" was suggested as a new type of trusted servant, the job was seen simply as a good means of exchanging up-to-date information..."
Be replaced with:
"You are linking your home group with the whole of A.A. In 1950, a new type of trusted servant, "group representative," was suggested to help in the selection of delegates to the newly-formed General Service Conference. By 1953, the job of 'group representative' was also seen as a good means of exchanging up-to-date information...."

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 13 Oscar Calle Briolo and Jesús César Pérez Sosa from the General Service Structure of Peru be admitted to the 61st General Service Conference as observers.
- 14 Sheila Davis and Martin Black from the General Service Structure of Great Britain be admitted to the 61st General Service Conference as observers.
- 15 Mike Donnelly, alternate delegate, Area 50, Western New York, be seated as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference because John Czermerys, the Panel 60 delegate for Area 50 resigned.
- 16 Mel Catherine, alternate delegate, Area 83, Eastern Ontario International, be seated as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference because Robb Watson, the Panel 61 delegate for Area 83 is unable to attend.
- 17 The General Service Conference conduct a thorough inventory of itself in accordance with the Comprehensive Plan formulated by the Conference Inventory Planning Committee. (See page 11)
- 18 The 64th General Service Conference be held April 27-May 3, 2014 since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays or hotel availability.
- 19 The Conference Committee on Archives meet separately at the General Service Conference following a joint meeting with the trustees' Committee on Archives.
- 20 The following procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference be established:
 - 1) The minority, expressing a feeling or opinion in light of the right of appeal to the General Service Conference, has been very rare. It is hoped that an individual entitled under Concept V to appeal would exhaust every avenue offered within the General Service Conference structure prior to making an appeal to the General Service Conference.
 - 2) Those entitled to appeal to the General Service Conference are members who, on the inverted triangle of the A.A. service structure, fall *below* the General Service Conference level — members of staffs, committees, corporate boards or trustees, as referenced in the first paragraph of Concept V of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.
 - 3) The minority should announce, in writing, to the chair of the General Service Board, the General Service Conference delegate chair and to the General Service Office Conference coordinator that it intends to appeal under Concept V to the General Service Conference.
 - 4) All Conference members will be given notice through the General Service Office of the minority's decision to file an appeal.
 - 5) Appeals under Concept V, including any minority report and background, must be received in writing 30 days prior to the General Service Conference in order for these materials to be distributed to Conference members. The G.S.O. Conference coordinator will be responsible for seeing that this material is made available to all Conference members within 10 business days after its receipt.
 - 6) The minority's appeal will be presented before the start of deliberation on Committee Reports:

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The minority will be given a maximum of ten minutes to present their appeal.
- majority will then be given a maximum of ten minutes to present their position.

7) The discretion to debate a minority's appeal rests with the Conference body.

The chair will ask if there is a motion to decline to consider the minority's appeal. A motion to decline to consider a minority's appeal:

- Must be made without comment.
 - Needs a second.
 - Is not debatable.
 - Requires a *two thirds majority*.
- 8) If the Conference decides to debate the appeal, it then takes the form of a motion which does not require a second. If passed by substantial unanimity, it becomes an Advisory Action.
- 9) Whether or not an appeal is debated, a summary of the minority's report and the disposition of the appeal will be published in the *Final Conference Report*.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 21 The 2011 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey.
- 22 The following "Policy on Actors Portraying A.A. Members or Potential A.A. Members in Videos Produced by the General Service Board or its Affiliates" be approved:

Videos produced and distributed by the General Service Board or its affiliated corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., that include actors portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members shall not show the actor's full face, unless:

- The General Service Board, by substantial unanimity, agrees that the proposed video is consistent with the A.A. tradition of attraction rather than promotion, and that such use of an actor or actors does not in fact or in appearance place personalities before principles, and
- The General Service Conference authorizes, by substantial

unanimity, the production and distribution of such video.

For purposes of this Policy, a "video" is any item of visual media in which a live actor appears, regardless of the medium in which the video is presented (DVD, film, electronic file, etc.).

For purposes of this Policy, a "potential A.A. member" is a character in a video who is portrayed as seeking help from A.A., or who is portrayed as the recipient of Twelfth Step work in any form.

Existing videos using actors to portray A.A. members or potential A.A. members may continue to be produced and distributed until retired from service.

The videos "Markings on the Journey," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," each of which is currently distributed only to A.A. groups, as well as "Bill's Own Story," which also has restricted distribution, may continue to be produced and distributed.

A copy of this policy shall be given to all entities participating in the production of a video prior to commencement of production. The background documentation for the policy will always be distributed with the policy.

- 23 A culturally sensitive Spanish-language Public Service Announcement be developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, independent of any English language P.S.A. (production cost not to exceed \$40,000) to better ensure the hand of A.A. is there whenever anyone anywhere reaches out.
- 24 The revised "Understanding Anonymity" pamphlet be approved.
- 25 The revised "The A.A. Fact File" be approved.
- 26 The section titled "How You Can Find A.A. in Your Town" in "A.A. At a Glance" be changed to "How To Find A.A.," and that that section which reads:

"Look for Alcoholics Anonymous in any telephone directory. In most urban areas, a central A.A. office or intergroup, staffed mainly by volunteer A.A.s will be happy to answer your questions and/or put you in touch with those who can."

be amended to read:

"Look for Alcoholics Anonymous in any telephone directory, your local newspaper or "How to Find A.A. Meetings" on the home page of our Web site www.aa.org. In most urban areas, a central A.A. office or intergroup, staffed mainly by volunteer A.A.s will be happy to answer your questions and/or put you in touch with those who can."



REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 27 The following text be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* in Chapter Nine: The General Service Board after the section titled "General Service Trustees" on page S69:

"Trustees Emeriti

The General Service Board has designated rotating board chairpersons as trustees emeriti. Trustees emeriti are invited to attend quarterly board meetings of the General Service Board and the annual General Service Conference. They are a resource of corporate memory and are often asked to share their experience with past board decisions, how previous General Service Boards conducted business, and the processes they used to reach a group conscience. Trustees emeriti do not vote on any matter before the General Service Board or the Conference."

- 28 The following text on page S67 in *The A.A. Service Manual* under "NOMINATION PROCEDURE" in the section on Regional Trustees:

"2. Two Conference Actions should be kept in mind. In 1977, the Conference recommended that a delegate not be eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference. And in 1985, it was recommended that 'no area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large U.S./Canada in the same year.'"

Be replaced with:

"2. Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

- 29 The following text on page S68 in *The A.A. Service Manual* under "NOMINATION PROCEDURE" in the section on Trustees-at-large:

"In the areas, the same procedure used in selecting a regional trustee candidate is followed. No area should submit the same name for regional and at-large trustee in the same year."

Be replaced with:

"Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

- 30 The section titled "Inactive Service Workers" in Chapter Four on page S37 in *The A.A. Service Manual* be revised to read:

"Inactive Service Workers

How does the area deal with area officers and committee chairs who have been absent from two or more assemblies? While the area assembly needs to establish its own practices or guidelines, it is generally suggested that a service worker be asked to resign if he or she is unable to carry out the responsibilities of the position."

- 31 The following sections be added to *The A.A. Service Manual* as follows:

Add to Chapter Two, page S28, before section titled "Group Information":

"Inactive General Service Representative

A.A. relies on the autonomy of each group regarding the period of time and involvement that constitutes inactivity. While the group needs to establish its own practices or guidelines, it is generally suggested that a service worker be asked to resign if he or she is unable to carry out the responsibilities of the position."

Add to Chapter Three, page S33, before section titled "The Alternate D.C.M.":

"Inactive District Committee Member

A.A. relies on the autonomy of each district regarding the period of time and involvement that constitutes inactivity. While the district needs to establish its own practices or guidelines, it is generally suggested that a service worker be asked to resign if he or she is unable to carry out the responsibilities of the position."

- 32 The following text in the section titled "What Goes On at the Conference" on page S55 in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

"What Goes On at the Conference

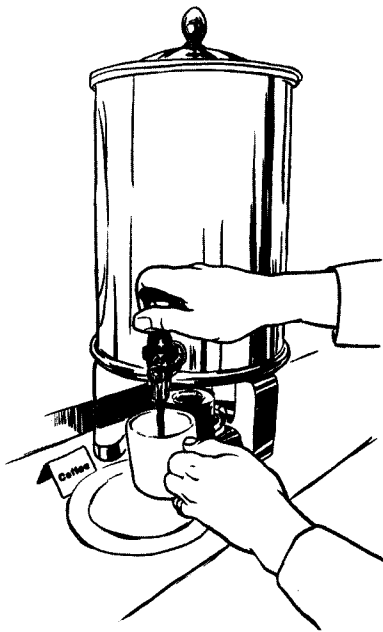
A typical Conference lasts a full week, with sessions running from morning to evening. The opening day features an opening dinner and a five-speaker A.A. meeting, and business sessions from Monday to Friday include committee meetings, presentations, workshops and new trustee elections. Each delegate serves on one of the standing Conference committees, which meet early in the week and do the principal work of the Conference. (Some delegates also have a secondary committee assignment.) The committees bring recommendations to the full Conference for consideration as possible Advisory Actions (see Chapter Eight for more on the committee system), and generally the last two days (or more) are devoted to discussion and voting on committee recommendations. A closing breakfast on Saturday, following the last day of Conference business, provides an opportunity for goodbyes, and for rotating trustees to say their farewells. Every other year, a visit to the home of Bill W. and Lois in Westchester County is scheduled."

Be replaced with:

"What Goes On at the Conference

A typical Conference lasts a full week, with sessions running from morning to evening. The opening day features roll call, keynote address, an opening dinner and a five-speaker A.A. meeting. Business sessions from Sunday to Friday include committee meetings, presentations, workshops, and new trustee elections. Each delegate serves on one of the standing Conference committees, which meet early in the week and do the principal work of the Conference. (Some delegates also have a secondary committee assignment.) The committees bring recommendations to the full Conference for consideration as possible Advisory Actions (see Chapter Eight for more on the committee system), and generally the last two days (or more) are devoted to discussion and voting on committee recommendations.

"Although outside of the Conference, a delegates-only meet-



ing is often held prior to the opening day of the Conference. On Saturday, following the last day of Conference business, a closing breakfast provides an opportunity for goodbyes, and for rotating trustees to say their farewells. In alternate years, a visit to G.S.O./Grapevine offices or the home of Bill W. and Lois in Westchester County is scheduled."

- 33 The General Service Board develop text to add to Article 3 in the current Conference Charter as found in *The A.A. Service Manual*, which includes the principles of participation, petition and appeal, for consideration by the 2012 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 34 The recovery pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs" be approved.
- 35 The name of the committee be changed to the Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities and that these changes be reflected in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure.
- 36 The title of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" be changed to "A.A. in Treatment Settings" and that the term "treatment facilities" be replaced with a more appropriate reference such as "Treatment Committees" or "treatment settings" wherever it appears in the pamphlet.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 37 The following slates of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in May 2011:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	The Honorable
Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.	Rogelio R. Flores
Corliss Burke	John Fromson, M.D.
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	Michele Grinberg, J.D.

Class B

Rod Betonney	George G. Martin
Kenneth P. Brueggemann	Don Massey
Donald Cusson	Don Miller
Nancy Haynes	Eleanor W. Nault
Barbara Kelly	Victor Phillips
Roberta Lindeman	Pamela Reising
J. Gary Lutz	Clayton Vandivort

Officers of the General Service Board

<i>Chairperson</i>	Ward B. Ewing, D.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Victor Phillips
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D.
<i>Treasurer</i>	Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
<i>Secretary</i>	Kenneth P. Brueggemann

- 38 The January 2011 appointment of the following officers by the chair of the General Service Board be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2011:

<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Doug Richardson

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 39 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2011:

Andrea G. Barthwell	George G. Martin
Rod Betonney	William Noonan
Joe Downey	Pamela Reising
Phyllis A. Halliday	Rick Walker
Roberta Lindeman	

- 40 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2011:

Ami Brophy	Eleanor Nault
Donald Cusson	Albin Zezula
Michele Grinberg, J.D.	[vacancy]
Nancy Haynes	[vacancy]
Don Miller	



■ Conference Inventory Planning Committee

INVENTORY PLAN

I Logistics

A. Location and Calendar:

- The inventory be conducted at the General Service Conference.
- The inventory take place at three consecutive Conferences: 2013, 2014 and 2015 implementing a three-year plan.

B. Schedule:

- Inventory be conducted during the regular Conference week, using the time allotted for the Workshop for the group meetings.
- At least two of the topic presentation time slots be combined for groups to report back to the full Conference body followed by full Conference sharing.
- The total number of inventory questions be divided between the three inventory years, so only one-third of the questions are addressed each of the three inventory years.
- The 2012 Conference Agenda Committee determine which inventory questions to address by the Conference each year so that following the 2012 Conference the Fellowship knows what questions will be discussed each of the three years.
- Conference members be divided into fifteen groups of nine members each.

- To maximize participation, the inventory questions for each inventory year be divided into thirds, so each year three sets of five groups consider the same group of questions.

II Participation

- A. Every voting member of the Conference be included in the inventory process to ensure that the inventory reflects current experience and a broad range of opinions/experiences.
- B. Each inventory group have the best possible proportionate representation from:
 1. Trustees and Directors
 2. Staff
 3. 2nd year delegates
 4. 1st year delegates
 5. By region, where feasible
- C. Members of each inventory group be selected by lot in December 2012 (first year) by one or two members of the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference coordinator.
- D. Any outgoing member be replaced by their incoming Conference counterpart. (i.e. an incoming delegate automatically be put in the same group as an outgoing delegate. The same applies to trustees and staff as they rotate.)

	YEAR ONE	YEAR TWO	YEAR THREE	TOTALS
OFFICE EXPENSE	\$ 5,000	\$ 5,000	\$ 5,000	\$15,000
Annual Reporting in <i>Final Conference Report</i>				
12 pages	\$ 6,832	\$ 6,832	\$ 6,832	\$20,496
20 pages	\$14,415	\$14,415	\$14,415	\$43,245
40 pages	\$22,535	\$22,535	\$22,535	\$90,260
Final Comprehensive Report (separate document)				
12 pages				\$17,625
20 pages				\$22,535
40 pages				\$41,580

The following outline is based on 44 inventory questions and is an example of how questions could be divided; any of the three inventory years could be the one year when there are fourteen questions rather than fifteen questions.

	INVENTORY YEAR	INVENTORY QUESTIONS	Each year there will be 15 inventory groups (A-O). Each inventory group will have 9 members.	
YR 1	2013	15 Questions (#1-15)	Group A-O	Groups A-E discuss questions #1-5 Groups F-J discuss questions #6-10 Groups K-O discuss questions #11-15
YR 2	2014	15 Questions (#16-30)	Group A-O	Groups A-E discuss questions #16-20 Groups F-J discuss questions #21-25 Groups K-O discuss questions #26-30
YR 3	2015	14 Questions (#31-44)	Group A-O	Groups A-E discuss questions #31-35 Groups F-J discuss questions #36-40 Groups K-O discuss questions #41-44

III Reporting

A. Conference inventory reporting:

- A thorough report of each year's Conference inventory session be produced that includes discussion related to each inventory question addressed that year and be included in the *Final Conference Report*.
- The report may include suggestions for future Conference agenda items or other changes in how the Conference serves the Fellowship.

B. Venues and methods for final and intermediate reporting:

- The full report be forwarded to the General Service Board.
- The full report be posted to the Conference dashboard.
- The full report be included in the *Final Conference Report*.
- Summary reports be included in A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, and Box 4-5-9.
- Summary reports be available at Regional, Local, and Additional Forums.

C. Feedback from noninventory participants be referred to their local area delegate.

D. A separate comprehensive report, including all three years' input, be produced after the inventory process is complete.

IV Finance

A. On the previous page are estimated costs associated with conducting and reporting the inventory:

- All cost estimates are based on 2010 prices, some increases may occur.
- Office expense includes additional personnel for tasks associated with the inventory.
- Costs for the annual and final reports include editorial, printing, translation, distribution and mailing expenses.
- The Final comprehensive report costs are based on distribution and mailing in the same fashion as the annual *Final Conference Report*.
- Annual and final report costs are dependent on the number of pages. Report costs could be lower than projected if the report(s) have less than twelve pages.
- No additional facility costs would be incurred since the inventory would take place during the regular Conference week.

V Inventory Questions

A. Effectiveness of the Conference/Conference Process Overall.

1. Reflecting on Concept I, how does the Conference ensure that it is the conscience of A.A. as a whole?
2. Reflecting on Concept II, how can we better serve as the actual voice and be an effective conscience for our whole society?
3. Reflecting on Concept III, how can we effectively balance

the freedoms and responsibilities that come with the right of decision?

4. Reflecting on Concept IV, how effective are we in treating all Conference members as equals (no one regarded as second class)?
5. Reflecting on Concept V, how well does the Conference facilitate the hearing and resolution of minority appeals/report? How could it be improved?
6. Does the structure encourage each individual in the Fellowship to feel and act as a member of a "society of alcoholics in action"? If not, how could we improve?
7. Does the year-long Conference process effectively encourage all Conference members to lead (or serve) in the spirit of our upside-down service structure? If not, how can we encourage all Conference members to do so?
8. How well is the use of Floor Actions serving us?
9. Reflecting on Concept X, how well is the authority of the Conference defined?
10. How well does the Conference fulfill the General Warranties of Concept XII?
11. How might any one of the Concepts be revised in essence or wording to more effectively and relevantly guide our leaders?

B. Composition of Conference

1. Should delegate areas be more consistently based on actual membership numbers?
2. Should regional divisions be based on membership numbers, the number of areas contained in each region or some other criteria? Please explain.
3. Is the size and structure (proportions of delegate/trustee/staff) of the Conference the most effective for conducting the work of the Fellowship? If not, how could it be made more effective?

C. Committee System

1. Committee system (Structure, Composition, Effectiveness, etc.): Does the Conference committee system function in accordance with our principles? If not, what changes should we consider regarding: a) structure b) composition c) effectiveness?
2. What is the right balance of participation among committee members (delegates, staff) and how can we best achieve that balance?
3. Could the committee process be improved to more effectively introduce change in the Fellowship, and if so, how?

D. Yearlong Process Effectiveness

1. What improvements could be considered to make sure the agenda selection process is more effective?
2. How well is the message of the Conference theme being carried out throughout the year?
3. How well do all Conference members communicate to the Fellowship about why we have a Conference and how the committee system works? How could we improve in this communication?

4. How can we better communicate that the Conference process is more than one week in the spring?
5. How do the delegates and regional trustees support the yearlong process effectiveness?
6. What other suggestions do we have for how to improve the effectiveness of the yearlong process?

E. Conference Preparation (background, content, delivery, etc.)

1. How can we improve the manner in which Conference background material is developed and distributed?
2. How well do the delegates balance their preparation for the Conference, especially in keeping with Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter? How could we improve in the practice of our rights and responsibilities under Concept III and Article Three of the Conference Charter?
3. What more could be done to prepare delegates for the Conference?

F. Conference Week Schedule

1. How can we improve the way time is allotted during the Conference for reports, presentation/discussion/workshop topics, and thorough discussion of agenda items?
2. What Conference activities give participants the most opportunities to be leaders?
3. At the Conference, what is the difference between being a leader or being a reporter? Can a person be both at the same time?
4. Does the time allotted, and the manner in which information is communicated from the trustees and board members, allow delegates to adequately understand and/or question their reports? How could this be improved?
5. How are leadership and participation affected by late night work sessions?

G. General Service Board/ Corporate Boards (A.A.W.S. & A.A. Grapevine)

1. Reflecting on Concept VI, how can the Conference ensure that the authority we delegate to the General Service Board is commensurate with the responsibility we have entrusted to them?
2. Reflecting on Concept VIII: (a) How well is the General Service Board exercising custodial oversight and how effectively are they serving as the principle planners and administrators of policy and finance? (b) What are the boundaries between oversight vs. delegation? When is each practiced?
3. Reflecting on Concept XI, does the General Service Board exercise serious care in having the best possible assistance in carrying out their duties? How can this process be improved?
4. Does the current role of the board most effectively address the needs of the Fellowship? If not, how should their role be changed?

5. Is the current makeup of the board (numbers and proportions) still the most effective? If not, what changes should we consider?
6. Should the Fellowship have more direct influence in the selection of Class A trustees, corporate directors, and general service trustees? If yes, how might that be accomplished?
7. How could we improve the methods used to solicit trustees and directors to get the most appropriate people interested in the positions?
8. Is the selection/election process for trustees and directors effective and impartial/fair? How would you change it?
9. What more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship?

H. Leadership

1. Reflecting on Concept IX, are the qualities of leadership, as identified in the leadership essay in *The A.A. Service Manual*, still the qualities that we should try to encourage in Conference members? If so, how successful are we in encouraging those qualities? If not, what changes should we consider?
2. How can we improve the methods of selecting effective leaders and nurturing leadership qualities in our trusted servants?
3. What more could be done to ensure broad diversity of representation in our A.A. leaders?
4. How well is the Third Legacy Procedure serving us? How could it be improved?



■ Presentations and Reports

21ST WORLD SERVICE MEETING REPORT

Sunday, following the Opening Session, the trustee-at-large/Canada reported on the WSM, held last October in Mexico City.

Greetings fellow Conference members. My name is Jo-Anne and I am an alcoholic. This is my final presentation as trustee-at-large/Canada. What a gift from God, and I cherish these final few moments of gratitude with you.

Thank you for this loving invitation to share my experience from the 21st World Service Meeting (WSM). In our U.S./Canada structure, the two trustees-at-large/U.S. and Canada are considered WSM delegates, and therefore attend these service meetings together to represent our structure. Thank you Don, it was a pleasure working with you.

At the third WSM held in London in 1974, the delegates agreed that future meeting sites should alternate between New York and another country, and they adopted the following statement of purpose:

"The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as that of all A.A. activity: to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers wherever in the world he may be, whatever the language he speaks. The WSM seeks ways and means of accomplishing this goal by serving as a forum for sharing the experience, strength, and hope of delegates who come together every two years from all corners of the world. It can also represent an expression of the group conscience on a worldwide basis.

"Experience teaches us that organizing ourselves into a sound structure enables us to develop and deliver our services more effectively. The WSM encourages the planning of sound service structures, suited to the needs and capabilities of the various countries; and the exploration of expanding A.A. services to reach the alcoholic through internal communication, literature distribution, sponsorship, public information, community relations, and institutions work."

Phyllis Halliday, G.S.O.'s general manager, chaired most of the sessions, and her calm and warm demeanor set a wonderful tone for the week. Jose Alfredo Hernandez, the Class A General Service Board (G.S.B.) chair of Mexico, gave an inspiring opening talk that ended with these words: "The worldwide language of Alcoholics Anonymous knows no boundaries; there are no distinctions of race, creed, language or dialect; we simply speak the language of the heart. May it be God's will, as each of us may conceive God, that this language of the heart be the language that guides and directs our WSM. If it is so, we can be sure we are doing the will of our creator. May God bless you all."

This was followed by a thought-provoking keynote talk on the WSM theme, "Sponsorship: Our Responsibility," by Kristin Langnes, WSM delegate from Norway.

We had nine women and forty-four men representing thirty-two countries, and although there were many delegates that I already knew from other meetings, like the Redela (Meeting of the Americas), there were many new faces, and by the end of our sessions there were only new

friends who share the same love and concern for Alcoholics Anonymous where they live around the globe.

All sessions were conducted in English with simultaneous translation in Spanish. I totally admired all of the delegates, especially those who spoke English as well as they could, even though it was obviously not their first language. It showed their courage, determination, and willingness to be a part of this wonderful meeting.

People from the host country, Mexico, really did their best to keep us busy after our sessions. Every night there would be a convoy of vehicles waiting to take us to A.A. meetings around the city, and each morning we would wake up in our rooms to little mementos of thanks. These mementos were usually biscuits or something sweet that always included gratitude readings for the day.

At the WSM, there are four committees: Agenda, Literature/Publishing, Policy/Admissions/Finance, and Working with Others. I had the privilege of chairing the Literature/Publishing Committee as a second-term delegate, and Don served on Policy/Admissions/Finance as a first-term delegate. We serve on the same committee for both terms.

The WSM is a service meeting, and therefore we do not set policy for any particular structure, but we do share our own country experience. Usually, all first-term delegates present "Country Highlights" just as we do here at the Conference with our Area Highlights. It was especially wonderful to hear from Estonia and Portugal, who were first-time attendees at this meeting.

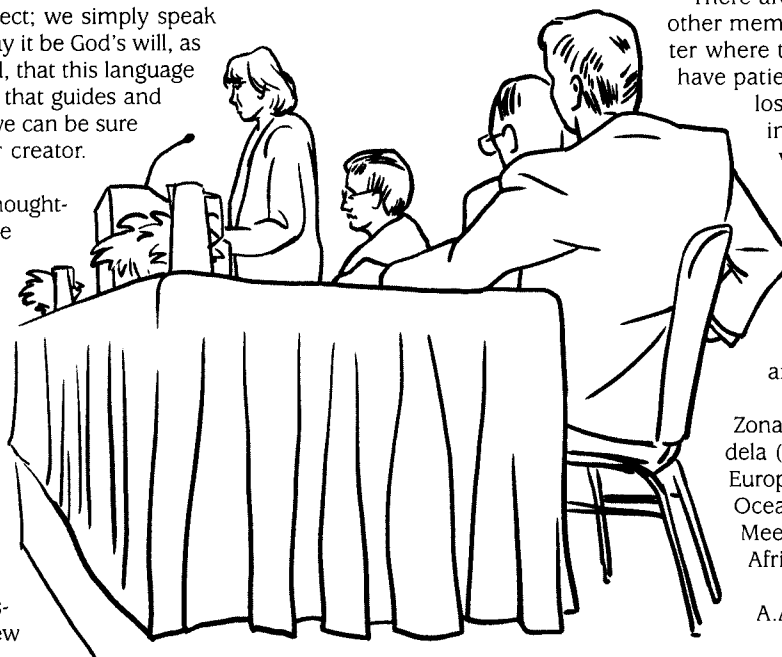
We also had set topic presentations, according to our theme and discussion topics. We had some wonderful sharing on Women in A.A., The Seventh Tradition, Sponsorship, Young People in A.A., A.A. and the Internet, A.A. General Service Trustees, and Preserving A.A.'s Identity. Each presenter gave wonderful sharing on each subject. On the topic of Women in A.A. Svetlana stated that in Russian society a woman who drinks is far worse than a man who drinks. Our own Russian proverb: when a husband drinks, half the house is on fire, but when a wife drinks, the whole home is on fire.

This describes the attitude toward women alcoholics in Russia at this moment, reported Svetlana, and yet, I look around *this* room, and see many examples of female leadership from our own structure, and also with our guests from Great Britain. We are all alcoholics who just happen to be women.

There are opportunities to inspire another member, man or woman, no matter where they live on the globe, and to have patience and tolerance and to not lose hope where attitudes seem inflexible. After all, in the forward to the Third Edition of our Big Book it says recovery begins when one alcoholic shares with another, so I suppose we can also say service begins when one servant shares with another their experience, strength and hope.

We also had reports from each Zonal meeting, starting with the Redela (Meeting of the Americas), the European Service Meeting, the Asia-Oceania Meeting, Sub-Saharan Meeting, and the West Central Africa Service Meeting.

There were three workshops: A.A.'s Twelve Traditions and



Group Autonomy, G.S.B. Procedures, and A.A. Members Working in the Field of Alcoholism.

There was also a comprehensive presentation by Phyllis on the International Literature Fund. This fund was started in 1992 with a recommendation for the WSM secretary to write "all participating countries for the specific purpose of raising funds for the current problem of providing start up literature for those countries unable to finance their own translations and acquisitions." Since that time, the response from countries around our A.A. world has been, and continues to be, positive, heartwarming, and most gratifying. This fund has been placed under the purview of the WSM Literature/Publishing Committee. Since 1991, A.A.W.S.'s International Literature Assistance expenditures to emerging countries in Europe, Africa, Asia, the Middle East, Oceania, and the Americas total over 2.5 million dollars.

There was a strong emphasis at our WSM to inform all countries to consider that it is not the amount that they contribute that's important, but rather the continued effort to make contributions. There is one country in particular whose tabletop voluntary contribution makes them 96% self-supporting, and has been very generous with their funds. The WSM stressed that it is a wonderful example of just giving something.

The whole four days went by so quickly, and yes, the reports and meetings made for long days, but being in the room together with worldwide representation of A.A. was worth every second, minute and hour.

We had a closing dinner at an authentic Mexican restaurant, where we were entertained with dancers, and mariachi singers. It was a very lively evening, and some of us were moved to get out of our chairs and join in the festivities.

On the final day, all second-term delegates were given an opportunity to say farewell to their fellow delegates and all spoke with such gratitude about the language of the heart, and how A.A. had given them another chance. All were so thankful for the opportunity to be part of the WSM and, as usual, there were tears of love leaking everywhere.

After a moving and thoughtful closing talk by the G.S.B. chair of Mexico, all delegates participated in the closing of the WSM by reciting the Serenity Prayer in each language present. This is our A.A.: each voice spoken, many languages, and one main purpose. It was a moment like no other.

There is a certain pride that I pray we all possess here in our U.S./Canada structure. It does not matter how large A.A. becomes; A.A. was born here, and you and I are participating this week to do our part to keep it alive for generations to come, wherever they are in the world.

There are more than sixty other G.S.O.s in the world. They are all working together with their own structures to make them work where they are, and whether we like it or not, we are looked upon as a template and guide. It charges us with the responsibility to keep our own house in order.

The International Committee does not have a corresponding Conference Committee, but that does not take away the importance and value of the work involved in keeping abreast of the world of A.A. outside of our own U.S./Canada structure. This is also the committee that is the command ship for the WSM, and I would like to thank Warren for his efforts in Mexico, even though there were some difficult moments, but we never missed a beat. The work of our G.S.O. International desk staff, their assistants, the Publications department, our general manager, our chief financial officer, and all the others who work very hard under the radar, is more than appreciated; the world of A.A. depends on, appreciates, and applauds their efforts. The privilege of being a part of this equation has been a life-changing experience for this alcoholic.

To meet and observe a new A.A. member embrace our pro-

gram is priceless, and that they have a Big Book in their own language clutched under their arm, because of the perseverance and commitment of hard-working members in their country. To think this all began over seventy-five years ago.

The theme for the 22nd World Service Meeting will be "Rotation: The Heartbeat of A.A." and will be held in New York City, October 21-25, 2012.

Thank you for your trust and this opportunity to serve.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada

DIVERSITY IN A.A.

Sunday afternoon's Presentation/Discussion topic was chaired by Corliss Burke, Class A trustee.

The Language of the Heart is Spoken Here

My name is Richard Boisvert and I am an alcoholic. I have the honor and privilege of serving Area 90, Northwest Québec, as Panel 60 delegate. Thank you so much for the invitation to speak and enjoy this extraordinary experience.

Because the theme for this 61st Conference is "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us," I sincerely believe that there is but one language that we should use in Alcoholics Anonymous, and that is the language of the heart; simply one alcoholic talking to another alcoholic, about his experience, strength and hope. It is our heart that speaks when we try to carry the A.A. message, giving hope to a newcomer or to an anonymous alcoholic experiencing difficulty.

I have a particular experience I would like to share with you regarding our responsibility for A.A.'s future. In 2006, my job took me to Nagoya, Japan, for a three month period. At that time I was sober seventeen years, I was Area 90's alternate chair, and I had a good family situation. I had my A.A. literature in my bag, and I was confident that I could easily find a meeting there. There's only one thing that I forgot: I don't speak Japanese! After a while, even with my literature, my sobriety was jeopardized by not being able to talk to another alcoholic or to find a meeting place. I asked for help from the hotel staff where I was staying, but they spoke very little English. I explained to them that I was looking for an A.A. meeting. They all asked: "What is A.A.?" I briefly explained that it is a fellowship of men and women who share their experience with each other in order to not drink. They all answered that they like to drink with their friends and that A.A. is not for them.

One evening, while attending a baseball game, I felt isolated and I ordered a large glass of beer. I was scared; I didn't want to drink it. My glass was about six inches from my mouth, and all of a sudden I thought of my friends with whom I served in Montreal and I told myself that I should call them before taking my first drink. I made my way back to the hotel where I called our delegate back home to tell her about my situation. I told her that I couldn't find help and couldn't talk about my situation to someone who would understand me. She listened to me and told me that she would send an e-mail to the G.S.O., asking for help.

I was quite surprised the next morning, as I found in my e-mails the names of fifteen members of Alcoholics Anonymous living in Japan! So I started to look for an alcoholic, as Bill Wilson had done in Akron, seventy-five years earlier. I did not want to drink and I knew that if I took that first drink, I would be done.

After six unsuccessful calls, I succeeded in speaking to an alcoholic named Tom. In fact, "speaking" is a big word; rather I started crying, because hearing his voice gave me a sense of security that I had lost. One alcoholic, talking to another alcoholic.

With the help of another alcoholic named Scott, I finally found

a meeting, spoke with some alcoholics twice a week, and came back to Canada with my sobriety intact. By opening a group in Nagoya, these members succeeded in being responsible for A.A.'s future.

So, how can I be responsible for A.A.'s future if it is to begin with me? Our First Tradition says: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity." In my group, my district, my area, at the Conference, do I use love and tolerance towards people? I often say that when I talk to a newcomer, I never have any problems because God lives inside me. It really is the language of the heart in action. But in a service meeting, God can leave very rapidly if I don't have love, tolerance and unity. Because of my responsibility and the privilege of serving the Fellowship, I must try and make people want to follow me. If I can stand in front of you today, it is because some people have been responsible for A.A.'s future and made me want to follow them. As you all count on the support of your group to recover, A.A. groups in Canada and the United States count on the General Service Conference to maintain the unity and strength of our Fellowship. It is our duty for all of today's and tomorrow's alcoholics.

I would like to end with a quote from Dr. Bob's last message: "Let us also remember to guard that erring member the tongue, and if we must use it, let's use it with kindness and consideration and tolerance.

"And one more thing: None of us would be here today if somebody hadn't taken the time to explain things to us, to give us a little pat on the back, to take us to a meeting or two, to do numerous little kind and thoughtful acts in our behalf. So let us never get such a degree of smug complacency that we're not willing to extend, or attempt to extend, to our less fortunate brother that help which has been so beneficial to us." (*Dr. Bob and the Good Old-timers*, page 338)

I hope that our vision for the future will be focused on the A.A. groups as the fundamental recovery tool. I hope that our vision will encompass an A.A. movement where the groups will still have the right to make mistakes. I hope that our vision will encompass an A.A. movement where the bond between service and the recovering alcoholics will remain important. I hope that our vision will encompass an A.A. movement where organizational words like "speed" and "convenience" will not replace the basic service structure and the language of the heart, which often require much time and effort in order to be expressed and heard.

Thank you for your attention.

Richard Boisvert, Northwest Québec

The Hand of A.A. — Inclusive Never Exclusive

In his writings about the early days of Alcoholics Anonymous, Bill Wilson recounts tales of fear and intolerance, membership rules and regulations ostensibly geared to protect groups from anything or anyone that might upset the A.A. lifeboat. At one point groups we asked to send in their membership rules for a review. It was determined that had all the edicts been in force everywhere at once, very few could have complied.

Groups ultimately survived and learned to not be afraid of what a particular type of newcomer might do to sully A.A.'s reputation or effectiveness. In an August 1946 article (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 39), Bill explains that if alcohol is an uncontrollable problem for the newcomer and he or she wishes to do something about it, that's enough for us. We wish to deny no one his chance to recover from alcoholism. We wish to be as inclusive as we can, never exclusive.

Since those early days the A.A. pendulum has done what pendulums do—swung to the opposite extreme. In many quarters of

our Fellowship exists the notion that A.A. can help all kinds of people with all kinds of problems. Perhaps this came about because we want to share our exuberance for sobriety and a new way of living with the whole world; or perhaps it's due, as the joke goes, to treatment centers with only one van. Or maybe we're simply not passing along our Traditions to newcomers.

I'm not so sure that we did ourselves any favors by coming up with a shortened version of the Twelve Traditions. The short form is what's read at most meetings and often the only version members know. Consequently, our Third Tradition is often interpreted as "just say you don't want to drink," whether you drink or not. Yet the long form of that Tradition clearly states that our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism, with alcoholism being the important word. Often our Responsibility Statement is interpreted as a mandate for saving the world: When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help; I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. The logic that follows is that our Twelve Steps work for all sorts of addictions. After all, look at how many Twelve Step programs exist today.

What is ignored is the need for identification. If the Steps were all that was needed for recovery, we could sit at home and work them alone. Meetings would be irrelevant. But it doesn't work that way. A necessary part of our recovery is identifying with other human beings who have been where we've been, done what we've done, and felt what we've felt . . . and have recovered. How can someone who doesn't have a problem with alcohol, but doesn't want to drink, identify with the alcoholic? Would I go to Gamblers Anonymous to treat my overeating? To Overeaters Anonymous to learn how to live, one day at a time, without crack cocaine? The Steps may be the same, but it's not the same. Related? Probably. But not the same.

Encouraging nonalcoholics to participate in A.A. creates problems for alcoholics and for the individual who is not addressing his or her real problem. By not guiding them to a program that more specifically addresses their problem, we may be signing their death warrant. As Bill says in "Problems Other than Alcohol," "It has been learned that there is no possible way to make non-alcoholics into A.A. members." Membership, no. But we can welcome them as observers at our open meetings.

Bill goes on to warn that our first duty as a society is to insure our own survival; that we must avoid distraction and multipurpose activity; and that an A.A. group, as such, can't take on all the personal problems of its members, let alone the problems of the whole world. When our primary purpose gets muddled with talk of drugs, pills, white flour, nicotine, or anything other than alcohol, what happens to the alcoholic? There are programs specifically for people with those other problems. But what about the alcoholic? Where will he go? Who can he find to identify with?

Of course, one who is an alcoholic *and* a drug addict; an alcoholic *and* a compulsive eater, are always welcome. As individuals, there's no reason we can't be useful by working with outside groups. Bill reminds us that "in A.A., the group has strict limitations, but the individual has scarcely any."

A.A. groups have fallen apart because a few well-intentioned members insist that although the person isn't an alcoholic, she should stay because for today, he or she doesn't want to drink. I've seen a group censure their G.S.R. for taking a nonalcoholic aside to explain that it was a closed meeting for alcoholics only. Upholding the Traditions is not an easy or popular stance to take in today's A.A. Those who do are often characterized as rigid and out of touch with today's reality or as uncaring and fearful bleeding deacons. I call them solid — and I hope to have the courage to be one of them.

Virginia Rogers, Southern Indiana

Tradition Five — Our Primary Purpose

Considering where I came from, it's a great honor and privilege to be here today and to have the opportunity to give this presentation on the topic "Tradition Five — Our Primary Purpose" and how it relates to our Presentation/Discussion topic of "Diversity In A.A." as well as our Conference theme of "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us."

No matter where I am in the world today, I'm always surrounded by a very diverse group of individuals of various ethnicities, creeds, colors, backgrounds, appearances, and personalities. One quick look around this room will instantly confirm this. However, I'm reasonably sure that all of us in this room have one thing in common: that we're all here today because someone took the time to practice our primary purpose of the Fifth Tradition and carried the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to us, regardless of our differences or diversities.

The Long Form of Tradition Five states "Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose* — that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers."

How important is this Tradition? In *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, on page 150, it states "Around it our Society gathers in unity. The very life of our Fellowship requires the preservation of this principle." Those are some pretty strong statements!

The primary message of Alcoholics Anonymous is to show others how we have recovered from a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body, and this message has no bearing on our differences or diverse natures, because the disease of alcoholism is not selective and simply doesn't care who we are, what we are, or where we came from. Our message is infinite, based upon our personal experiences with the Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service.

Our Conference-approved literature provides many useful tools and specific instructions to help us carry our message to the still-suffering alcoholic. However, these publications aren't intended to carry the message for us. Our message is most effectively carried when one drunk shares his or her experience, strength and hope face-to-face with another drunk in the language of the heart.

In recent years, I've heard our oldtimers say that they believe our message has become diluted, and there has been quite a bit of discussion about a general lack of participation within our Fellowship. I, too, have these same concerns and believe that this may be a secondary disease within our Fellowship that has the potential to destroy us from within. Is this a result of the message

that's being carried today? It appears to me that a lot of emphasis is being put into carrying our message of the Twelve Steps of Recovery, with very little focus on our Twelve Traditions of Unity and the Twelve Concepts of Service. Aren't all of these Legacies essential to the survival of our Fellowship and long-term sobriety?

After drinking for many years, there were several people telling me that I had a problem with alcohol and that I needed to do something about it. Unbeknownst to me, I was already living in the delusion of alcoholism and refused to admit that I had any kind of a problem with alcohol. I continued my uncontrolled drinking for many more years before I couldn't take it any more. I had arrived at that jumping off place and had no idea what I was going to do. The humility and despair were tremendous! It was then that I finally made a simple plea: "God, please help me."

Through a very astounding sequence of events, I ended up in a treatment facility and discussed my dilemma with a doctor who had been my family physician for many years and who had tried to get me to quit drinking twenty-five years prior to that time. In our discussion, he told me that they could help me get sober, but in order to stay sober, I had to get involved in Alcoholics Anonymous. It was because of him that I showed up at my first A.A. meeting.

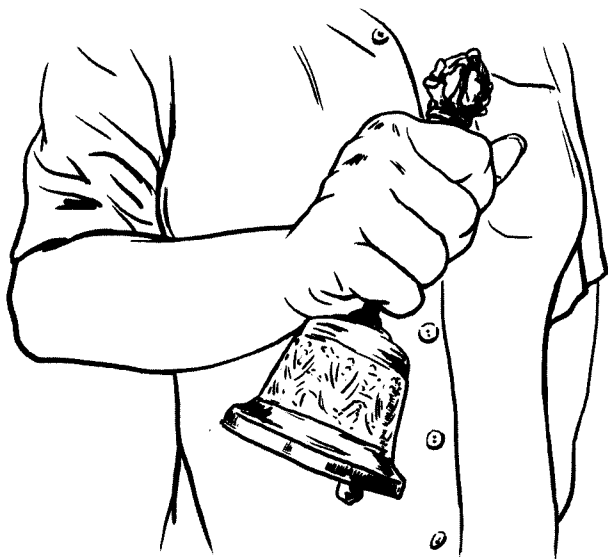
I didn't know if I was an alcoholic or not and I knew absolutely nothing about the disease of alcoholism. When I walked into that first meeting, I looked around and saw a very diverse group of people. There were men and women from all walks of life and I was scared to death! Fortunately, these people approached me and made me feel welcome. They didn't care who I was, what I was, where I came from, what my background was, or what my beliefs were. They simply told me that if I had a problem with alcohol and wanted a way out, they had a solution for me. They strongly suggested that I needed to attend meetings on a regular basis, to get a sponsor and have him take me through the Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. I knew that I had run out of options and had no choice but to do as they suggested. Over time, these people taught me about the disease of alcoholism. They shared their experience, strength and hope with me and taught me how to stay sober one day at a time. Thank God for these people, for they utilized our cherished Fifth Tradition, carried out our primary purpose, and taught me how to pass this precious gift on to others. This single principle of Alcoholics Anonymous saved my life and provided me with a way of living beyond my wildest dreams!

There are thousands of alcoholics in the world dying every day because they don't have our solution. There is no doubt in my mind as to where I would be today if someone hadn't taken the time to provide me with their precise message of recovery, just as it had been so freely given to them by another sober member of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I didn't get sober by doing a self-study of our Big Book. I didn't get sober by reading our A.A. Conference-approved literature and pamphlets. I got sober because another sober member of Alcoholics Anonymous was willing to exercise our primary purpose face-to-face with me and guide me through the Twelve Steps of Recovery, the Twelve Traditions of Unity and the Twelve Concepts of Service. That's the only reason that I'm standing here sober today, and the only way that I get to keep what I have is to pass it on to others in the same precise manner that it was freely given to me.

It's my hope and prayer that the decisions we make this week will truly be in the best interest of the alcoholic who still suffers and the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. It is essential that we do this, regardless of what our differences and diversities may be, because "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us!"

Allen Wharton, Wyoming



FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon, the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Terry Bedient, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Terry Bedient and I am a very grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report to the 61st General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor will be included in the *Final Conference Report* and auditor partner Kevin Sunkel is here to answer any questions that may arise from this report. Also available throughout the week are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, Grapevine controller. Our goal is to help you become familiar with our financial condition so that you can communicate clearly to your area. Enhancing our understanding of finance is one sure way to improve the service structure. Your area will be listening carefully to what you report after the Conference, so let us know what we can do to enhance the communication.

To begin our review of the financial position of our General Service Office; A.A. World Services Publishing activities; La Viña; A.A. Grapevine, Inc.; and the Reserve Fund, we will review 2010 results, 2011 budget, and some projections for 2012 and 2013.

"Around the Picnic Table" is a phrase coined at the 59th Conference. It means that much of the finance discussion during Conference is "preaching to the choir." But what we really need to do is plan for better communication as members talk around the picnic table.

Our conversations this week will emphasize the importance of self-support and Slide 1 lists a few things to consider in communicating with the Fellowship about finance. Focus on the spiritual value of contributing with examples of how contributions get used. Yes, we are facing some financial challenges, but our service structure is designed to foster responsibility and stability. Members can be confident that trusted servants are accountable, based on the checks and balances that have been built into the financial structure of staff, accountants, auditors and officers. Humanize the numbers. If an \$8 million G.S.O. budget seems intimidating, we can talk in terms of \$6 per member or \$137 per group. Emphasize corporate poverty—that we should have just enough to carry the message. And encourage Grapevine subscriptions as an excellent way to help carry our lifesaving message.

Slide 2 summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office. I am sure we are familiar with the functions listed with the possible exception of the last line, entitled Supporting Services. This includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of G.S.O. functions for 2010 was \$8,642,112, which is 1.6% less than in 2009. Most of the Functional cost, centers showed decreases, but I will highlight several increases. We had the World Service Meeting in Mexico City, and the net cost which falls to G.S.O., was \$205,600. Approximately \$62,000 additional was spent during 2010 on Regional Forums. The staff member on this assignment is working to reduce hotel, mailing and other costs where possible.

Slide 3 is similar, except that Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. Group and member statistics are shown at the bottom of the slide.

Slide 4. Here, we have displayed a few member statistics. We see that an annual contribution of only \$6.29 per member or \$137.45 per group in 2010 would have allowed the Services to be fully self-supporting from contributions. How do we arrive at these numbers? It is just a simple calculation of costs shown on financial statements divided by the number of members or groups shown on the Contribution statistical report. And remember, those numbers are only as good as the data we can capture in an Anonymous Fellowship. A delegate asked me to add an "ideal column" and I will leave it to you to fill in the blanks.

Slide 5 shows a detailed breakdown of Group Service activities. This is intended to give a broader understanding of the extraordinary range of services performed by your G.S.O. on behalf of each group. Once again, G.S.O. provided more services for less cost than in 2009.

In 2010 (Slide 6), the General Service Board received contributions of \$6,408,421, which was an increase of approximately \$112,300, or 1.8% more than last year. The year 2010 marked a slight upturn after contribution decreases for two years in a row. That kind of decline had not occurred for many years and we eagerly await 2011 results. I am sure I speak for everyone when I say how deeply grateful we are for this support from across the Fellowship, considering these tough times. We are grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. And I hope information from this Conference will help to assist in your communication about self-support around the picnic table.

Slide 7 summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2010 amounted to \$12,470,712, which was about 10% less than 2009, or \$1,288,000 less. We must remember that there were substantial purchases just prior to the price increase of July 1, 2009. After deducting the cost of goods sold, shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$7,864,429, or 64.5% of sales. We then deduct Program expenses of \$2,672,624 and Supporting expenses of \$1,703,380. A.A.W.S. had an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$3,488,425. Prior reports have noted the importance of maintaining a realistic Gross Profit percentage which A.A.W.S. directors and staff continue to monitor.

La Viña (Slide 8), our Spanish-language magazine, reported a loss greater than budget, due in part to additional costs resulting from a Conference Action last year. Gross profit from the sale of



magazines and related items equaled \$51,323, an increase of about \$1,000 from 2009. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$126,803, the result is a loss for 2010 of \$75,481. This compares to a loss in 2009 of \$54,472 and was comparable to the 2008 loss of \$76,264. A loss of \$114,695 has been budgeted for 2011. Please remember that La Viña's direct expenses are paid from the General Fund, which houses all contributions.

A.A. Grapevine (Slide 9) incurred a loss as well. Over the year, you have heard of extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$2,097,408 in 2010. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,245,532. Gross profit from related items was approximately \$535,297, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,780,829. Total Costs and expenses of \$2,218,666 are deducted and then Interest Income of \$38,800 is recorded. The result was a loss of \$399,037 as compared to a budgeted loss of \$245,741. A significant portion of this loss was due to reorganizational costs. The Grapevine budget for 2011 anticipates a loss of \$93,970.

Slide 10 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2010. The G.S.O. shows contributions, interest, and literature profits totaling \$9,897,401. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$8,642,112, which leaves a positive result for 2010 of \$1,255,289. From this we subtract the operating losses of Grapevine (\$399,037) and La Viña (\$75,480), and then add the net gain of the International Convention this past summer of \$844,545. This results in a 2010 bottom line of \$1,625,317. This positive bottom line assists in keeping the Reserve Fund on an even keel.

Slide 11 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, G.S.O. and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, the G.S.O. has only two sources of money; contributions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund. Historically, G.S.O. has relied on literature sales to help balance the budget.

Slide 12 shows the relationship between the Fellowship, Grapevine and the Reserve Fund. To pay its bills and fund obligations, Grapevine has only two sources of money: subscriptions and literature sales. At the end of each year, any cash more than is necessary to pay bills on time is transferred to the Reserve Fund.

Slide 13 covers the General Service Board Reserve Fund. The Reserve Fund ended 2010 with an adjusted balance of \$14,368,427, equal to approximately 11.3 months of operating expenses. At the end of 2009, the Reserve Fund balance was the equivalent of 9.5 months of operating expenses. Many of you know that a 1977 Conference Advisory Action asked our Auditor to comment annually on the adequacy of the Reserve Fund. Our understanding of the *The A.A. Service Manual* is that the Reserve Fund is for infrastructure investments or extraordinary circumstances, but not to fund long-term obligations. For 2010, our Auditor has stated that without reference to long-term obligations, "the question of adequacy is answered in the affirmative."

Slide 14. Over the past decade, a number of actions have been taken to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. Big Book prices were reduced \$1 with publication of the 4th Edition, then restored in 2004; selected book prices and handling charges were raised in 2005; G.S.O. accomplished a major cost reduction program in 2007 and 2008; in 2009, both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine implemented price increases.

Slide 15. Based on future projections from both G.S.O. and Grapevine, we may well be relying more on contributions in the coming years. So remember, "A dollar ain't what it used to be."

Slide 16 shows A.A.W.S. projections for 2011, 2012 and 2013. With NO increase in gross sales and a 4% increase in contributions, there would be a net loss in both 2012 and 2013.

Slide 17 shows A.A.W.S. projections for 2012 and 2013 with a 4% increase in gross sales and a 4% increase in contributions, for a profit in 2012 but a loss in 2013. Remember that over the past few years, the Reserve Fund has maintained its adequacy because of A.A.W.S. profits, which you can track on the last line of this chart.

Slide 18 shows Grapevine projections with a loss for 2011 and 2012, but a consistent increase in subscriptions and magazine revenue for a profit in 2013 of \$112,000.

Our Auditor (Slide 19) continues to remind us of long-term obligations for post-employment commitments to current employees and retirees, for both pension and medical benefits. These obligations are funded out of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine operations. With regard to Pension, A.A. has for its employees a Defined Benefit Pension Program, which was established in 1965. By law, Column A must nearly equal Column B in about 5 years. The unfunded Pension Liability in Column B is about \$5.9 million. A.A.W.S. and Grapevine have included paying down this liability into their budgets. We will need to sustain an annual level of fund payments of approximately \$1,600,000 for each of the next several years. Our Pension and post-retirement health obligations now account for about 12% of the G.S.O. budget.

Our benefit plans should be periodically reviewed, but remember that as long as G.S.O. remains in business, pension benefits, which have already accrued cannot be changed.

In conclusion, let me review a few of the ongoing activities of your trustees' Finance Committee:

- Composition, Scope and Procedures now provide for an annual Committee review of the financial aspects of the 3-5 year strategic plans of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine.
- The Unfunded Pension Liability is now clearly reported on a separate line in the Consolidated Financial Statements.
- There is an ongoing subcommittee to oversee Grapevine cash flow in the context of recent draws on the Reserve Fund.
- A subcommittee has begun to review and analyze the Pension Plan.

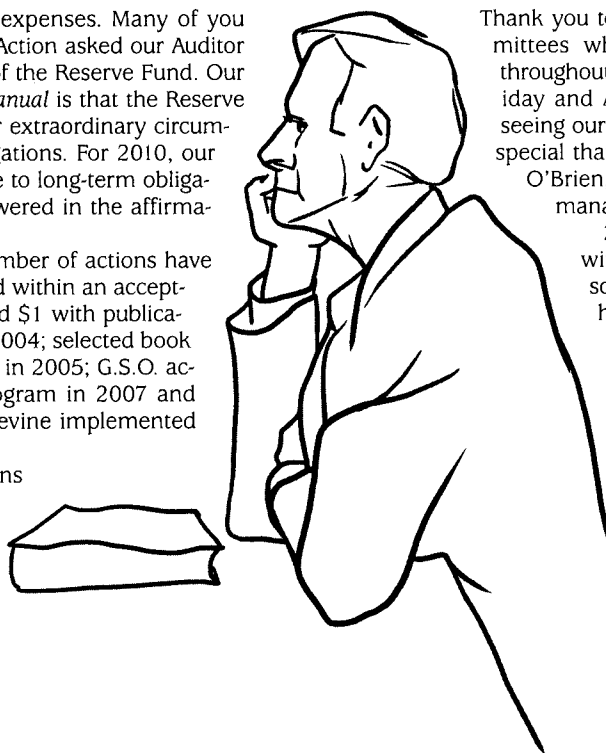
I am pleased to acknowledge the extraordinary talent and dedication that I am privileged to observe as treasurer.

Thank you to members of all the finance committees who sort through enormous detail throughout the year. Thank you to Phyllis Halliday and Ami Brophy for competently overseeing our operating corporations. And a very special thank you to Don Meurer and Eugene O'Brien, our talented and dedicated finance managers.

2011 will undoubtedly be marked with some uncertainty and perhaps some surprises due to the continuing hard economic times. But there will be new groups and more members and unlimited opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper.

And remember, Finance has no importance in and of itself. Finance is simply a way to help carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

*Terrance M. Bedient, treasurer
General Service Board*



AN INFORMED GROUP CONSCIENCE: THE VOICE OF A.A.

Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S., moderated the Monday evening Presentation/Discussion session.

Self-Support: Where Do Money and Spirituality Mix?

When I came to Alcoholics Anonymous, to say that I was spiritually, morally, and financially bankrupt would be an understatement. The corruption of the instinct for material security by alcoholism caused me to harm my family, friends, and society. I have recognized and confessed these harms and the character defects underlying them. I asked my Higher Power to remove them and made amends, including financial restitution. Some of my amends have been indirect, meaning I have had to change my attitude about money, how I get it and how I use it. When my sponsor told me to get a job and pay my bills, I didn't see what that had to do with not drinking, but I know now that it was a means to a spiritual awakening. As I became a part of my A.A. group, I became a giver as well as a taker, both financially and through service.

The spiritual awakening has given me a new attitude about money. Bill W. writes in the essay on Step Twelve, "Money gradually became our servant and not our master. It became a means of exchanging love and service with those about us." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 122) My time and talent, as well as my money, are required for me to be useful to others. The exchange of love and service implies that giving and receiving are both parts of the spiritual principle. We say, "We have to give it away to keep it," but I think we have to give it away to get it. We really don't want to keep it, we want to keep it flowing. The root of the word "currency" means to flow to. The word "affluent" means to flow abundantly. We use these words in a financial sense, but they have a deeper spiritual meaning. Just as inflow and outflow are necessary for a healthy body of water, so we need them to be spiritually healthy. One version of our Eleventh Step prayer, attributed to St. Francis of Assisi, says "It is in giving that we receive." A prayer attributed to Ignatius of Loyola that I use in my Eleventh Step says, in part, "Dearest Lord, teach me to be generous.... To serve you as you deserve, to give and not count the cost..."

Bill W. writes, "Where the proper use of money ends, and its misuse begins, is the 'spiritual space' we are all seeking." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 24) Our Traditions define this spiritual space. Tradition Six counsels us on where to separate the material from the spiritual, in the matter of outside enterprises like clubs. Tradition Seven tells us where and how money and spirituality should mix, in the hat. We don't keep more money than we need to carry the message, so money serves our primary spiritual aim, not hinders it. Tradition Eight says we are not to be paid for the Twelfth Step.

A.A.'s principle of corporate poverty is so refreshing to me in these economic times. This principle was developed through vision and experience; Bill W. cites two people as the main influences, John D. Rockefeller, Jr. and St. Francis of Assisi. (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 111) Talk about a mix of money and spirituality!

I have been asked to put this into the context of the Conference theme. The essay on leadership in Concept Nine talks about the need of our vision for the future of Alcoholics Anonymous, both spiritually and financially. We will find unity in our spiritual principles, but will our method of paying for services through a combination of contributions and publishing income be sufficient? Can we keep the A.A. Grapevine financially sound as a tool for recovery and Twelfth Step work? We must let the spiritual principles guide us. "We found we could not place

money first. For us, material well-being always followed spiritual progress, it never preceded." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 127) Our responsibility is to learn the principles given to us by those who came before, and to practice them. We can then show others how they have worked for us and how they have kept Alcoholics Anonymous united. In this way, we can be sure that we will receive the financial support that we need.

Mike Rogers, Kansas

Humility — Accepting the Group Conscience

At one time or another, we members of Alcoholics Anonymous have participated in a group conscience. In the perfect A.A. world, we would ask questions; we would pin down the presenter and try to get all the information available. Whenever we could, we'd take time to talk over the items with our sponsors, group members, and friends. We would pray for guidance. We may come up with additional questions, or we may consider a different point of view; but when all is said and done, we would take a few breaths, make a decision, and surrender.

We alcoholics are funny people. Many of us claim to hate authority figures. It is surprising when we find out that we quickly give ourselves over to authoritative posturing without even thinking about it. Members of a voluntary nonresident, self-help organization like Alcoholics Anonymous are typically ungovernable in any conventional sense. The techniques that may prove effective in government or business will quickly turn off a person who is only doing something because they feel it is right in their heart. When someone starts yelling, bossing, or criticizing openly, the volunteer is totally free to drop their tools in place and walk away. Many of us forget this simple fact and get drawn into exploring fantasies of what administrators and representatives do. This is particularly true when we acquire titles to describe our service functions. Many times groups that experience disunity through personality conflicts or through an uninformed conscience begin to conform to the will of the personalities instead of the principles.

Nearly fifty years ago, Bill wrote in Concept I "Throughout the entire world today we are witnessing the breakdown of 'group conscience.' It has always been the hope of democratic nations that their citizens would always be enlightened enough, moral enough, and responsible enough to manage their own affairs through chosen representatives. But in many self-governing countries we are now seeing the inroads of ignorance, apathy, and power-seeking upon democratic systems. Their spiritual resources of right purpose and collective intelligence are waning. Consequently many a land has become so helpless that the only answer is dictatorship." (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 2010-2011 edition, p. 8)

Though we members of Alcoholics Anonymous cannot be governed, we can be led or inspired toward what feels right in our hearts. This feeling of rightness is what many of us associate with the spiritual awakening. It is in this context that the concept of our Second Tradition becomes more obvious. Our only real authority rests with God, as He may express himself in our group conscience.

I sometimes think that participation in A.A. is all about talking when it is really about listening. My sobriety, and therefore my life, depends on my thinking of you and how I can help you discover or grow in this life-saving program. How can I help you if I am not listening to you? I can't hear you or my Higher Power's voice if I am so involved in getting my point across. It may mean listening to the person who has a different point of view. A good idea can come from anyone, anytime, but I need to be listening.

Maybe I need to practice the principle of humility, not that I know exactly what that means. Maybe it means that I am a small part of the great whole of Alcoholics Anonymous, and that A.A. must continue or most of us will surely die. Hence, our common welfare comes first.

Surrender to the group conscience begins with anonymity, the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. We are asked to give up personal desires for the common good. When we ask the question "What is right?" instead of "Who is right?" we begin to remove the personality of our groups and recognize that a loving God is our only ultimate authority. We no longer have to assume the awesome responsibility of being "boss of the world" or "master of all we see" or "the director." We should always remember that membership, in itself, ought to forever be the highest position attainable in Alcoholics Anonymous; that processes should always be democratic in nature; and when members should be consulted on matters that affect them.

During the remainder of this 61st General Service Conference, we will participate in A.A.'s largest group conscience. We will discuss and vote on matters that will affect A.A. worldwide. As trusted servants of Alcoholics Anonymous the Twelve Concepts have given us the Right of Participation, the Right of Decision, and the Right of Appeal. Let us practice these and all of A.A.'s principles in a spirit of love, tolerance, and humility. We are responsible for A.A.'s future — let it begin with us.

Frank Ziemba, Delaware

An Informed Group Conscience— Using the Three Legacies

We all know that Recovery, Unity and Service are the Three Legacies of our A.A. experience. Our leaders are but trusted servants, they do not govern. God, as He may speak in our group conscience, is our sole authority. And world service is the heart of our Third Legacy. I stole this from the A.A. Grapevine, July 1955, Vol. 12 No. 2.

Our Three Legacies in the group conscience are evidence of our spiritual principals in action! Our Twelve Steps are the Legacy of Recovery, evidence of the Twelve Traditions stand for the Legacy of Unity, and our Twelve Concepts represent our Legacy of Service. Service in A.A. is anything that helps us reach a fellow alcoholic. It could be anything ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a phone call and a cup of coffee, as well as A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. All of these services are examples of our Third Legacy.

Put them all together and they're the makings of a great life. Of course on occasion the principles that we hold near and dear can suddenly slip away from any of us, and can reflect negatively through us in a group conscience. As we utilize the Twelve Steps they allow us to grow and change, and as we work with others it changes who we are. We begin to feel that spirit of being responsible for the future of alcoholics everywhere. We feel responsible for preserving what was so graciously given to us. We begin to be very mindful of the Twelve Traditions that are the glue that holds us together. Putting our common welfare first, we try to ensure that no harm comes to Alcoholics Anonymous. My experience since has been to be mindful of the Twelve Concepts; they insure that we are all equal. We all have a voice. We reside under but one ultimate authority, that loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Here at the Conference we are the voice of A.A. Bill talks about wanting a "feel" of all of us in A.A. *Comes of Age*. We have been entrusted to participate and listen to make decisions on behalf of our beloved Fellowship. We are protected to appeal against any tyranny of the ma-

jority. Our co-founders created a delicate set of Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

I believe the group conscience is a great opportunity to practice Concept Nine. We can lead people into service; not drag, but lead. Most of us have been in a group conscience when the discussion got heated. We felt the relief when one of us stood up and said something that calmed the room. We have been in the group conscience when we voted and after the minority speaks the whole feel of the room changed and the vote swung the other way.

Through good leadership we can make sure that we have all of the information necessary to have an informed group conscience. Almost all of us had the experience of the vote going the opposite way that we wanted. These are the moments when we get to look closely at our other Legacies; work some Steps; take a good look at our Traditions. We must respect the group conscience in order to be an example of our Legacies in action!

I was raised in Alcoholics Anonymous by a wise woman. She taught me a lot of what I know today. Something she taught me was to carry on the resentment that she had with an assembly planning committee years ago. (I didn't recognize it then.) Mostly I just wanted to recover, but of course I wanted her to like me, so I set out to be the perfect student. The issue was that she didn't agree with the group conscience to have the little ribbons under our name badges. Her argument was that it implied that we were somehow better than other A.A. members. She felt it was dangerous to alcoholics and that it fed their egos, and her argument made sense to me. So there I was years later, representing my group as a G.S.R. at our area assembly. I was chatting with the delegate and he happened to ask, "Where's your ribbon?" I very proudly pulled out the resentment that had been gift-wrapped for me and explained all of my profound knowledge to our delegate, thinking I was just going to dazzle him. He simply looked right into my eyes and said, "It was the group conscience." Boy did I feel humbled! I felt like I had been hit right between the running lights. It was the same sensation that I have when the minority speaks and the hair all over my body stands up. Needless to say I have proudly worn the ribbon every since.

A few thoughts that I came across looking through the March 1971, Vol. 27, No. 10, of the Grapevine. Bill said "The Group Conscience of A.A. is a wonderful, though sometimes a fearful, thing. We have with us the conservatives, the liberals, and the radicals. The conservatives often put an end to many an unworthy project. But if they had their way entirely, almost nothing would be done. Sometimes they would rot us by preventing action. On the other hand, the radicals would quickly ruin us, if they had their way, by all sorts of actions that are no good. So the course of progress is somewhere down the middle. . . all of the influences, good and bad, are needed as spurs to progress."

So it is my belief that the Three Legacies are the equilibrium of the group conscience. They keep us right-side up and right sized.

Angela Heuer, Idaho

SPONSORSHIP

Pam Reising, East Central regional trustee, moderated the Presentations/Discussion session Tuesday afternoon.

Importance of a Home Group

Our literature tells us that the informed group conscience is the voice of A.A. because from it our trusted servants take their lead and input. Furthermore, our whole service structure is dedicated to supporting home groups in their efforts to carry the

message and to help new and old members participate in the miracle of Alcoholics Anonymous. Our literature goes on to state that a group's service work is where our group members "First experience the joy and growth that can be derived from A.A. service."

Since the home group is ground zero for our direction, our voice, and our leadership, are we providing an attraction to service beyond the group? I know many sponsors who declare that group service is the only form of service and General Service is merely politics. Is that accurate?

If that is not accurate, then what is the problem? The area of service where I have seen real difficulty is in General Service involvement. I have had opportunities to visit several area assemblies and I have consistently seen less than half of the registered groups represented. I have had chances to visit many groups and districts, and when it comes to service, the issue is not simply a lack of interest; it is absolute apathy. Why is this? Are we fulfilling our responsibility for A.A.'s future? Are we helping others to see that service is vital to our very survival? What can we members involved in service work do?

In evaluating what to do to responsibly support the A.A. groups, I have had many different thoughts. First, I found myself defensive at being labeled political, and then I got judgmental at the perceived apathy. Neither of these reactions addresses the issue, however. Instead, these would only deepen the rifts and further advance the apathy, so I thought about what works with alcoholics.

My first thought was sponsorship. Sponsorship has helped many people transition from active alcoholism to sobriety, so perhaps it would work in service work. However, the problem here is that in areas where service work is lacking, there seems to be a dearth of service sponsors. Events like the Regional Forum seem to work great at firing folks up and attracting them to service participation, but they often involve preaching to the choir. I have heard that service assemblies such as SWRAASA and NERAASA have generated interest and provided the steppingstone for new leaders to carry the message back to the A.A. groups. Could either of these be the answer?

So what are my conclusions? While some or all of these things might be part of the answer, the solution appears to lie with us, the members who are already involved in the general service structure. It seems that perhaps our future depends on the development of these types of activities not only on a regional level, but also on the area and district levels. More importantly, it appears that our future depends on our ability to both explain the importance of carrying the message outside of the home group and to do this in a way that generates interest in those who might join us.

To modify an A.A. principle, for our service leadership, we must attract people into service work rather than trying to promote them into involvement.

Tom Kepner, Mississippi

Leading by Example — Attraction Not Promotion

"I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible." This was written for the 1965 International A.A. Convention that was held in Toronto, and former General Service Board trustee, Al S. is credited as the author of the Responsibility Statement. In the souvenir book for the 1965 Convention, Dr. Jack Norris, Class A trustee and then chairman of the General Service Board, wrote: "We *must* remember that A.A. will continue strong only so long as each of us freely and hap-

pily gives it away to another person, only as each of us takes our fair share of responsibility for sponsorship of those who still suffer, for the growth and integrity of our group, for our Inter-group activities, and for A.A. as a whole. It is in taking responsibility that real freedom and the enduring satisfactions of life are found. A.A. has given us the power to choose — to drink or not to drink — and in doing so has given us the freedom to be responsible for ourselves. As we become responsible for ourselves, we are free to be responsible for our share in A.A., and unless we happily accept this responsibility we lose A.A. Strange, isn't it?"

We are all here because we have taken this message to heart and because we value and love this Fellowship so much that we use our time and talents to try to give back what we have so freely been given. For today, we are A.A.'s future, and it does begin with us. Given this responsibility we should ask ourselves if we are the kind of leaders that would attract others into service, or would we drive them away?

Whether we lead by being sponsors, chairing meetings, serving as G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, delegates, or trustees, we need to remember that just as we are sometimes the only example of the Big Book someone ever sees, in some ways, we may be the only *Service Manual* for some, and the introduction to the *A.A. Service Manual* for many. I believe I have to inventory my behavior as a trusted servant just as diligently as I conduct my Fourth Step inventory for my own personal recovery. I use tools such as the Traditions Checklist to assist in looking at how I serve the Fellowship. Do I serve in such a manner that others would want to participate? Do I act as a trusted servant, someone whose job it is to carry out the work that I am asked to do by my area and the groups within it, or have I taken a role where I am in charge and believe that everyone is there to serve me? Do I find the time to do what I am asked, or am I too busy to be of real service? Have I become a know-it-all, or am I constantly working to stay up-to-date and be aware of the consensus around me? Am I able to set aside my own preferences and desires to be helpful to others? Do I remember my place in the service triangle, or have I become the leader of the pack? Have I stayed connected and involved in my home group? In my district?

I view my opportunity here at the 61st General Service Conference as one of the greatest joys and honors that I have experienced and am so grateful to be a part of this event. I was awed at the love for the Fellowship that I felt in the room at the end of last year's 60th General Service Conference. To think how each of us was able to set aside any personal desires, or needs, to make sure the hand of A.A. is there whenever anyone reaches out. I was amazed at the amount of work that we were able to accomplish together because of our commitment to be of service. It was humbling to be among you, and to serve beside you, and I come back this year excited to get to the work at hand.

I ask God daily to help me be a humble servant and to do His will. My hope is that I live and serve in a manner that would encourage other members to want to be an active participant in the program and Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

"I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere reaches out for help I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And, for that, I am responsible." I have made a commitment to service work in Alcoholics Anonymous and to try to give back some of what has so freely been given to me, but what I find is that my debt continues to grow. I am given so much more than I ever dreamed possible. Thank you all for your commitment to this Fellowship, and for the leadership through love that you show me.

Mel Lawson, Western Michigan

Recovery, Unity, Service

My name is Cate, and I am an alcoholic, Panel 60, Area 80, Manitoba. I'm honored to share with you today on the topic of Sponsorship, but more specifically on Recovery, Unity and Service.

There is plenty of literature available in Alcoholics Anonymous, so I flipped through some A.A. pamphlets and picked up a few A.A. books, which I often do when seeking guidance, with hope that I would find something appropriate to this topic. I knew that Chapter Two in *A.A. Comes of Age* contained information about the Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous. . . Recovery, Unity and Service, so I decided to start there. The first thing I read was on page 52, and it was a quote from Bill W.'s talk on Recovery: "It is traditional in Alcoholics Anonymous that we do not make speeches; we just talk about our own experiences and the experiences of those around us." After reading that, I put away the books and the pamphlets and started over.

When I first started coming to A.A. meetings, there were a few things that were strongly suggested to me: go to a lot of meetings, get a Big Book, get a sponsor, and do the Steps. However, I had selective hearing when I was first coming around, and I was relatively sure that I heard you assure me that everything I needed to know was in the Big Book. Therefore, I was also relatively sure that I did not need meetings or a sponsor once I bought my Big Book. After careful alcoholic consideration, I decided all I really needed was the ability to read. So that's what I did, I bought my Big Book and I read. And I continued to drink. And life did not get any better. I eventually decided that perhaps I would need to try the meeting suggestion and the sponsor suggestion so that I could learn how to control my drinking.

I didn't really understand what a sponsor did and I didn't really know how to go about getting one, so I kept putting it off. I ultimately waited a bit too long, because finally one woman appointed herself my sponsor. I asked her what she would do as a sponsor. She told me that she would take me through the Steps and answer any questions I might have. I told her I was already doing the Steps. I told her which ones I had already done, which ones I might consider doing, and which ones really didn't apply to me. She said something very simple in response, which I remember clearly to this day. She simply said, "You don't do the Steps alone." I really didn't understand why at the time, but it has certainly become clear to me since.

We did go through the Steps in order. I know I didn't understand what I was doing as I was doing them, or why. But I did realize that, as we went through them, I wasn't drinking and at some point around Step Two, I discovered I no longer wanted to drink. The craving was removed. I know that, if left to my own devices, I could not have done the Steps the way we did them together. And when I was able to look back and see what we had done, I could understand why the Steps aren't meant to be done alone. I needed the guidance, patience and experience of a sponsor to show me the way.

In addition to taking me through the Steps she also helped me become a participating member of our group, rather than a member who just attended meetings. She got me involved and, along with many other members who I like to call my anonymous sponsors, made sure that I understood the importance of a commitment to the group, and the importance of understanding and following the Traditions. It was often hard for me to accept that the group conscience was always right and that my support was needed in order to maintain group unity.

Good sponsorship also helped my journey through service. I found that becoming immersed in the service structure was like learning a foreign language. At first I didn't know what questions to ask and for a long time I definitely had more questions than an-

swers. Without service sponsorship, which included a lot of loving encouragement in addition to the answering of many, many questions, the likelihood of me being effective or even remaining in service would have been highly doubtful. Service sponsorship showed me how important every service position was to the still-suffering alcoholic and knowing the importance of service gave me the strength to stick with it.

This is what I believe on the topic of Sponsorship: without a sponsor my recovery would have been precarious or nonexistent; I would likely not have been able to commit myself to a group and certainly not to a group conscience; and I couldn't support or be part of the unity needed within the group and within A.A. for their survival. Without the feeling and the spirit of unity that comes from being committed to a group and to Alcoholics Anonymous, I would not likely have had the willingness to get involved in the service that is absolutely essential to carry the message of recovery. And so it has been my experience that sponsorship is necessary to complete the circle of the Three Legacies of Alcoholics Anonymous: supporting recovery, encouraging unity, and providing service, so recovery can happen again.

The theme of this year's Conference is "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us," So what can I do? In recovery it is suggested that we remember we may be the only example of the Big Book that someone sees. In terms of sponsorship, it might help us to always remember to think, speak and act as if we were someone's anonymous sponsor, because we never know when and how the message gets carried.

Cate Wittig, Manitoba

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS IN A DIGITAL AGE

The final Presentation/Discussion session, on Thursday evening, was moderated by Andrea Barthwell, A.A.W.S. director.

Practicing Our Traditions in a Digital Age

When I received the invitation to talk about "Practicing Our Traditions in a Digital Age," I had just left a family funeral. My nephew-by-marriage had passed away, and the whole family was gathered in support of my niece. She had gone through a period in her late teens and early twenties when she was a total hellion. During that period, she had attended an A.A. meeting with me where she identified as an alcoholic and shared experiences that most alcoholics would relate to. Her four-year marriage seemed to stabilize her, but with her husband gone I am worried about her. I fear that in her grief she may start drinking and return to her old ways. Our Conference theme, "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us," really resonates with me. I'll do all I can to be responsible for A.A.'s future so that A.A. will be here for my niece if she ever needs us. And if the digital age makes it easier for her to reach out to us and for us to be there for her, then so much the better. Following are some of my thoughts on the subject:

Unity. Let's acknowledge that the Internet is potentially the greatest unifying communication tool in history, giving us the ability to communicate across geographic boundaries and to connect with people whom we may never meet face-to-face, and let's commit to using the Internet responsibly as a unifying force for our entire Fellowship.

Group Conscience. The digital age makes participation easier. The week of my nephew's funeral, while traveling to his memorial service, my cell phone helped me join the group conscience of a service committee that I would have missed otherwise. This type of convenience is especially helpful in areas with remote communities.

Welcome! We're glad you're here. The same day I received the invitation to give this talk I also received an e-mail with the subject line "Newcomer." Jocelyn, an A.A. member from Maine, had contacted a fellow southern California area delegate before moving to San Diego. He sent her a warm, welcoming message, a link to our Central Office Web site and he copied me on the message. I followed up with another welcoming message offering help. Later that day, through another e-mail, I was able to welcome the first deaf general service representative (G.S.R.) in our area.

Rule #62. How can we take ourselves seriously when long-forgotten friends are posting pictures of us from our high school years in various states of debauchery?

Carrying the Message to the alcoholic who still suffers. As I serve on the Conference Public Information Committee, I constantly consider ways to use our digital age to carry the message. Here's a great idea from the General Sharing Session, found on page three of the November 2010 Quarterly Report from G.S.O., regarding the www.aa.org Web site: "Have a woman or man telling their story of hope and recovery in an anonymity protected way to help the newcomer accessing the Web site." We are always at our best when we carry the message through our personal stories. I'd love to see this suggestion put into action.

Cooperation without Affiliation. Let's be sure as we develop our applications to deliver our A.A. content digitally that we keep this principle in mind.

Self-Support. Make your annual birthday contribution to G.S.O. through the "A.A. Member Contributions Online" tab on the aa.org Web site.

Nonprofessionalism and payment for special workers. I'll just pose a question here: Should we be paying our area webmasters a fee for their services?

Benign anarchy. Isn't that what the Internet is? Here's Bill on anarchy: "I think that the idealist who first advocated the concept felt that if only men were granted absolute liberty, and were compelled to obey no one, they would voluntarily associate themselves in the common interest." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 50)

No opinion on outside issues. This is a grey area. A.A. doesn't have any opinion on outside issues, "particularly those of politics, alcohol reform, or sectarian religion." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, 4th ed., p. 565). I can have an opinion on such issues, as an individual; I just can't share them "in such a way as to implicate A.A." We usually exercise an abundance of caution about this, restraining ourselves in the interest of unity. But on Facebook, it seems to be a whole other matter. Why is that?

Complete anonymity at the public level. A no-brainer. The Internet and social media are public, and Tradition Eleven applies. See A.A. Guidelines on the Internet.

Anonymity and humility. Again, I offer a question: How can we best use social media in a humble way? I don't know, but for the sake of A.A.'s future, let's see what we can do to lead by example.

Joel Castellaw, San Diego/Imperial California

Carrying A.A.'s Message Online

I've heard some A.A. members say that we might be the only examples of the Big Book some people will ever see. When Bill wrote "There is action and more action. 'Faith without works is dead,'" (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 88) I believe he was referring to the principle that our actions speak louder than our words. I have found this ideal to be true everywhere I go: in and outside of A.A. meetings, with my family, at work or school, and even online.

After I received the invitation to speak about Carrying A.A.'s Message Online, I went to the link found at aa.org for the On-line

Intergroup site. Since there are daily A.A. meetings within walking distance of my home, I didn't have any experience with a cyber-A.A. Fellowship. I felt like a newcomer again. I had to navigate the different types of meetings: e-mail, chat text, audio, video, telephone, and discussion forums. I read the link to the A.A. Guidelines on the Internet and the online intergroup pamphlet called "Getting Started in Online A.A.," and I jumped in. I signed up for an e-mail group, visited a chat/text group, and logged on to an audio visual group.

For the e-mail group, I sent a request to the moderator stating that I was a member of the Spiritual Basis A.A. Group and gave him or her my e-mail address. I received an e-mail right away that gave me access to their online discussion board. I also received an e-mail everyday that posts all the messages from the previous day. For the first week or so, I only read the messages. Just like when I started to go to A.A. meetings, I was shy. Gradually I started to reply to people's posts. One thing that bothered me was that people would sometimes post quotes from other twelve step fellowships, or religious texts. So the question became, how do I carry A.A.'s message online? Love and tolerance is our code, so *how* I handle this situation was just as important as the message itself. On the first page of the chapter "Working with Others" in the Big Book, it states "So cooperate; never criticize. To be helpful is our only aim." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 89) I brought up Tradition Ten as a discussion topic: "No A.A. group or member should ever, in such a way as to implicate A.A., express any opinion on outside controversial issues — particularly those of politics, alcohol reform, or sectarian religion. The Alcoholics Anonymous groups oppose no one. Concerning such matters they can express no views whatever." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 192) As with any A.A. discussion meeting, opinions varied but there were members willing to share their experience, strength and hope online. Just like a traditional face-to-face A.A. meeting, I felt responsible for following our Traditions, and standing up for them when they were being violated.

The online chat meeting was interesting. I went to an address where there were chat rooms set up for multiple twelve step fellowships. I didn't spend too much time reading the articles about addictive behavior, shopping at the gift store, or linking to the online recovery radio site where I could hear circuit speakers or listen to positive music. I clicked on the Recovery Chat Room link and went to one of the Alcoholics Anonymous meetings. There was a moderator for the meeting and about twenty-five people signed on. It was run similar to my neighborhood meeting: readings, people introduced themselves as alcoholics and were greeted and then thanked. The moderator requested a topic and we discussed it. If you had something to say you would type an exclamation mark and the moderator would call on you. Then you would type in your sharing, one line at a time, for five minutes. The meeting closed with a moment of silence and then people left the chat room.

The audio/video group I joined felt the most comfortable to me. I went to the hosting site, signed up for a handle, then went to the chat room on a certain day and time as instructed. I entered the password listed on the online intergroup Web site and there I was, sitting in my living room, streaming live, participating in an Alcoholics Anonymous meeting with A.A. members from London and Tokyo. We read from the book *Living Sober* and had a discussion afterwards. When the discussion about the reading was over, we discussed online A.A. One of the members was hours away from an English-speaking meeting when he reached out for help and got sober through chat rooms. I was amazed. When discussing how he got sober, he quoted directly from the Forward to the Fourth Edition, and said, "Modern-to-modern or face-to-face, A.A.s speak the language of the heart in

all its power and simplicity.” (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. xxiv).

This presentation does not even begin to touch on other ways we carry A.A.’s message online. Our Fellowship is navigating new waters regarding anonymity on social networking sites and whether or not it is appropriate to post A.A. business minutes online. In the past, most members did not hesitate to list their personal phone number on their home group’s flier, but now these fliers are posted on the World Wide Web, which is a public domain. Many A.A. members don’t consider that they may be jeopardizing other A.A. member’s anonymity when they send an A.A. announcement that lists twenty people’s e-mail addresses in the distribution. The A.A. Guidelines on the Internet and the October 2010 issue of the A.A. Grapevine address some of these issues.

Carrying A.A.’s message online, I received the blessing of sharing with A.A.s from around the world. Alcoholics Anonymous is a paradox: fervently grassroots and local, yet universal at the same time. The principles I apply in my local A.A. meetings are the same principles I apply to A.A. meetings online. The funny part about carrying A.A.’s message is that it is inherent to practice the principles at the same time. Step Twelve is written as if these are two separate actions, but in my experience, they are deeply rooted together.

A friend in A.A. once told me that it is fine to pray for people who are hungry, but it is a lot more effective if you give them food. Carrying A.A.’s message online is practicing A.A.’s principles in every aspect of my life. We are Responsible for A.A.’s Future — Let It Begin With Us.

Alicia Rosselot, Southwest Ohio

Grapevine — “A.A.’s Meeting in Print” and More...

I’d like to begin by thanking Adrienne for the loving invitation to present today on “Grapevine — A.A.’s Meeting in Print — and More.” Thankfulness wasn’t my first reaction when I saw that this was my topic. A.A. Grapevine has been the source of some controversy over the past few years, and I’m not always comfortable dealing with controversy. However, as I got more into the topic and had the opportunity to speak with some of the dedicated people who have an intimate knowledge of this subject, I became grateful to have this opportunity for learning. Each time I am forced to step out of my comfort zone, I grow.

Unlike many of the newcomers of today, I was made aware of both the existence and importance of the Grapevine from my very first meeting. I saw it on the literature table at each meeting and was guided to a Grapevine meeting right away. My first sponsor told me to attend a Big Book meeting, a Step meeting, and a Grapevine meeting each week. She said it was important to learn how to use all the tools A.A. had to offer.

It was probably two years or so before I ordered my own subscription to the Grapevine. I relied on being able to get it at the group instead. Since that time, I have been a steadfast subscriber for over twenty-nine years. In the interest of full disclosure, I should add that I don’t always read the Grapevine issues from cover to cover. I usually check out my favorite sections and then pick a story or two to glance at. Although I don’t always read the Grapevine, I do make use of the magazine by giving it to a newcomer at a meeting or giving it to my doctor for his waiting room.

I have given copies to my sponsor to use on her prison commitments, and I have purchased subscriptions to give as prizes at our area convention. The point I am trying to make is that I see great value in the A.A. Grapevine, even if that value is not always for my personal use. I still see it as an important tool for recovery.

Last year, I was privileged to participate in the Grapevine Survey as recommend by an Advisory Action of the 2010 General Service Conference. This year’s Conference Committee on the Grapevine will look at the results of that survey in greater depth than I can here. However, one thing that stands out is that an overwhelming 92 % of the 8,000 members who completed the survey said that it is important for the Grapevine to continue. This is even more remarkable when you consider that over 60 % of those responding were nonsubscribers! This should tell us that they, like me, see a great value in the Grapevine aside from their own personal use. In fact, 96 % of those responding state that the Grapevine is “very valuable.”

I spoke earlier of the controversy surrounding the Grapevine, so I should address that. We are all aware that the Grapevine has lost money over the last several years. The dollar amounts are large, and somewhat scary. No one disputes that. What we do disagree on is what to do about it.

At the heart of the financial difficulty for the Grapevine is the fact that its only source of support comes from paid subscriptions. Only six percent of our membership is buying those subscriptions. I am going to refer to that percentage as “those who want the Grapevine.” There is another group of members we should consider in this discussion. Let’s call them “those who need the Grapevine.” My sponsor tells me that whenever she takes my copies of the magazine into the prisons, they quickly disappear and are treasured by those who receive them. When I give a copy to a newcomer, they almost always tell me later how beneficial it was to them. I can’t say for certain what happens to the copies I leave with my doctor. I can tell you that they are never there when I go back for my next visit. I like to think that the magazine helped plant a seed for the person who picked it up.

For most of the members in the “those who need the Grapevine” category, buying their own subscription is not an option. For many of them, a digital version of the Grapevine is just as out of reach as the print version. The reality is that “for those that need the Grapevine,” it is not a luxury, it is a lifeline. In the early days of my recovery, I used to feel that the twenty-four hours between meetings was forever. Imagine if you had to wait a week or longer until your next meeting! These are the “alcoholics who still suffer” that we speak of in our Fifth Tradition. Are we to abandon them in their very real need because we haven’t found a way for the Grapevine to make more money? Perhaps what we need to abandon is our insistence that the A.A. Grapevine should be a totally self-supporting entity. Instead, we can begin to look at it as a mission-driven arm of our Fellowship, existing as a service to A.A. members.

I don’t intend to say that we should give up looking for ways to defray costs. We are responsible to practice prudence in our financial affairs. There are ideas on the table that could help; this Conference will consider some of them. There are other suggestions we could look at, such as having service pieces currently being mailed out by A.A.W.S. included in the Grapevine instead. This would include, but not be limited to, A.A.W.S. Highlights, *Box 4-5-9*, and *Markings on the Journey*. The Grapevine has the capability of doing this. A.A.W.S. could pay a printing fee to A.A.G.V. for this service, thus generating income for the Grapevine while also saving A.A.W.S. the costs of postage. A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine would remain separate corporations in cooperation with each other.

The Fellowship has spoken to us that the Grapevine should continue. Our responsibility for A.A.’s future is to find ways to make that happen.

Elaine McAndrews, Southern New Jersey

■ Reports from the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: As we start our busy week of discussions, let's each of us take a moment in our daily prayers and reflections to remember our fellow members in Japan, New Zealand, and the Middle East, and the challenges they face as they cope with the results of several recent, extraordinary disasters and turbulent societal upheavals. As you may be aware, we have been staying in touch with the G.S.O.s in Wellington and Tokyo. They know they have our loving support and our readiness to be of assistance where we can. The reality of the members in these countries has been altered perhaps for years to come, and yet we know they continue to carry the A.A. message of hope, even amidst the rubble of their towns and cities and in the face of personal deprivation and sorrow. This week, let us send a kind thought, a prayer, a blessing to our friends in these countries so that we are with them in spirit as we do the Higher Power's work here for our members in the United States and Canada. Would you join me in a moment of silent, loving unity with our Fellowship around the world? Thank you.

One of the highlights for all of us this past year was the celebration of A.A.'s 75th Anniversary at our International Convention in San Antonio. What an extraordinarily wonderful experience! There were 53,000 members, friends and family members attending. The careful planning by G.S.O., coupled with the electric enthusiasm of everyone in attendance, created a memorable and successful event. Members traveled from all over the world to join with us and their presence was a true testament to the dynamic power and universality of the A.A. message to help anyone, anywhere, to recover from alcoholism.

The 21st World Service Meeting was held this past October 2010 in Mexico City. Fifty-three delegates from thirty-two countries shared their experience, strength and hope with each other for a week. Jo-Anne Lowenberger and Don Massey, our trustees-at-large, were our delegates to this gathering. If you have not done so already, I would encourage you to read the Final Report of this World Service Meeting. You will see that A.A. is truly an international community and that we all share the same principles and encounter many of the same challenges.

Currently, the Big Book has been translated into sixty-one languages, including new translations into Tibetan; Amharic, the predominant language spoken in Ethiopia; and Saami, the language of Laplanders. Four translations are pending — one in Greek and three in the African languages of Twi, for Ghana; Luganda, for Uganda; and Xhosa, for South Africa. *Living Sober* has been translated into Croatian and *Came to Believe* was translated into Romanian.

In addition to the World Service Meeting in Mexico, our trustees and staff traveled abroad to share our experience with other countries including Greece and France. At the invitation of their General Service Board, Phyllis Halliday and I visited New Zealand where we met with several groups, trustees on their General Service Board, and attended their Conference.

Our General Service Board welcomed some new members. We've been joined by Class A trustees John Fromson and Michele Grinberg, and Class B trustees Rod Betonney and Donald Cusson. Joe Downey joined A.A.W.S. as the new nontrustee director and Michele Grinberg joined the Grapevine Corporate Board as a director.

We are privileged to have Ami Brophy as our new executive editor/publisher of the A.A. Grapevine. To say that she has been kept very busy with a variety of challenges would be an understatement. We are glad she is with us and providing us with her expertise.

At the General Service Office, Doug Richardson was promoted further down the A.A. service triangle to the management post of Director of Staff Services. Doug supervises the G.S.O.'s ten A.A. staff and works closely with Phyllis on numerous office projects. Rick Walker, who after doing a terrific job as the 2010 International Convention coordinator, succeeded Doug as staff coordinator and will also function as the G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site Services' point person.

The General Service Board has met four times since our last Conference. Aside from the members meeting of the board at the Conference last year, the trustees held two of their quarterly meetings at the Hilton Rye Town Hotel in Rye Brook, New York, and it's 2011 Winter Quarterly Meeting here at the familiar Crowne Plaza in New York.

Since the 60th General Service Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Saskatoon, Saskatchewan; Torrance, California; Trois-Rivieres, Quebec, and Myrtle Beach, South Carolina. An "Additional" Forum was held in the West Central Region in Rapid City, South Dakota. Finally, there was a Local Forum for Spanish-speaking districts that took place in Area 8, San Diego/Imperial California. All were attended by enthusiastic members interested in participating in A.A.'s Three Legacies.

One of the most significant projects undertaken this year has been the move towards the production of our own digital Apps so that we may provide the Fellowship with an e-Book version of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. There will be more presented about this project in the A.A.W.S. report.

At our trustees' Sharing Sessions, the Board spent a good deal of time discussing the Grapevine. Again, you will hear more about that topic when the Grapevine and Finance reports are presented. I did establish an Ad Hoc Committee of the General Service Board to identify areas of efficiencies for A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine; this committee will be making recommendations to the corporate boards and the General Service Board as their discussions move forward.

Following the example of the Conference, it is time for the General Service Board to do an inventory of itself and the two corporate bodies. I was pleased to appoint an Ad Hoc General Service Board Inventory Committee that will develop the inventory process and present a plan to the Board at its July meeting. A few items are already being forwarded to this Ad Hoc Committee; one is a review of the trustee emeriti attendance at our quarterly meetings and another is a letter regarding the composition of the General Service Board.

This past year might be called The Year of the Subcommittees and Ad Hoc Committees — we had on the order of twenty-five such committees of the boards in operation, not including the in-house G.S.O. and Grapevine committees and teams or the Conference Inventory Planning Committee and its various subcommittees. The board discussed the growing number of subcommittees and raised questions regarding the basic function of the General Service Board. Are we doing work that should be delegated to staff? Where should our primary efforts be spent? What is the role of the General Service Board and how does it relate to the corporate boards? These questions will, I am sure, also become part of the Board inventory in the coming year. On the subject of subcommittees, I must say a special thanks to the staff members who acted as secretaries to most of these committees and did exceptional work with coordinating background, agendas, reports, and the multitude of conference calls required to get the work done.

The upcoming week will be a rich and full one, I am certain. There are many important and exciting agenda items that you will

be considering. As trusted servants, delegated to act on behalf of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, your informed group conscience will not only guide and direct the boards and the offices in their work during the next year, but will set an example of leadership in service that will be a power of example to all members. May a loving God bless you in your endeavors!

Ward Ewing, D.D., chairman

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries.

A.A.W.S. directors include two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and the staff coordinator. Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: director of staff services, G.S.O. staff, chief financial officer, publications director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine.

Each year directors serving on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office (G.S.O.), and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors. The purpose of the publication activities and group services provided by A.A.W.S. and G.S.O., as requested from the Fellowship, is to support members' and groups' Twelfth Step service to reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 60th Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity, track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations related to A.A.W.S., review financial reports, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters.

The board utilizes the committee system to address extensive agendas, to gather background material, and to thoroughly consider requests. The board, in turn, discusses committee reports and votes on any recommendations presented by a board committee in these reports. In addition, each committee and the board as a whole conduct long-range and strategic planning. Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies).

Group Services — A net total of 1,896 new A.A. groups were listed at G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact receives A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step activities. In most instances, we have been meeting or exceeding our goal for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to have their new kits in-hand within 21 days of entering their information into the system.

Regional and Special Forums and Other Events — Throughout the year, G.S.O. staff members are invited to attend and participate in

many local and Area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips help provide information about G.S.O. to A.A. gatherings and help staff to gather local experience to add to other collected experience available from G.S.O. Since the 60th General Service Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff have participated in five Regional Forums: The Western Canada in Saskatoon, Saskatchewan, May 14-16, 2010; the Pacific Regional in Torrance, California, August 27-29, 2010; and the Eastern Canada Regional in Trois-Rivieres Quebec, September 17-19, 2010. A West Central Additional Regional Forum was held in Rapid City, South Dakota, November 12-14, 2010, and the Southeast Regional Forum took place in Myrtle Beach, South Carolina, December 10-12, 2010. In addition, there was a Local Forum for Area 08's Hispanic Districts held in San Diego on August 22, 2010.

Alcoholics Anonymous International Convention — Approximately 53,000 A.A. members, families and friends joined together to celebrate A.A.'s 75th Anniversary in San Antonio, TX from July 1-4, 2010.

25th Annual Intergroup/Central Office/A.A.W.S./A.A. Grapevine Seminar — As A.A.W.S. Board chair, I attended this event with G.S.O. Publications Department personnel and staff. The Seminar was held in St. Louis, Missouri, September 23-26, 2010, with 130 attendees from approximately 110 local offices.

14th Annual National A.A. Archives Workshop: Michelle Mirza, G.S.O. archivist, attended and presented at the 14th Annual National A.A. Archives Workshop.

International — Trustees and G.S.O. staff members also accept invitations from A.A. in other countries to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures. Highlights include: May 13-15, 2010, Warren Stafford attended the 20th Anniversary of A.A. in Minsk, Belarus. October 17-21, 2010, JoAnne Lowenberger and Don Massey, trustees-at-large, along with G.S.O. management and staff participated in the 21st World Service Meeting in Mexico City, Mexico. September 21 to October 4, 2010, G.S.B. chair Ward Ewing and G.S.O. general manager Phyllis Halliday traveled to New Zealand to observe that country's General Service Conference. April 15-18, 2011, Ward Ewing and Phyllis Halliday attended the General Service Conference of the Great Britain in York, England.

Financial — Complete audited financial details for 2010 are included in the Conference Manual and *Conference Final Report*. Here is an overview: G.S.O. had a net profit for the year 2010 of \$1,255,289, compared with a budgeted profit of \$1,007,995. This net profit is \$18,272 less than the \$1,273,561 profit reported for the year 2009. Net sales of \$12,183,911 for the year 2010 were approximately \$1,766,089 (12.7%) less than budgeted. Gross margin from literature sales was \$9,321,621, approximately \$858,379 (8.4%) under budget and \$521,655 less than 2009. Contributions received of \$6,408,421 were \$58,421 (1%) more than budgeted and \$112,311 (1.8%) more than the total for 2009. Total revenue for 2010 (gross profit from literature sales, contributions, and interest earned on cash flow) was \$14,273,404. Total revenue was about \$530,446 less than budgeted and \$259,267 less than in 2009.

Contributions Online — In June of 2010, G.S.O. implemented a system to allow A.A. members and groups to contribute to the General Service Board online by using a credit card or e-check. By the end of 2010, more than \$82,000 of contributions had been received electronically.

2011 Budget — The A.A. World Services Board approved the 2011 General Service Office budget; after review by the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee, the budget was approved by the General Service Board.

Publications — **Unit Distribution** — Distribution from G.S.O. of all books totaled 1,701,373 units for 2010. Big Book and *Twelve Steps*

and *Twelve Traditions* unit sales of all editions for 2010 were 886,873 and 363,669, respectively. Unit sales for these books in 2009 totaled 1,219,618 and 454,347, respectively. The 2009 figures reflect large orders received in anticipation of the July 2009 price increases. In 2010 A.A. purchases totaled 1,434,303 units (84.6% of total units). Purchases of items by non-A.A. individuals/entities in 2010 totaled 262,070 units (15.4% of total units).

International Convention Souvenir — A soft-cover edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* was the 2010 A.A. International Convention souvenir, and approximately 25,000 copies were sold.

eBook Project — The A.A.W.S. Board approved plans for G.S.O. to proceed with creating and distributing its books and other publications in digital form. Budget approval was granted by the General Service Board in January 2011. Infrastructure investment is expected to amount to approximately \$400,000, incurred over a two-year period. As a result, G.S.O. is developing the necessary technology infrastructure, and preparing A.A.W.S. publications in eBook format, in order to make them available for purchase and download online. The current project timeline calls for availability of the Big Book and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in English, French and Spanish in the second half of 2011. An overview of the eBook project will be presented to the 61st Conference.

International Translations/Copyright Activities — The Publications Department is continuing an extensive inventory of the status of documentation for A.A. literature in translation and licensed to other General Service Boards for publication. In March 2011, the board approved a revised translation policy. Recently completed translations include the Big Book in Amharic for use in Ethiopia, in Sinhalese for use in Sri Lanka, and in Saami for use in Lapland. *Living Sober* was translated into Croatian. The pending translation of *Alcoholics Anonymous* into Xhosa, spoken in South Africa, will bring the number of translations of the Big Book to 62.

Attributions — The A.A.W.S. Publications Committee reviewed the use of non-A.A. logos or trademarks on and in our literature and video products. The committee concluded that the existing long-standing A.A.W.S. attribution practice is consistent with customary publishing and media industry standards, and does not conflict with A.A.'s *Twelve Traditions*.

Reprint Requests — During the year 2010, A.A.W.S. granted permission/did not object to 122 requests to reprint from A.A. literature, and denied permission (including lack of authority to grant permission) to 51 requests.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site is the responsibility of the A.A.W.S. Board of Directors, acting through its Services Committee and in accordance with the *Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous*. The board approved Quarterly and Annual Web Site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. These reports detail requests for changes and additions to the Web site and how they are addressed. The annual report is provided to the Conference Committee on Public Information from the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

Online Literature in Translation — In response to a request from the Bali/Indonesia Intergroup, the board approved a procedure to add translated A.A. material in read-only format to a section of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site upon request from international A.A. entities in countries with no General Service Board structures. This literature would be viewable only through an Internet link from the Web page of the foreign A.A. entity requesting the link.

Web Site Planning — A committee consisting of G.S.O. management, staff and A.A. volunteers with Web site expertise was created to look at possible redesign of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in order to improve and expand functionality.

How to Find A.A. Meetings — The board approved a change to

the text on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site explaining how to access resources that provide local A.A. meeting information. The board also approved posting the content lists for the D.C.M. and G.S.R. Kits on the Web site, with links to material available online.

G.S.O. and Staff Operations — At year-end 2010, G.S.O. had 77 full-time employees, and five part-time employees. G.S.O. management, has begun the process of hiring a new A.A. staff member. The deadline for receipt of applications was April 15th. In June of 2010, a G.S.O. Employee Appreciation Picnic was held, providing a wonderful opportunity for camaraderie and employee recognition. On May 25, 2011, the general manager and the management team will hold an All Employees Meeting to provide service training, and discuss eBook implementation and other matters.

G.S.O. Visitors — In 2010, G.S.O. welcomed 2,114 visitors, including several groups ranging from 10 to 75 members. Many A.A. members traveled great distances to visit G.S.O. and to express their gratitude, in many languages, for their sobriety. One of the main highlights for members is a visit to the G.S.O. Archives where the welcoming Archives staff provides information and answers questions.

Archives — In 2010, renovations doubled the storage and working space for G.S.O.'s Archives. G.S.O. Archivist Michelle Mirza reported that, while she and her staff were reviewing and relocating material from basement storage to the new Archives' storage, they discovered an early scrapbook compiled by Jim B., the member credited with contributing the phrase "God as we understand Him" to A.A. Additional information about the vital work of the Archives is available in the G.S.O. Reports section of the Conference Manual.

George Martin, chair, A.A.W.S.



■ Literature Distributed — 2010

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	414,459
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	289,883
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	40,610
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	142,580
Daily Reflections	145,079
Daily Reflections (large print)	12,431
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	140,769
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	7,087
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	146,507
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	21,319
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	48,279
A.A. Comes of Age	9,476
As Bill Sees It	26,824
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	25,717
As Bill Sees It (large print)	5,048
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	7,249
"Pass It On"	6,943
Experience, Strength & Hope	10,773
Total	1,501,033

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	26,678
Living Sober	128,584
Living Sober (large print)	7,455
Came to Believe	49,952
Came to Believe (large print)	4,059
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	15,660
Total	232,388

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	12,476
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	22,534
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	33,538
A.A. for the Native North American	18,126
A.A. for the Woman	98,944
The A.A. Group	86,816
A.A. in Your Community	39,938
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	20,784
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	20,053
The A.A. Membership Survey	25,892
The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs	92,864
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	26,680
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	14,872
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	122,536
Circles of Love and Service	42,902
Bridging the Gap	25,501
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	14,890
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	13,767
Do You Think You're Different?	110,401
Questions About A.A.	217,183
Questions About A.A. (large print)	5,861
G.S.R.	39,771
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	16,368
How A.A. Members Cooperate	17,751
How It Works	63,217
If You Are a Professional	29,885
Inside A.A.	43,785
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	23,421
Is A.A. for You?	370,288
Is A.A. for Me?	86,711

Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	16,541
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	75,770
It Happened to Alice	36,450
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	39,965
The Jack Alexander Article	18,748
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	10,351
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	47,025
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	29,709
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	8,528
A Newcomer Asks	318,079
Problems Other Than Alcohol	97,678
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	279,550
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	16,188
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	32,482
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	63,504
Twelve Tradition Flyer	5,388
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	47,425
This Is A.A.	270,367
This Is A.A. (large print)	5,909
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	17,041
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	49,336
Too Young?	68,410
Understanding Anonymity	59,409
What Happened to Joe	38,257
Young People and A.A.	90,398

Total 3,500,263

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	261,453
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	30,466
Wallet cards-Anonymity	26,850
Anonymity Display Card	2,119
Parchment-scrolls	1,814
Placards	460
C.P.C. Workbook	1,489
Archives Workbook	518
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1215
P.I. Workbook	1,687
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,746
Treatment Facility Kit	466
Big Book on CD ROM	56
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	18
A.A. Guidelines	87,007
Group Handbook	2,702
Wire Racks	1,589
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	29
Audio CDs	778
DVDs	6,625
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	169
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	18
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cd album)	3,056
A.A. Comes of Age (cd album)	336
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	99
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cd album)	1,391
TV Public Service Announcement	292
Radio Public Service Announcements	221
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1417
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,358
Fact File	1,872
Table Top Display 12 & 12	446
Pioneers of A.A. (cassette album)	9
Pioneers of A.A. (cd album)	97
Living Sober (cassette album)	9
Living Sober (cd album)	474

Total 440,351
Grand Total 5,674,035

SPANISH

Books & Booklets

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	10,199
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	10,053
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	6,336
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous Large Print)	3,286
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,055
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,683
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	1,970
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	2,396
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	8,573
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	12,292
El Manual de Servicio de A.A./ Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	3,701
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	16,751
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	4,856
A.A. en Prisiones: de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	4,391
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	3,623
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	3,971
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	3,653
Total	103,789

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	7,587
Preguntas Frecuentes Acerca de A.A. (Questions About A.A.)	27,599
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	19,548
¿Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	54,210
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,342
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	3,376
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,754
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,022
Seamos amistosos con nuestros amigos (Let's be Friendly with our Friends)	1,217
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,099
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	11,213
Cómo Funciona el Programa (How It Works)	3,664
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	7,151
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,718
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	6,830
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	11,254
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	3,181
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	3,092
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	1,530
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	10,832
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	1,280

Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	10,883
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	1,888
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	5,439
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	4,723
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,863
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,030
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,849
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,587
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,030
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	6,823
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,236
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	1,584
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	9,423
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,730
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,212
¿Es A.A. Para Mí? (Is A.A. for Me?)	11,438
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	4,292
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,388
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	2,384
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,385
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,632
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,974
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A. Legacy of Service)	1,606
Si Usted es un Profesional (If you are a Professional...)	2,862
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine...Our Meeting in Print)	1,792
¿Demasiado Joven? (Too Young?)	1,329
Total	289,881

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	7,510
Parchments, Spanish	306
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	12,382
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	47
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cd album) (Big Book on cd)	841
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	17
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (cd album)	1,084
Total	22,187
Grand Total	415,857

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format relie)	4,300
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format souple)	1,412

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous—format poche)	822
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format relie)	1,797
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format souple)	848
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve—format poche)	1,242
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	326
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,037
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	3,487
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	402
Expérience, Force et Espoir (Experience, Strength and Hope)	346
Transmets-Le (Pass It On)	541
Total	17,560

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,506
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,016
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,102
Total	5,624

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	8,644
Foire aux questions sur les A.A.	2,039
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	7,845
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,910
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	478
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,027
Le membre des A.A. face aux médicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member—Medications & Other Drugs)	1,762
Les A.A.—Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	1102
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	425
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	3,042
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	808
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	986
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	583
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	1,107
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	752
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	891
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	871
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,315
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	334
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,316
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	796
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	3,512
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.	

(A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,444
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	245
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	696
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	561
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	358
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,949
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,401
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	2,176
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,387
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,512
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,781
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	560
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	2,056
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,057
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	541
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,071
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,497
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,421
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,968
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	2,178
AA pour l'alcoolique plus age (AA for the older alcoholic)	995
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,858
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	2,053
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	668
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,307
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	658
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	670
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,526
Total	81,139

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	1
12 & 12 (cd album)	516
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions	712
(Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,011
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	812
Carte Je Suis Responsable (I am responsible wallet card)	791
Video Cassettes	13
DVD	34
Notre Methode (How It Works)	8,665
Manuel de Groupe	26
Pochette de l'Information Publique	21
Pochette des Centres de Detention	6
Pochette de la CMP	6
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	96
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	9
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	146
Total	13,865
Grand Total	118,188

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is one of two operating corporations of the General Service Board and the multimedia publisher of Grapevine magazine content, available on various platforms and in a variety of formats, including print, digital, and audio at aagrapevine.org. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes La Viña magazine and its related books, CDs and audio formats. The General Service Board, as a service to the Fellowship, finances this Spanish-language publication.

The magazine and content relay the program in action through members' personal stories. Average monthly Grapevine circulation, in print and audio, was 93,104 in FY2010 against a budget of 92,000. The average bimonthly circulation of La Viña in 2010 was 8,741 against 9,300.

Based on the Grapevine's 2010 subscriber survey, it is estimated that the magazines are passed on to approximately 2.5 readers per copy, thereby reaching an estimated 233,000 readers per Grapevine issue and 22,000 through each La Viña issue. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. distributed 135,586 Grapevine and La Viña books, CDs, and other items, including the latest title *Spiritual Awakenings II*, the International Convention issue, the annual wall calendar and pocket planner.

By charter, the A.A. Grapevine Board consists of seven to ten directors. Traditionally there have been nine: two general service trustees; a Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; two regional trustees; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor/publisher. This year the General Service Board is bringing forward a slate of seven directors.

As a rule, the purpose of the Grapevine Corporate Board, an affiliate service corporation of the General Service Board, is to serve the A.A. Fellowship in the following ways:

- To oversee the publishing operations of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- To provide sound financial management of the corporation.
- To establish corporate policies and set corporate priorities.
- To engage in the ongoing process of strategic planning.
- To operate in accordance with the principles of A.A. as expressed in the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts.

The slate of Grapevine directors met thirteen times since the last Conference — four times as a Corporate Board; four times as a Planning Committee; and five special meetings. The fourth Planning Committee and fourth quarterly board meetings will be held during the 61st Conference. The directors also gathered in appointed committees to oversee the work of A.A. Grapevine, Inc. In 2009-2010, six ad hoc committees and one standing committee were active. The standing Nominating Committee, chaired by Dorothy Hurley, facilitated all facets in the selection of candidates for board openings. The Conference Advisory Survey committee, chaired by Ginger Rhoades Bell, oversaw the project and compilation of

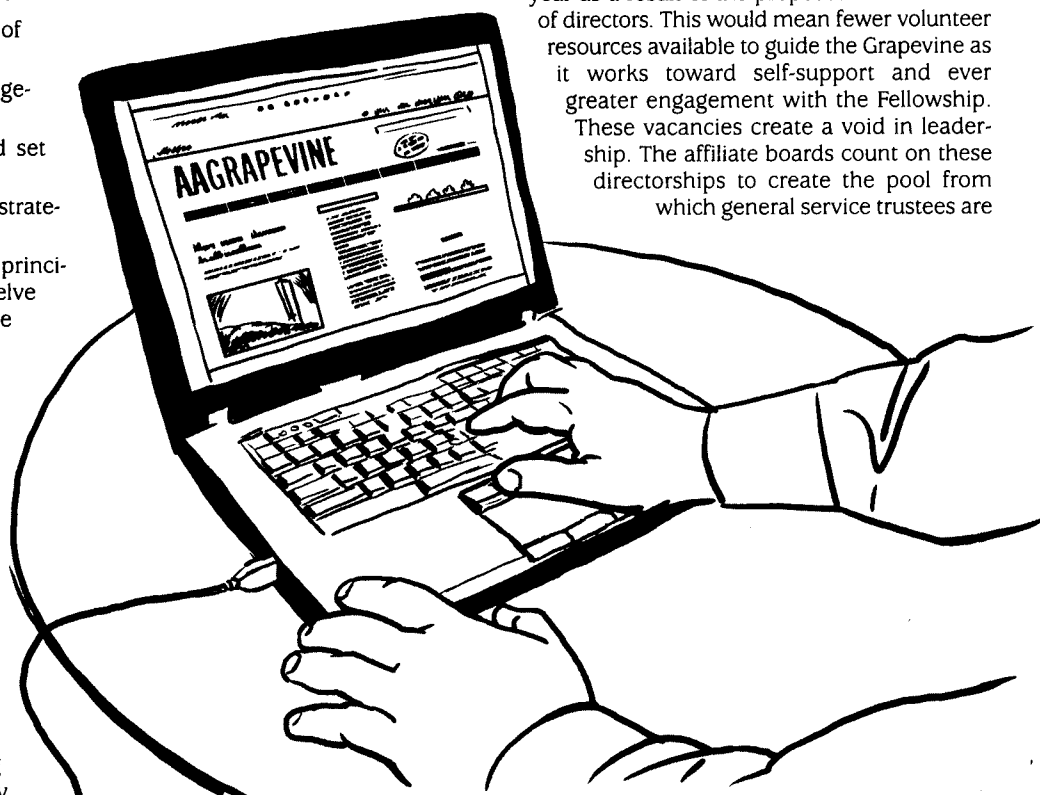
data gleaned from 9,735 survey respondents; the results will be provided at the 61st General Service Conference. The Search Committee focused on identifying the best possible executive to manage the corporation. The Finance and Budget, Personnel, Personnel Handbook, 2010 International Convention and Advisory Action ad hoc committees gathered for their dedicated work several times throughout the year. The Editorial Advisory Board, comprised of A.A. members with professional experience from publishing, public relations and related fields, supported the board and staff by convening in January.

In addition to work done in committees, the A.A. Grapevine Board focused on activities to enhance the communication with and beyond the Grapevine Conference Committee. The board also hired a professional publishing consultant to evaluate the corporation's strategic business plan and overall operations resulting in a management change. Grapevine's new executive editor/publisher, with 25 years of multimedia publishing experience, began in November.

The Grapevine Board also turned its sights to closing the deficit gap. Together with the trustees' Finance Oversight Committee, the Grapevine Board worked to remediate any negative cash balances and Reserve Fund drawdowns. Additional drawdowns are anticipated for 2011, contingent upon the outcome from Grapevine's proposed Conference Agenda items and the level of subscription support from the Fellowship.

A.A. Grapevine's staff cuts were accompanied by overhead reductions, including replacement of off-site board planning meetings with conference calls. A Shared Resources Committee is simultaneously exploring potential savings to be achieved by collaborative action between GV and A.A.W.S.

The board faces an additional challenge during the upcoming year as a result of the proposed reduced slate of directors. This would mean fewer volunteer resources available to guide the Grapevine as it works toward self-support and ever greater engagement with the Fellowship. These vacancies create a void in leadership. The affiliate boards count on these directorships to create the pool from which general service trustees are



selected. The full negative impact of this slate may not be fully recognized for several years to come.

Grapevine Financial Report — The Grapevine realized a loss of \$399,037, in comparison to a budgeted loss of \$245,743 for FY 2010.

This was below budget by \$153,294. Gross Profit on the magazine was below budget by \$151,846. This shortfall was due to Magazine Income being below budget for the following reasons:

1. Anticipated revenue for 2010 from the July 2009 price increase was unrealized (approx. \$176,000).
2. Changing subscription/product fulfillment vendor in order to expand digital capabilities and to correct prior fulfillment vendor problems. The conversion process resulted in a noncash write-off to magazine income (approx. \$67,000).

Some magazine revenue shortfalls were recovered through cost savings. Direct Costs of the magazine were below budget by \$91,984. This was due to reduced magazine printing costs against budget, as well as anticipated postal rate increases that were budgeted for but did not occur. Gross Profit on magazine-related items was below budget by \$90,933. Books and CDs were below budget across the board in line with the broader industries. However, gross profit on the special issue of Grapevine, a souvenir item for the International Convention in San Antonio, exceeded budget by \$23,614, or 40%. Costs and Expenses were under budget by \$96,586. Editorial costs of \$736,998 were under budget by \$101,254. Circulation and business expenses of \$1,058,525 were under budget by \$168,820. General and Administrative expenses of \$423,143 were \$173,488 over budget, mainly due to unbudgeted expenditures for professional fees and severance pay.

La Viña Financial Report — La Viña is published by A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and funded by the General Service Board. Bimonthly circulation of La Viña averaged 8,741 in 2010. Gross Profit on the magazine was \$28,642, which was over budget by \$5,541. Gross Profit on La Viña related items was \$22,680, which was \$2,116 behind budget. Costs and expenses for the year were \$126,802. This was under budget by \$11,653. The Net Loss for 2010 was \$75,481 against the budgeted Net Loss of \$90,558. This was primarily attributable to budgeted yet unspent Selling Expenses.

A.A. Grapevine and the Reserve Fund — A.A. Grapevine makes deposits to the Reserve Fund, and also places paid subscriptions in the Reserve Fund to cover future costs. As of December 31, 2010, the amount held in the Reserve Fund for these paid subscriptions totaled \$1,778,500. Neither the A.A. Grapevine nor A.A.W.S. may accumulate funds or borrow money to fund strategic projects. Occasionally, over the years, A.A. Grapevine, like A.A.W.S., has turned to the Reserve Fund to fund special projects and/or to replenish operating capital, such as for updating the technology infrastructure and funding the operating deficit last year. Total drawdowns for 2010 were \$588,000.

A.A. Grapevine is designed to be editorially independent and self-supporting solely via subscriptions and sales of other items. It does not receive support through contributions or external funding, nor does it sell its products through outlets outside of A.A. The Grapevine Board has submitted actions addressing this challenge.

A.A. Grapevine has, since its inception,

been committed to making the magazine available to as many people as possible. Subscription prices have been kept artificially low, lagging behind increased costs. Overhead has increased dramatically, especially for postage, rent and pension funding. Last year's rate increases began to address rising costs of production but more work is needed.

With Grapevine's penetration (including pass-along) to the U.S. and Canadian membership at 26%, there is great potential for growth. To survive, Grapevine must change along with all other magazine and book publishers as content consumption habits change. Grapevine's majority reader profile: a 50-year-old, white male with 20 plus years of sobriety, can be seen as a mandate to grow and to serve a wider, diverse membership.

Going forward, the print publication will be retained for those who want or need it in this format *while* offering content in ways the broader membership wishes to receive it. Our first step was the digital magazine, providing Grapevine and La Viña readers access to the magazines via computer, tablets or smartphones. The page-turning technology offers readers an exact reproduction of the print product digitally as desired. Reserve Funds facilitated the relaunch of AAGrapevine.org, updated by a content management

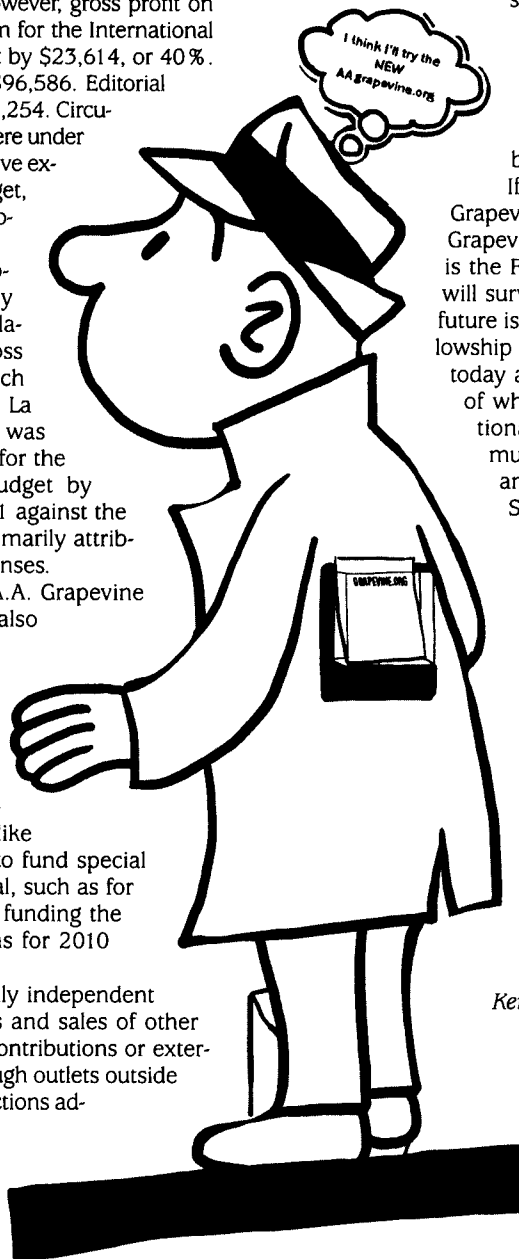
system that will allow for easy and weekly refreshing of stories. The site is designed to serve the Fellowship better as a community and to engage a wider, varied and younger audience. The new design will allow for easier navigation and member interaction and involvement.

If "carrying the message" is at the heart of Grapevine, then self-support is its life-blood. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. belongs to the Fellowship, and it is the Fellowship that must decide if Grapevine will survive and how it will survive. Grapevine's future is in the hands of the Fellowship. If the Fellowship wants Grapevine and La Viña to be here today and in the future — for alcoholics, many of whom don't know about A.A. yet — additional subscribers and the service structure must commit to supporting A.A.G.V., Inc. as an integral part of our program and Twelfth Step work.

Let's ask ourselves: Is the new A.A.G.V. relevant? Is there a need for it? Does GV carry the message of A.A.?

If any answer is yes, Grapevine and La Viña must be supported to reach out as far as they can so that the message is there for shaky newcomers, still-suffering alcoholics and others. A.A. Grapevine has served the Fellowship for 65 years. The International Journal of A.A. has changed with the times, while adhering to its mission of carrying the message of A.A. to alcoholics and uniting us in recovery and service to the program that has given us a new life and the responsibility to share the message with those that ask.

Ken Brueggemann, chair



Books

Best Of Bill (Hard Cover)	2,498
Best Of Bill (Soft Cover)	6,620
Best Of Bill—Large Print (Soft Cover)	1,047
Best Of Bill—French (Soft Cover)	1,357
The Home Group—French (Soft Cover)	498
Le Langage Du Coeur	500
Best of the Grapevine I (Soft Cover)	647
Best of the Grapevine II (Soft Cover)	388
The Language of the Heart (Hard Cover) 3,857	
The Home Group	-
El Lenguaje del Corazon	1,880
Best of the Grapevine III (Soft Cover)	505
A.A. Around the World	563
The Language of the Heart (Soft Cover)	2,431
Thank You For Sharing	739
Spiritual Awakening	4,413
The Home Group Revised (Soft Cover)	1,501
I Am Responsible: The Hand of AA (Soft Cover)	1,271
Emotional Sobriety (Soft Cover)	8,147
Language of the Heart (Large Print)	439
In Our Own Words	2,706
Beginners Book	7,387
Voices of Long-Term Sobriety	3,243
A Rabbit Walks Into a Bar	6,312
Spiritual Awakening II	3,403
Best Of Bill—Spanish	2,922
Lo Mejor de la Viña	1,047
El Grupo Base	1,223
Total:	67,544

Cassette Tapes

Total: 108

CDs - English

Sub-Total: 6,971

CDs - Spanish

Sub-Total: 4,338

Totals: 11,309

Miscellaneous

Facsimile of First Grapevine	298
Slogans—French	110
Victor E. Poster—French	—
AA Preamble	505
Grapevine Binder	348
Man on the Bed	1,179
Slogans	974
Serenity Prayer	2,008
Victor E. Poster—English	111
Wall Calendar	7,125
Pocket Planner	8,457
Grapevine Workbook	21
Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	1,137
French—Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	83
Traditions Checklist	484
Victor E. Poster—Spanish	27
Spanish—Preamble	182
Spanish—Slogans	208
Spanish—Serenity Prayer	609
Spanish—Tradition Checklist	712
Special Convention Edition Issue—English	27,757
Special Convention Edition Issue—Spanish	3,484
Special Convention Edition Issue—French	805

Total: 56,624

Grand Total: 135,585

	APRIL 2011	APRIL 2010	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	715	732	(17)
Alaska	474	492	(18)
Arizona	1,577	1,668	(91)
Arkansas	469	515	(46)
California	8,220	8,516	(296)
Colorado	1,748	1,707	41
Connecticut	1,293	1,378	(85)
Delaware	386	397	(11)
District of Columbia	179	166	13
Florida	4,759	4,795	(36)
Georgia	2,054	2,278	(224)
Hawaii	439	479	(40)
Idaho	595	656	(61)
Illinois	2,911	3,158	(247)
Indiana	1,282	1,313	(31)
Iowa	896	937	(41)
Kansas	958	967	(9)
Kentucky	813	762	51
Louisiana	696	726	(30)
Maine	541	507	34
Maryland	1,203	1,160	43
Massachusetts	2,312	2,290	22
Michigan	2,733	2,855	(122)
Minnesota	2,202	2,301	(99)
Mississippi	384	435	(51)
Missouri	1,354	1,398	(44)
Montana	546	600	(54)
Nebraska	745	779	(34)
Nevada	812	575	237
New Hampshire	668	628	40
New Jersey	2,621	2,528	93
New Mexico	580	652	(72)
New York	4,905	4,959	(54)
North Carolina	1,955	2,117	(162)
North Dakota	316	310	6
Ohio	2,232	2,382	(150)
Oklahoma	699	788	(89)
Oregon	1,451	1,417	34
Pennsylvania	4,995	4,730	265
Rhode Island	326	346	(20)
South Carolina	888	870	18
South Dakota	339	350	(11)
Tennessee	975	1,101	(126)
Texas	3,470	3,638	(168)
Utah	508	545	(37)
Vermont	349	346	3
Virginia	2,063	2,001	62
Washington	2,691	2,830	(139)
West Virginia	410	338	72
Wisconsin	2,147	2,326	(179)
Wyoming	246	266	(20)
Puerto Rico	23	27	(4)
U.S. Possessions/APO	74	82	(8)
Virgin Islands	48	43	5
Subtotal US	78,275	80,162	(1,887)
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	857	868	(11)
British Columbia/YKN	1,011	1,043	(32)
Manitoba	343	425	(82)
New Brunswick/PEI	231	258	(27)
Nova Scotia/			0
Newfoundland/Labrador	328	400	(72)
Ontario	3,029	3,155	(126)
Quebec	233	284	(51)
Saskatchewan	357	390	(33)
Subtotal Canada	6,389	6,823	(434)
FOREIGN			
	950	1,107	(157)
Grand Total	85,614	88,092	(2,478)

LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*

Mar./Apr. 11	Mar./Apr. 10	Diff.
6,165	6,623	(458)

(*does not include monthly orders)

■ Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Archives committee is responsible for developing and implementing the policies that govern the Archives services and makes recommendations to the General Service Board on Archives procedures and budget. Through its group conscience, and guided by A.A.'s principles and professional standards, the committee reviews all requests for the use of the Archives from in and outside the Fellowship. Since the 2010 General Service Conference, the committee has met three times granting permission to twenty-one researchers for use of archival materials. All applications for access are carefully considered through recommendations from the Archivist and established policies. In response to a 2010 Conference Archives Committee Additional Consideration, a subcommittee was formed to revise the section, "Role of the Archives Committee" in the Archives Workbook, to include activities for local Archives committees. The subcommittee solicited sharing from local archivists. The new subsection entitled, "Tools and Suggested Activities for Archives Committees" will be presented to the 2011 Conference Archives Committee for review.

The committee reviewed the Archives current policy on materials marked "classified" and restricted from public examination, and noted that this policy was developed in 1975, with a time limit of twenty-five years, which has now expired. Furthermore, the policy is inadequate and does not reflect current professional practices. A subcommittee was formed to explore the existing policy and classified materials, as well as to develop a new policy to regulate use of restricted materials. The committee approved the new policy on Classified Records, which adequately balances the researcher's need for access, while still acting within the spirit of the Fellowship's tradition of anonymity, privacy regulations and other significant limitations.

During the last year the committee discussed the practice and procedure of electronic signatures on the Archives' "Research Application Form" and "Sound and Film Application Form." We consulted with legal counsel and agreed to add an "I Agree" box following the Indemnity Statement, which allows signatures submitted electronically to be an acceptable form of consent to the terms and conditions outlined in the policies. The committee received extensive reports from the Archivist that included a graphic chart reflecting research responses for the last decade, ongoing preservation efforts, Web site developments, and a summary of projects completed in 2010 and 2011 projects. At each of its quarterly meetings, the committee noted the outstanding work of our Archivist, Michelle Mirza. Although she is the fifth person to serve as our Archivist in A.A. history, she is only the third professionally trained Archivist. The Fellowship is fortunate to have someone with her experience, qualifications, and dedication managing and protecting our invaluable archival collection.

Dorothy Hurley, chairperson

Staff report: The General Service Office Archives has an ongoing commitment to preserve the official records of Alcoholics Anonymous so that there can be no distortion of our history, and also to support academic and scholarly research. It is our responsibility to ensure that the original message of recovery, unity and service is not distorted as our Fellowship progresses into the future. We provide service to those who are interested in learning more about A.A.'s historical legacy, as well as to archivists within the Fellowship. In 2010 we responded to over 1,600 requests for information, utilizing a combination of unpublished primary sources and published material maintained in the repository. We welcomed over 80 new archivists and committee chairs and extended assistance and

support whenever possible.

The Archives area at the San Antonio International Convention was an outstanding success. The specially designed exhibit was well-received, along with the special issue of *Markings*, the Archives newsletter. The exhibit area featured two pods that included historical imagery, used to demonstrate the consequences of drinking before Alcoholics Anonymous; images illustrating the beginning of our story in Akron and New York; the remarkable efforts and challenges that preceded the publication of the Big Book; and a history of all previous International Conventions. There was a special display on the history of A.A. in San Antonio and other displays showing local A.A. histories in a variety of presentation styles: published booklets, pamphlets, leaflets and binders. Our visitors listened to voices from the past on audio listening stations and accessed the A.A. Timeline from a web portal. We also had a theater room featuring the Archives film, *Markings on the Journey*, which was filled to capacity throughout the extent of the Convention. Letters were sent to all the International Convention Archives volunteers, thanking them for their dedicated service in assisting our numerous visitors and tirelessly answering their questions.

We are continuing in our mission to build a comprehensive catalog of the extensive Archives audio collection. This is a multiple-phase project that involves listening to thousands of audio recordings arranged in particular series. In 2010 we completed the "Bill W." series, which consists of recordings of Bill at various events. The recordings offer an accurate testimony about Bill's experience and A.A.'s development. It reveals decades of unsolved mysteries and other valuable information from the receding tide of the past. As Bill wrote in a letter to John P., dated July 1954, "*I used to be rather against a lot of recordings being made of me, lest my part in A.A. be over-emphasized. But I now see that these records are of great help, particularly to outlying groups. Respecting the history of A.A., I have been collecting material for a long time. A good deal of this has filtered out in many talks about the country and could be re-assembled if I never get around to doing it...So you needn't worry, the story won't be lost.*"

We preserved, processed, and arranged several collections, including the papers of Dr. John Norris, trustee emeriti; organized and indexed the extensive magazine collection, which goes back to the 1930s; and refined the Slide collection index. We are utilizing new software to maintain the extent of the collections. Last year we migrated over 2,800 records from the Library catalog and over 400 records from the Film Collection. We published four issues of the Archives newsletter, *Markings*, in 2010. Articles in the newsletter focused on providing professional assistance to local archivists, as well as historical pieces such as the development of the Twelve Traditions, the history of Spanish translations of A.A. literature, and area and group histories. Our subscriber list has continued to increase as *Markings* gains interest nationally; it is distributed electronically to over 6,800 recipients.

In November 2010 the Archives observed its 35th anniversary since its auspicious opening. To observe this anniversary, we hosted an Open House earlier in the year, which was well-attended by both G.S.O. and Grapevine employees. We created special displays, gave tours and imparted knowledge about what G.S.O. archivists do.

Finally, the Archives continued to enrich its collection of treasures received from members and friends, including early printings of A.A. books and other A.A. related material. We were particularly fortunate to receive an original September 1939 edition of "Your Faith" magazine that included an interview with Dr. Bob. We extend gratitude to those who have generously donated items in the past twelve months.

Michelle Mirza, archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed by the General Service Board in 2003, is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The Audit Committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

John Kane, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of at least four trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The Compensation Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

Don Miller, chairperson

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 61st General Service Conference, "We are Responsible for A.A.'s Future — Let it Begin With Us." We also discussed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires and a Post-Conference Sharing Session that included suggestions for improving the flow of the Conference in order to allow sufficient time for committee reports and Conference business. The committee agreed to the following changes:

- a. The General Service Conference begins on Sunday morning.
- b. The trip to the G.S.O./Grapevine Offices on Tuesday is scheduled for every other year, alternating with the visit to Stepping Stones on Saturday. In 2010, Conference members visited Stepping Stones and in 2011 they will visit the G.S.O. and Grapevine Offices.
- c. The Remote Communities Meeting, which is not part of the General Service Conference week agenda, will meet on Saturday.
- d. Committee reports begin on Wednesday afternoon rather than Wednesday evening.
- e. A full Archives presentation is scheduled for every other year.
- f. A revised Floor Action procedure has been implemented.
- g. A presentation/discussion topic is scheduled for the Sunday afternoon session.
- h. The International presentation was moved to Sunday. In the year after a World Service Meeting (WSM) is held, the second term W.S.M. delegate (trustee-at-large) will present a report on the World Service Meeting. By moving this segment to Sunday, an additional half hour is allotted for committee reports.

Additionally, the committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Agenda a request to consider reducing the number of presentations/discussion topics planned for the 2012 General Service Conference.

Workshop questions for the 61st General Service Conference were approved for distribution in the Communications Kit that was mailed in December 2010. The committee reviewed and approved the revisions to the 61st General Service Conference Evaluation Form, and also requested that the trip to G.S.O. and the Grapevine Office be added to the Evaluation Form. We also reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2011. Forty items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference Committees, or to the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards. This total does not include any items that may have been submitted directly to committee secretaries or to the two corporate boards.

A.A. Peru and A.A. Great Britain requested that trusted servants of their respective service structures attend the 2011 General Service Conference as observers. The committee approved the requests and forwarded the request to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. The committee also agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions a request that a formal relationship be developed between the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions and the trustees' Conference Committee in order to address matters of policy relating to the Conference.

The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Agenda Committee a request that the trustees' Conference Committee meet annually with the Conference Committee on Agenda and the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions to address matters concerning the Conference Agenda and Conference Policy and that these meetings take place prior to the January General Service Board meeting. It is expected that the Conference Agenda Committee address only that portion of the request that pertains to the Conference Agenda Committee.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the phrase "Requires a second" be added to the procedure for Floor Actions in the document "How the General Service Conference Operates/Summary of Conference Procedures" so that it reads: When a floor action is to be heard, its maker will be given two (2) minutes to state the rationale behind the action, after which the chair shall ask if there is a motion that the Conference decline to consider the floor action. A motion to decline to hear a floor action:

- Must be made without comment.
- Requires a second.
- Is not debatable.
- Requires a two-thirds majority.

The committee took no action on the following proposed agenda items:

We discussed at length a request to establish guidelines for the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee to communicate and interface for approval of any/all proposed General Service Conference agenda items. It was the sense of the committee that the process currently in place for the review and disposition of agenda items is effective in allowing the Conference to conduct its business.

The committee considered a request "to specifically bar and prohibit the use of the decline to consider procedure" related to Floor Actions and agreed that as the revised Floor Action procedure was only instituted at the 60th General Service Conference; we would like to see the procedure utilized by the Conference for a few more years to determine its effectiveness.

The committee discussed a proposal that "any modifications to

A.A. Conference-approved literature, excluding *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* and the *Final Conference Report*, be reviewed by the Fellowship prior to being reviewed by the assigned trustees' committee" and a proposal "that an appeal process be developed whereby rejection of an agenda item by a trustees' committee would be appealable to the General Service Conference." The committee noted that the proposed Conference Inventory Plan, which may be adopted by the General Service Conference, will include specific inventory questions that will provide an opportunity for discussion regarding procedures for changes to Conference-approved literature and the agenda selection process.

We discussed at length a request that each Conference committee have an agenda item specifically designated for review of past Advisory Actions for compliance, outdated actions, and/or items not in practice. The committee felt that each Conference committee already has, as an annual agenda item, a review of its History and Actions; if an action is deemed outdated or inconsistent with a current practice, specific suggestions regarding a possible change can be brought to the attention of the appropriate committee.

Also discussed was a request to extend the length of the General Service Conference schedule and noted that changes were made to allow more time for committee reports and Conference business.

The committee considered a suggestion to prioritize Conference agenda items and agreed that each Conference committee is autonomous and is able to manage and address proposed agenda items.

Vic Phillips, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the summer edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Adrienne Brown

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. In August of 2009, the trustees' committee expanded its scope to include service to Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees and oversight of Special Needs literature. At that point, the title of the committee was changed to Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. To that end, the committee agreed to add to their Scope the following phrase: "Maintaining an interest in the changing attitudes within the professional community regarding Alcoholics Anonymous, providing the tools through A.A.'s publications and other strategies to reach the professional community/treatment facilities with an interest in fostering the kind of attitudes which allow A.A. to better reach the still-suffering alcoholic."

Among the many tasks completed this past year, in response to their scope, the committee:

- Worked with the Publications Department to add an option to the *About A.A.* postal card that invites professionals to request contact with local committees and to add language to the C.P.C. Workbook regarding the use of the C.P.C. video "A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community."
- Reviewed and accepted the following revision to the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous": replace "drying-out" with the words "detox, rehabilitation" in the section "What A.A. Does Not Do."
- Reviewed a draft service piece about use of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in C.P.C. endeavors, which included shared experience from Class A trustees, and forwarded it to the 2011 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for consideration.
- Reviewed the 2011 Exhibit schedule at 30 national professional, as well as the 2010 exhibit evaluations. Offers to exhibit at national professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions who may be interested in A.A. as a resource and on new geographical locations. Trustees' committee members contacted the secretary with suggestions for future national exhibits.
- Considered suggested additions to the C.P.C. Workbook and Kit and forwarded them to the 2011 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for review. These consisted of a sample guide letter for healthcare professional school administrators and a list of goals and project suggestions for C.P.C. committees.
- Forwarded to the 2011 Conference C.P.C. Committee the concept of a C.P.C. literature compilation CD/DVD with background, noting that this information is readily available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and the item would be redundant.

Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities — The Treatment Facilities Workbook underwent an extensive review to change the language throughout the Workbook to reflect inclusivity of a wide variety of treatment settings, as well as to include shared experience from a Treatment Facilities Committee regarding carrying the A.A. message into outpatient treatment facilities.

The committee forwarded to the 2011 Conference Committee

on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities a requested report regarding changing "Treatment Facilities" Committee to "Treatment" Committee in committee titles and in A.A. literature.

A three-ring binder format was developed for the Special Needs-Accessibilities Kit to achieve parity with other service committee Kits.

Eleven stories were selected from 42 submissions for the proposed recovery pamphlet for alcoholics with special needs, with three of the eleven being of A.A. members developing a disability after achieving sobriety, and a draft pamphlet was forwarded to the 2011 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

Conley Byrd, chairperson

Staff Reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an "open" A.A. meeting. The staff member on the Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2010, 496 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Hundreds of other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. is the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* Two issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2010. The Spring issue featured an in depth article that explored A.A. as a resource for drug and alcohol court professionals. The Winter issue focused on how A.A. cooperates with professionals and highlighted sharing from professional friends of A.A. who were presenters at the 2010 International Convention. Currently, more than 9,000 professionals receive *About A.A.* About one third of the list receives the newsletter via A.A.'s Digital Delivery system.

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 28 national or international conferences of professionals in 2010. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space, display and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. Thousands of professionals in a broad range of fields visited the A.A. booth at these national events. In the interest of extending the hand of A.A. to all who suffer, each year some Public Information events are also included such as the NAACP and LaRaza. In addition, 40 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees. G.S.O. furnished C.P.C. material for several exhibits and events set up by local committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities have created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Mary Cumings

Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities — Beginning in July 2009, the task of communicating with Special Needs-Accessibilities service committees within the A.A. Fellowship has been given a permanent home on the Treatment Facilities assignment. While each type of service committee addressed by the assignment may strive to carry the A.A. message of recovery from alcoholism to different populations of alcoholics, the overall purpose of the Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment is to share A.A. and service committee experience and information through literature, activity updates and other communications with these distinct committees. The assignment currently communicates with: area and district Treatment Facilities (TF) committee chairpersons, area and district Bridging the Gap (BTG) committee chairpersons, area and district Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons, and area and district Special Needs-Accessibilities committee chairpersons.

Communication with these trusted servants begins with a welcome letter from the assignment coordinator, along with some of the service materials that might be helpful as the committee chair starts out in the new position. While physical materials are still sent through the post, the new trusted servants are also directed to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site (www.aa.org) where A.A. Guidelines, service committee Workbooks, and other service materials may be read and/or printed directly from the service committee "buckets." In addition, all area level service committee chairs receive a list of other area level service committee chairs to facilitate sharing experiences and activities.

During their term of service, area and district chairs receive updates on other committees' activities thorough articles in *Box 4-5-9*, and receive updates from the assignment coordinator that may contain ideas, activities, questions and solutions from other committees. These assignment updates also contain items of interest from the General Service Office, requests for sharing on a particular question when appropriate, and efforts to address possible areas of confusion.

Correspondence from newly sober clients in treatment centers, and from professionals in those facilities, is always welcome. In addition, communication is received from alcoholics with special challenges (blindness, deafness, brain injury, etc.) asking for A.A. literature in a format that they can understand. Each of these receives a response from the staff member, with as many as possible linked as well to an A.A. member or committee in the Fellowship who can serve as an additional resource.

The staff member on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

In addition, the staff member on this assignment coordinates the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)* — a vital means of sharing for a spectrum of nonincarcerated A.A. members who are not

able to attend A.A. meetings either because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance, or because they are not able to leave their place of residence to attend a meeting. In addition to not having access to English-language A.A. meetings, *LIM* participants need to: 1) read and write English; 2) provide a permanent mailing address; and, 3) be willing to share experience, strength and hope via letters, tapes and/or e-mail.

The *LIM* membership waxes and wanes a little every month, as participant circumstances change, but the total number of participants stays at around 500. When Loners move back to a country where meetings are more readily available, they often send a fond farewell with great gratitude for the *LIM*. Meanwhile, another A.A. member is moving to a country with little or no A.A. contact, or no English-language meetings, and they are excited to discover *LIM*. While the category of Homers, A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity, has many stable members, we also hear from a few who no longer need the *LIM* as they become more physically mobile. And the service retains a small number of those for whom it was originally developed — the Internationalists working on seagoing vessels for long periods of time. It is a privilege to hear from all who need this service and to be grateful for the opportunity that many of us have to readily find an A.A. meeting in our own communities.

While members of this correspondence service most often write directly to each other, the assignment also coordinates a confidential bimonthly bulletin (*LIM* Bulletin) sent to Loners, Homers, Internationalists, and to Loner Sponsors and Port Contacts. The bulletin contains excerpts from *LIM* members' letters, and includes full names and addresses. *LIM* is distributed only to the members mentioned above who appreciate the need for confidentiality of personal sharing through correspondence. In addition, *LIM* members *only* are sent a directory of member names, addresses and phone numbers. This directory is updated several times during the year, and contains the confidential contact information for members from several different countries.

This assignment also provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities service in A.A., serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. Remote Communities resource materials housed at G.S.O. include pieces of A.A. literature (Serenity Prayer, Steps, and Traditions) that have been translated locally in a variety of Native North American/Aboriginal languages.

Gayle Solheim Riese

CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings.

Based on recommendations in three Advisory Actions from the 2010 General Service Conference, new text is being added to the Conference-approved pamphlets "Carrying the Message Into Correctional Facilities," "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Corrections Professionals" regarding clear information and good communication between A.A. members and corrections professionals. Along these same lines, the committee also approved the suggested changes to proposed language in the Corrections Workbook forwarded by the 2010 Conference Committee.

Following up on a 2009 Advisory Action and a 2010 Additional Committee Consideration, the committee continued its work on the revision of the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." A subcommittee was formed, and a thorough review of ninety submitted stories was conducted. The selected stories were forwarded to

the Publications Department, along with a list of suggested 'topics' and suggested photos, based on recommendations and suggestions from the 2009 and 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections. A detailed progress report has been forwarded to the 2011 Conference Committee on Corrections.

The committee reviewed suggestions from the Publications department for adding references to the Big Book in "A.A. in Correctional Facilities," including a proposed section describing 'Big Book Studies' as a possible meeting format, and agreed to forward these suggestions to the 2011 Conference Committee on Corrections.

In response to a 2010 Additional Committee Consideration, the committee requested that the staff member request (via e-mail) sharing of local solutions A.A. members may use to resolve perceived differences between facility rules/regulations and what A.A. is and is not, from all Area Corrections chairs, H&I chairs and delegates. This information has been gathered and will be reviewed by the committee to determine how such shared experience might be best utilized by the Fellowship.

Following up on another 2010 Additional Committee Consideration, an inventory of the English, Spanish and French Corrections Workbooks was conducted by the staff member and Publications Department. The missing section in the French language Corrections Workbook "The Four Step Process Approach to Starting or Restarting A.A. Meetings in Correctional Facilities" has been translated into French, for inclusion in the next printing.

Rogelio Flores, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Around 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a pre-release contact. While not everyone who writes to G.S.O. has a problem with alcohol, all letters are answered; those indicating they have a drinking problem are provided with basic literature, information about Twelve Step services specifically designed for the alcoholic who is incarcerated, and a warm invitation to participate in the Fellowship and program of recovery of A.A.

If an incarcerated alcoholic requests free literature, he or she may be sent a Big Book and a selection of pamphlets, and often the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. However, this assignment tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since "carrying the A.A. message" in this way is an A.A. service opportunity. Requests for multiple copies for an inside group, or ongoing requests from the same facility, are usually referred to those local A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This practice is also in keeping with past recommendations of Conference and trustees' Committees on Corrections.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.), coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many alcoholics who are incarcerated are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. To fill their requests, this assignment puts out regular pleas to the Fellowship through various channels for new correspondence volunteers — especially males. One of the challenges to this staff assignment is explaining why — when A.A. members continue to volunteer their time — we can never completely close the gap. The short answer is that every day more alcoholics in correctional facilities discover that the root

of their problem is alcohol and decide to do something about it! Once they come across the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, they want to share their journey with someone, just like the rest of us. In 2010 we linked 923 male alcoholics, and 487 female alcoholics in prison, to an outside A.A. correspondent through the C.C.S. In order to meet those requests, we needed to be able to match the inmates with 1,410 outside A.A. volunteers. Even while many of those volunteers offered to write to more than one alcoholic behind the walls at a time, the number is still large. And that is just the data for one year.

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals & Institutions, and Bridging the Gap Committees. Two or three times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared experience on how to use those tools. This past year a call for submissions went out as part of the ongoing revision of the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," as well as news about discount A.A. literature available, ideas for stimulating interest in the Corrections Correspondence Service, what to do if you get "no response" from an inside correspondent, and new sections being added to the Corrections Workbook and the "A.A. Guidelines on Corrections Committees."

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site has a special section where several pieces of Corrections service material can be found, including current and past issues of *Sharing From Behind the Walls* (SFBTW), a quarterly newsletter which contains excerpts of sharing from A.A. members in prison who wrote to G.S.O. The selections from these A.A. members' letters are typed up and sent to them along with a request to reprint the excerpt in a future issue of SFBTW. The permission letter also mentions the possibility of the newsletter being posted on G.S.O.'s Web site. Posting this anonymity-protected newsletter on the Web site and inviting members who take meetings into correctional facilities to print out copies is another way of seeing that the newsletters get back into the hands of those who need it most.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the alcoholic in prison identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions sometimes require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities, are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

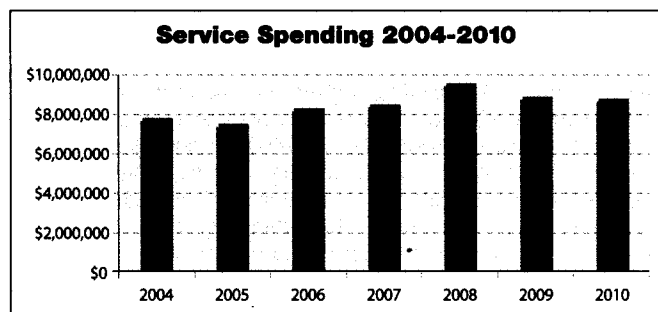
Jim Malone

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report:

G.S.O. — At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2010 and reported that G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$1,042,995, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was reduced by \$35,000 to \$1,007,995. For the year 2010, however, G.S.O. turned in positive results from operations of \$1,255,300. Both revenue and expenses were considerably less than budgeted.

Net sales for 2010 were approximately \$1,300,000 (9.6%) less than budgeted,



which after taking into account the fact that there were also no manufacturing, royalty or shipping and warehousing expenses, left a gross profit of \$371,500 (4.5%) less than budgeted. Fortunately, Contributions ended the year approximately \$58,400 (1%) greater than budgeted. We were also able to curtail some expenses and defer others so expenses were \$778,000 (5.6%) less than budgeted. It was gratifying to see an increase in contributions after two down years.

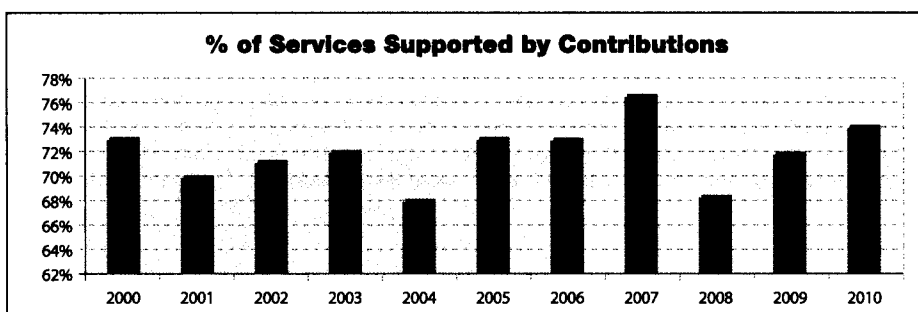
A.A. Grapevine — The Grapevine budget anticipated a net loss of \$245,741 for 2010. The actual result for the Grapevine was a loss of \$399,037. The primary reason for the additional Grapevine loss was that Revenue trailed the budget by \$243,000. Fortunately, expenses were also \$96,500 less than budgeted. Included in the revenue for 2010 was the result of the Grapevine Convention item that netted approximately \$71,000. La Viña anticipated a \$90,558 loss (after Conference actions), but achieved only \$75,481 loss.

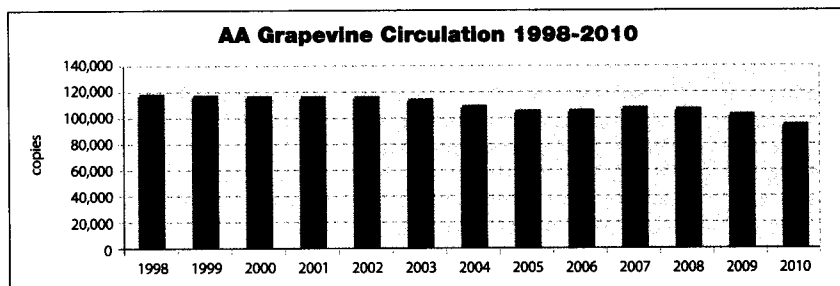
International Convention — The net result of the Convention added \$844,545 to the G.S.B. accounts.

At December 31, 2010, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 9.5 months of operating expenses. After taking into account transfers to the Reserve Fund Authorized by A.A.W.S. in March of 2011, the Reserve Fund will represent approximately 11.3 months of combined operating expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions from members. Contributions of \$6,278,900 received from *groups and members* were approximately \$63,900, or 1% greater than budgeted, and \$115,900 (1.8%) greater than in 2009. The \$6,278,900 in contributions came from 27,662 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents approximately 43.9% of the 62,873 groups listed with G.S.O., just slightly less than the 44.3% reported last year. Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,408,421, reflected in our 2010 financial statements, include approximately \$129,518 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2009, \$133,715; 2008, \$137,600; 2007, \$144,400; 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000.

This year the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was 62,873, slightly greater (1,260 more groups) than the previous year. However, the number of groups contributing decreased slightly (373). It is important to remember, however, that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us. While total contribution dollars were higher, so too were the total number of contributions.





The Contributions department noted 77,185 contributions received during 2010. This compares with 76,058 during 2009 or 1,127 more. Beginning in June 2010 we implemented the Contributions online function. For the period June through December we received approximately 1,056 contributions via the online method, representing approximately \$82,500.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,183,911, which was \$1,766,089 (12.6%) less than budgeted, and approximately \$1,291,805 less than 2009. During 2010, approximately 885,075 Big Books were sold compared with 1,220,000 in 2009 and 1,110,000 in 2008. We must remember, however, that a significant number of books were purchased prior to the July 1, 2009 price increase. Printing and manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted by approximately \$1,177,000. This is partly a result of better than anticipated manufacturing costs, our print purchasing team was able to take advantage of printers wanting to keep their employees working, thus negotiating better deals, but primarily due to the reduced sales level. The Gross profit of \$7,863,870 was \$589,000 less than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$14,273,404, approximately \$530,446 less than budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2010 were \$13,018,115, approximately \$770,740 less than budget and \$240,000 less than 2009 as well. Three significant components of this decrease were in Salaries, Other literature assistance and Contracted Services. Salaries were under budget due in part to unfilled positions and in part to employees out on disability. Other literature assistance was under budget by approximately \$80,000 due to a combination of fewer requests for assistance from emerging Fellowship Structures around the world, as well as a reduction in the cost of some of the translation expenses, due to some of the literature being produced in foreign countries instead of in the New York area. In the Contracted Services category, in addition to several projects that we held off on, we received approximately \$90,000 from our insurance carrier, the result of the claim for our 2009 outage due to a virus problem on our system. When compared with budget, the lower revenues combined with lower expenses resulted in a 2010 positive operating bottom line of \$1,255,289, approximately \$18,000 less than 2009.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship — in 2010, \$8,642,112 was spent to provide Services to the Fellowship, approximately \$145,650 less than was spent in 2009. This compares with \$8,783,762 in 2009 and \$9,447,300 in 2008.

The 2010 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 31.8% (which includes various group contact-type

costs in addition to Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.3%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 9.3%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.0%; Regional Forums, 6.6%; Archives, 7.9%; C.P.C., 4.7%; Public Information, 5.0%; Correctional Facilities, 4.2%; International Convention, 3.1%; Treatment Facilities, 2.4%; Special Needs; 1.4%; Nominating, 1.5%; World Service Meeting 3.5%; and other various 0.3%. Contributions provided 74.2% and 25.8% came from the profit from literature sales. This compares with 71.7% and 28.3% in 2009 and 68.1% and 31.9% in 2008.

2011 G.S.O. Budget — Sales for 2011 have been budgeted slightly higher when compared with 2010. Even though Contribution revenue has shown positive movement for several years, total Contributions received for 2008 and 2009 showed declines. For 2010 contributions received increased from 2009 by just under 1%. We have estimated approximately a 1% increase for 2011.

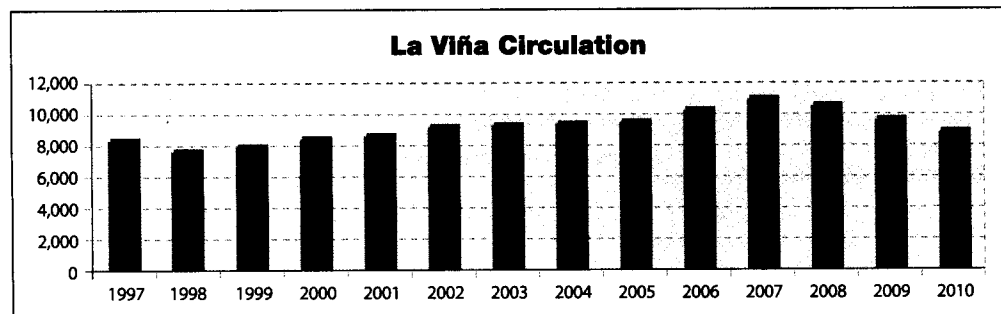
Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. We are trying to make more use of electronic communications where ever possible to reduce costs of postage and supplies. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower overall gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages and make price increases necessary from time to time.

Recent pricing history — In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed by one year the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. *Previously*, the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prices of books and booklets were increased effective July 1, 2009, anywhere from \$.25 to \$2.00.

The budget anticipates approximately an 8.7% increase in costs when compared with 2010 actual results, but only a 2.2% increase from the 2010 budget. Recall earlier discussion of under budget conditions in several of the line items during 2010 that are not anticipated to repeat in 2011. Based on these preliminary assumptions — approximately a 2.25% increase in sales, a 1% increase in contributions, and an increase in total operating expenses — the projection for 2011 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$340,080, considerably less than the \$1,255,289 achieved for 2010. During the budget process, the A.A.W.S. Board, as well as the trustees' Finance Committee, remains cognizant of the need to replenish funds that have been withdrawn from the Reserve Fund. Management continues to assess expenses and operations with an eye towards reduce costs. We are hopeful that the introduction

of Contributions online will allow us to reduce costs by e-mailing acknowledgements to contributors.

The Reserve Fund (and Historical Reference for price adjustments) — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to



lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments. As noted in previous reports, G.S.O. management was charged with presenting a 2009 budget with sufficient revenue that, with all things being equal, would maintain the Reserve Fund at a nine-month level of operating expenses after three years. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31, of \$11,868,427 (before March transfer) amounts to about \$189 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has decreased approximately \$300,000 from last year. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,408,421) by the 62,873 groups listed gives us an average of about \$102, (equal the same as last year) while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$137.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, gross magazine income for 2010 of \$2,097,408 was approximately \$29,857 less than the prior year. Average paid circulation of 93,104 was approximately 9,177 less than 2009. The average paid circulation of 93,104 compares with 102,281 for 2009, and 104,993 for 2008.

Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,245,532 was \$1,639 less than last year, and \$161,747 less than budgeted. Other publishing income was \$95,737 less than budgeted but \$40,000 greater than 2009. Other publishing income included \$114,600 of income to the Grapevine realized at the San Antonio Convention, which will not repeat in 2011. Gross profit on magazine related items was approximately \$81,000 less than budgeted, and it was \$2,000 less than 2009. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,819,629, \$11,000 less than 2009, but \$245,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$2,218,666. Costs and expenses were \$255,561 more than 2009, but \$96,600 less than budget. Excluding La Viña, the Grapevine reported a loss from operations of \$399,037, which was approximately \$266,443 greater than the 2009 loss of \$132,594, and \$153,296 greater than the budgeted loss of \$245,741.

The Grapevine's 2011 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine income of \$2,156,107 (approximately \$58,700 more than the \$2,097,408 realized in 2010), a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$8,290, and a gross profit of \$1,312,520. This is an increase of \$67,000 from 2010. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to decrease \$30,495, while interest income is estimated the same as 2010.

A loss for 2011 of \$93,970 is anticipated, compared with the \$399,037 loss for 2010.

La Viña — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2010 average circulation of 8,741. This compared with a 2009 average of 9,663; 2008 of 10,404.

The hope had been that La Viña would increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we would see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past thirteen and one-half years. During 2010, subscription income was \$91,558 and direct costs of publishing were \$62,916,

resulting in a \$28,642 gross profit. During 2010, La Viña realized approximately \$22,680 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$126,803. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on La Viña for the year was \$75,481, compared with a loss of \$54,472 for 2009, \$76,260 for 2008 and \$67,047 for 2007.

For 2011, the loss on the La Viña magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$114,697, (approximately \$39,200 greater than 2010), with circulation projected to decrease slightly to 8,517 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since the inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,340,480 has been invested in La Viña in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other items — During the year, the trustees' Finance Committee reviewed several other items. One was the recommendation, approved by the General Service Board, that "The net amount of Assets and Liabilities of the pension plan that is now reported in the Reserve Fund column be reported in a separate column on the Audited Financial Statements."

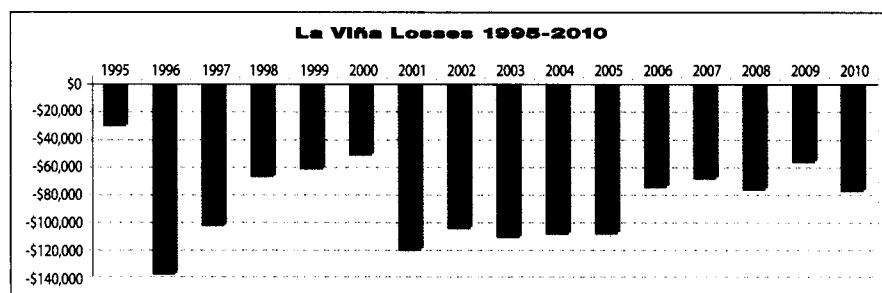
The Committee recommended, and the General Service Board concurred, setting up a subcommittee to oversee the cash flow of the Grapevine, monitor cash balances, and oversee remedial activities that will bring an end to the negative cash balance and consequent Reserve Fund draw downs. A subcommittee was appointed to clarify the process of drawing funds from the Reserve Fund. The Treasurer has appointed a subcommittee to analyze and communicate aspects of the Employees retirement Plan.

The trustees' Finance Committee recommended, and the General Service Board concurred, that a thorough re-evaluation of the Boards' commitment to continued production/support of La Viña be undertaken. Additionally, the G.S.B. approved an amendment to the Committee Composition, Scope and Procedures, such that the trustees' Finance Committee "annually reviews and reports to the General Service Board on financial aspects of the operating corporations 3-5 years strategic plans."

As noted in prior reports, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2006 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. While the economic outlook for 2011 may be uncertain as the economy unfolds, we will continue to monitor events with our goal to insure the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

Terrance Bedient, treasurer



Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2011¹

	Groups	Members
United States	57,905	1,279,664
Canada	4,968	94,017
Sub-Total	62,873	1,373,681
Correctional facilities ²	1,559	38,938
Internationalists	3	0
Lone Members	0	105
Total	64,435	1,412,724
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	43,541	644,948
Grand Total	107,976	2,057,672

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 60 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figure.

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 60th General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. Following is a summary of each session:

July 2010 — Is Our A.A. Membership Survey Providing A.A. Itself and the Professional with a Thorough and Useful Enough Overview of Our Fellowship? The first presentation was given by Mary Cummings, G.S.O. staff person, who shared on the topic: "The A.A. Membership Survey — Statistically, it serves its intended purpose." Although, based on her past professional experience, she felt the survey was inadequate, her conclusions actually raised more questions than they answered, such as, "...do we need the Membership Survey to tell us that our membership is not reflective of the demographics of the U.S. and Canada? That women and people of color are underrepresented? We have known these facts for decades. Has self-knowledge led to increased diversity or significant changes in our Twelfth Step work? Have you ever taken the Membership Survey on a Twelfth Step call? Do you use it when working with a newcomer?" She continues by asking, "What about as a C.P.C. tool? Do we need the Membership Survey to tell us that most members have received some form of additional help, both before and after sobriety? How vital is the Membership Survey to our Twelfth Step work with professionals? I think it is easy to rely on tools such as the Membership Survey and neglect the most important aspect of carrying the message in this area." In closing, Mary noted that "...the most powerful and effective way to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous is through personal contact."

Southeast regional trustee, El Nault, gave the second presentation entitled: "The A.A. Membership Survey — it *does not* capture an adequate picture of our Fellowship." Ironically, although she began her research to validate this topic, "...the survey *does not* capture an adequate picture of our Fellowship." Her conclusion was

that the Membership Survey *does* capture an adequate picture.

El did an extensive "survey" of seated delegates. She noted that an "adequate picture" of the Fellowship might be "...in the eye of the beholder." The delegates who responded to her inquiries reported that, as far as they were concerned, the survey results were valid and that in their areas they used the pamphlet for committee work at area and local levels for Public-Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment or Corrections work, as well as work with judges, health fairs, and corrections conventions, and for information to the media. Delegates also noted that the results are helpful in planning future service projects and preparing for our General Service Conference and they used the pamphlet to show newcomers that they are not alone. She concluded that "...to know who we are, to share with others who we are, and to make data-informed decisions to develop new programs, literature, etc., to reach the millions of suffering alcoholics requires information that we currently gather through our Membership Survey."

After the presentations, attendees were invited to share on the topic. A general service trustee shared that the Membership Survey was useful as a P.I. tool. Another general service trustee shared that the Membership Survey pamphlet continues to resonate with her because as a newcomer it made her feel a part of A.A.; a part of a significant demographic group. A staff member shared that, in the future, she hopes delegates would be encouraged to be more directly involved in the distribution process of survey questionnaires and instructions, because it would help the Fellowship to retrieve more accurate data and therefore increase the validity of the survey. She concurred with one of the presenters that the survey, though flawed, was an accurate tool for use in A.A., as well as its use for those outside of A.A.

A Class A trustee reported that currently general practitioners are spending less and less time consulting with and listening to their patients. He pointed out that in his opinion doctors are more interested in bottom line information, such as the number of A.A. members and groups rather than other data. And another Class A shared a grave concern that perhaps the survey suggested that A.A. membership was flat. An A.A.W.S. director thought that societal values have changed from the previous generation, leading to an increase in the number of women alcoholics. She also noted that the survey's data has been consistent for over two decades, which might add to the validity of its usefulness.

A general service trustee and an appointed committee member both expressed the idea that perhaps A.A. should invite outside professional statisticians or other professional researchers to take a more in-depth look at A.A. in order to ask questions that go beyond the survey questionnaire. In conclusion, a trustee-at-large noted that as imperfect as the Membership Survey might be, it can help ferret out unanswered questions.

October 2010 — "G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site" — A.A.W.S. director, Andrea Barthwell, shared on the question, "G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site — A vital communication tool! How can we best utilize our G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site while considering the impact worldwide?" She noted that "...a Web site's strength is that it acts like a network node, giving the user an opportunity to branch out from an initial inquiry to discover relevant or related information clusters." She asked why a business, enterprise or organization should use the Internet. The answer she noted was that the Web is a valuable tool to get one's message out. Andrea expressed that an organization needs to connect a user to resources not previously known to him or her, so that accurate and clear organizational information can be disseminated. She observed that A.A. was correct in looking at the need to have a place on the Web.

Her view was that the Web and social networking could provide value to an organization by connecting people who are trying to ac-

compish a goal using these new tools. She spoke of what the real impact of focused effort on the Internet could mean for A.A. by reaching more suffering alcoholics from a wider range of vantage points. She brought up a concern about anonymity protection with an online presence, noting the ability to protect anonymity on the Internet required unique technological approaches. Expanding our capacity to carry the message, she said, was a good outcome of Web-based applications. Just as groups register at the A.A. site, an individual with a desire to stop drinking could register for access to the online community, which could have the ability to function 24/7 and expand our reach to rural and remote populations and also provide group specific meetings in smaller chat rooms — for example, for women, for Spanish-speaking members and for young people.

Andrea concluded that the possibilities on the Internet were endless and the potential to have a positive impact worldwide was great, as long as we can make ourselves heard amidst the noise, and it was time we leverage technology to reach a generation of people who have grown up "...with keyboards attached to their fingertips," and to reach people with limited mobility, who are geographically isolated, and needing to have the message brought to them.

Bill Noonan, A.A.W.S. director, was the next to share and his question was, "Are we thinking out of the box (or around the box) when it comes to communicating with the Fellowship via our G.S.O. A.A. Web site?" Bill began by stating that he doesn't believe that anything we have done so far can be described as thinking "out of the box," or even around the box, when it comes to A.A.'s use of the World Wide Web. He went on to explain that he took great pride and comfort in the Fellowship's steadfast history and that A.A.'s 36 spiritual principles, particularly the Twelve Traditions, have ensured that A.A. does not move too quickly down any path, nor jump on any "current trendy bandwagon." He observed that it is hard to imagine life without the Internet in today's world. He expressed his view that A.A. has reached a point in its history that is critical to the very survival of the A.A. message and the A.A. Fellowship.

Bill contacted several intergroups and central offices around the country while preparing his talk and was not surprised to hear that the online meeting directory was the number one service their Web sites provided. The staff/member on the International Conventions assignment reported that 89% of the people who pre-registered for the Convention in San Antonio registered online, essentially nine out of ten people.

Bill offered some suggestions:

- Simplify the A.A. home page and give the first-time visitor three choices: a) Do you need help? b) For A.A. members; c) Information on A.A. for media and professionals.
- Have a woman or man telling their story of hope and recovery in an anonymity protected way to help the newcomer accessing the Web site.
- Expand our help to professionals looking for guidance for clients.
- Allow District Literature chairs the ability to order A.A. literature online.
- Link to the A.A. Literature Catalog without prices and no online ordering capability.
- Allow print options for pamphlets if we can still protect our copyrights.
- Provide a space for area trusted servants to share their experiences and problems.
- Establish a general navigational tool to update the Meeting Search and map tool to be mobile-device friendly for access by iPhones, iPads, Blackberries, Droids, etc., and to access a literature application or "App" as they are commonly referred too.

In closing, Bill stated that. "The basic message of Alcoholics Anonymous has not changed for 75 years, nor should it change, but the manner in which we convey that message to those in need must evolve with the times in order for us to continue to be the last hope, the last place to turn to, when there is no place left to turn except the bottle."

A summary of the sharing follows: A general service trustee recalled the concerns a number of years ago regarding listing online intergroups and online meetings in our directories as an example of how we often may be afraid of change. She encouraged everyone to consider how to better reach the suffering alcoholic via technology. A G.S.O. staff member shared that A.A. is not the only organization facing challenges creating user-friendly Web sites.

From two appointed committee members: One expressed a resentment that the copy of his Big Book on his iPhone came from someone he doesn't know. That individual has his \$4.95 and not A.A. because he can't get the Big Book for his e-reader from A.A. The second member suggested expanding the view of A.A.W.S. from just a publishing company to a "media" company, with a broader vision of ways to deliver A.A.'s message.

An A.A.W.S. trustee director assured the gathering that A.A.W.S. was developing e-publishing and working toward a broad new vision for the Web site. A regional trustee felt the Web site was too complicated and was not user-friendly for professionals, failing to connect professionals with A.A. members directly.

The moderator, trustee-at-large/U.S. Don Massey, concluded the session by commenting that what we do on our Web site will impact not only the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, but other countries all around the world.

January 2011 — "The A.A. Service Structure" — Regional trustee Pam Reising, shared on the topic "The A.A. Service Structure — A worldwide membership responsibility — taking responsibility for A.A. and its services." She spoke about her sponsor who, talking about various service responsibilities, mostly at the home group, said: "The greatest gift you will ever know is to be of service to your fellow alcoholics."

Her first home group, Pam said, was a very old-time, traditional group where it was the custom to walk around the room and shake hands with everyone before the meeting started. This custom was really service work in which the hand of A.A. was literally extended to the newer member as well as the group's sober members. She was expected to be at her home group to support the newcomer and oldtimer alike, and her sponsor made it clear that if she missed the meeting, she was to put extra money in the basket the following week — "just because you're not there, doesn't mean the group ceases to have expenses."

Pam observed that from the home group springs the army of G.S.R.s whose dedication, communication between service entities, and tireless work is really the lifeblood of Alcoholics Anonymous. Many of these G.S.R.s go on to serve as D.C.M.s. She noted, that there are literally tens of thousands of A.A. members in various service positions in the United States, Canada and worldwide who have, and are, taking responsibility for A.A. and its services at the district level.

Pam also "tipped her hat" to the delegates, who had all undertaken an awesome responsibility requiring sacrifice, time, energy, extensive travel, and leadership, to be of service not only to their areas but to the world of A.A. She concluded, "While our service responsibilities may differ, the common thread that binds us is the love for this cherished Fellowship and the genuine desire to reach and help those who have yet to find us. We have all arrived here by different paths. But our destiny is to serve together in this brief time and place in A.A. history. For staff, delegates, directors, and trustees — we have been passed the torch of service and its attendant responsibility from the giants who preceded us."

G.S.O. staff member, Mary Clare Lynch, next shared on the topic, "Envisioning the future of the A.A. Service Structure worldwide — encompassing our hopes and dreams for A.A." In considering this topic she was inspired by Bill W.'s counsel about our Structure in Concept VI: *"Of course there is no desire to freeze these relations into a rigid pattern. However satisfactory and right, . . . the future may reveal flaws that we do not yet envision. New conditions may require refinements or even considerable alterations."*

Mary Clare spoke about the wide range of technological innovations that A.A. and the service structure might implement in the future, ranging from innovative Web sites to service meetings conducted via the Internet. Her core hope for our Service Structure is that we would fully embrace a chance to go back to the drawing board and create it anew. She posed the questions: "If we had no Service Structure, what would we create? What do we need? What can we do? Most importantly, what are we willing to support financially, through our own contributions?" A new structural creation, she said, might explode the service structure "out of the box" in using technology as the valuable tool that it is to carry the A.A. message, to complete project work, to bridge the isolation amongst ourselves and between us and newcomers, and to inform professionals and others about the A.A. program of recovery from alcoholism.

In the future, she said, "...thinking out of the box, the General Service Conference/General Service Board workload needs to be concentrated and strategic. I envision a future where we reach such a level of maturity and trust that many decisions do not have to wait for a sit-down face-to-face General Service Conference, but could be routed right through a transparent screening process and either be denied or assigned to work teams for completion. The General Service Conference would be held with delegates gathering simultaneously in their regions and being interconnected. Delegates would come to New York only every two or three years. Money saved by meeting less frequently would go toward the use of one of the electronic meeting systems to streamline deliberation and the voting process when Conference did meet. Future face-to-face Conferences would require little in terms of paper background, as the agendas would be structured largely for sharing sessions on issues of consequence, and background would be accessible online in a protected environment."

She concluded with an appeal made by our co-founder, Bill W.: *"God forbid that Alcoholics Anonymous ever become frozen solid in its ways of doing or thinking. Within the framework of our principles, the ways are apparently legion."*

After the presentations, Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S. and chair of the Sharing Session, thanked the speakers and noted that the General Service Board had an obligation to bring vision to the Fellowship. He then invited all in attendance to share on the topic.

One delegate reported that she was surprised by the need to manage the amount of e-mail that comes in to her on a daily basis. She empathized with the volume of work done by the G.S.O. staff, and suggested that perhaps they need iPads. Still another delegate shared that it takes A.A. a while to move when it comes to moving into a "paperless" way of doing business. She expressed that we ought not confuse the message with the delivery system. There is no substitute for one alcoholic talking to another alcoholic, but we can use new methods to reach the suffering alcoholic. One delegate felt anxious with the discussion, sensing that like her workplace, we get so tied down by what we did in the past, we need time to keep our balance, and felt that some of the types of discussions she has heard during the Board weekend might contribute to the view that service work is becoming less attractive. A delegate from one area noted that there were challenges to be faced with technology regarding the skills needed to utilize computers by service members,

the expense of purchasing them and the problem of deciding who gets them.

A G.S.O. staff member commented on the use of the phrase, "If it ain't broke, don't fix it!" She asked what would happen to us if we operated that way. She said she would never dream of changing the Steps, Traditions or Concepts, but we can change the things that surround these principles to find wiser and more efficient ways to carry the message. We need to challenge ourselves to find what is the best we can do for A.A. Another G.S.O. staff member commented that A.A. needs to keep that one-on-one communication. In his opinion, we need to look at how we transmit Conference background. There are 1.3 million members in the U.S. and Canada and it seems to him that we have missed the point of "delegated business authority." Not everybody is interested in Conference business. He doesn't want his home group bogged down in Conference material discussions — the service structure is there for those who want to participate. There is always a certain amount of tension within the Fellowship — we don't have unanimity but we have a group conscience. His question for us as members is, "How do I accept the group conscience when I am in the minority?" Another share from a staff member noted that when his child wanted a cookie, she didn't care or need to know where it came from. She had a "parent" who provided the cookie. When he was new, he didn't know or care where the Big Book came from — he knew it came out of a box in his home group. He had no idea of the A.A. service structure, but he instinctively knew it was working fine. Our Conference is the "parent" of the structure — its work should be almost invisible and unobtrusive.

An appointed committee member shared that there's a whole "business" side to A.A. that has changed and we need to keep looking at "the business" model to help reach the suffering alcoholic. A director noted that sometimes more technology might mean less attendance at meetings.

A trustee believed that we had moved ahead somewhat in our technological methods, but that we are perhaps, like him, fearful of technology and where we are headed with its use. He noted that we need the kind of technology that helps us to find those who want and need us; we don't want to keep our Fellowship a secret. Another trustee observed that A.A. seems to have one foot in tomorrow and one foot in yesterday. What the trustees committees need to do is look to yesterday so we can move forward today. She hoped the delegate chairs would go back to their areas with different scopes and visions to help make A.A. the very best. Although we don't agree on how to make A.A. better, our love of A.A. and our Traditions brings us together and will sustain us with One who has all power. The final trustee to share noted that A.A. has a tendency to surrender to the future late. We need to move into the future. Our biggest impediment is our fear that we will "break" something.

Don Massey, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: Since the last Conference, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., has produced 18 issues of the redesigned Grapevine and La Viña, plus the special 75th Anniversary Convention Issue (which sold out). Other products include the 2011 wall calendar and pocket planner; *Spiritual Awakenings II* book; 12 editions of Audio Grapevine and 12 issues of the e-newsletter, *Heard It Through the Grapevine*. Digital versions of Grapevine and La Viña magazines were launched at year-end, debuting in January 2011, and the Web site relaunch project for AAGrapevine.org kicked off in 2010, to launch in mid-2011. There also has been a move to a new fulfillment house, resulting in significant savings.

The A.A. Grapevine staff currently consists of ten full-time and

three part-time employees, who work on the production of the publications; circulation and public information; finance and shipping; and customer service. A full-time web editor and full-time La Viña editor joined the staff in mid-2010. The La Viña editor prepared for launching the expanded 68-page issue of La Viña, which debuted in January 2011, with the assistance of a new locally-based bilingual art director with extensive magazine experience. The web editor focused on the Web site relaunch, including developing sharing sessions with members of the Fellowship across North America and executing the project management of the design and development teams. Once launched, the web editor will focus on creating the expanded editorial content of A.A. Grapevine's Web site, which post-relaunch can be updated easily and inexpensively. In addition, a subscriber survey, and Conference and Fellowship Grapevine surveys were conducted.

During the past year La Viña's Editorial Advisory Board, a group of A.A. members with substantial professional experience in publishing, business, and communications, have helped guide the magazine and vet manuscripts. La Viña's Editorial Advisory Board met with staff several times this year to assist with the editorial direction of La Viña and discuss circulation and the development of stories.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. welcomed a new executive editor/publisher this year, who joins the staff with an extensive publishing/management background. The executive editor/publisher is responsible for establishing the vision for A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and developing and implementing the A.A. Grapevine strategic plan. In addition, the executive editor/publisher will focus strongly on developing a cost-effective and self-supporting operation and business model. Many innovative projects are in the pipeline for 2011, and beyond, to that effect.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s, chief financial officer, the controller, drafts Grapevine and La Viña's budgets in collaboration with the board's finance committee, reports on the GV and LV's financial standing each quarter and keeps a close watch on company expenditures and cash flow. The controller also supervises copyrights, freelance contracts, and in-house shipping, serves as chair of two trustees' retirement committees, and plays a key role in strategic planning. He and the rest of the Grapevine team also help the Fellowship understand that A.A. Grapevine, Inc. strives to be self-supporting. Its mission is to carry the A.A. message, and break even, with the help of the Fellowship.

Amber Eden, managing editor

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 21st World Service Meeting (WSM) was held October 17-21, 2010 in Mexico City, Mexico, with the theme "Sponsorship: Our Responsibility." Fifty-three delegates were in attendance representing A.A. service structures in 32 countries. Don Massey, trustee-at-large/United States, first-term delegate, and Jo-Anne Lowenberger trustee-at-large/Canada, second-term delegate, represented the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager, Phyllis Halliday, presided at the event and staff member, Warren Stafford, served as WSM coordinator. Other staff members serving as secretaries to WSM committees were Adrienne Brown, Mary Clare Lynch, and Eva Sanchez. John Kir-

win served as logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and liaison to hotel staff.

Literature Assistance — The 2011 Literature Assistance budget of \$100,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service board. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2010, 60 reviews of proposed translations were completed.

Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada will be represented at five zonal service meetings in 2011, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In June 2011, Phyllis Halliday and Warren Stafford will attend, as observers, the 5th Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM), which will be held in Johannesburg, South Africa. In July, Phyllis Halliday and G.S.O. staff member, Warren Stafford, will attend, as observers, the 9th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Chandigarh, India. In October, Phyllis Halliday and the newly assigned staff member on the International Desk will attend, as observers, the 16th European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany. Also, in October, Don Massey, trustee-at-large/U.S., and the newly elected trustee-at-large/Canada, will attend, as delegates, the 17th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in San Salvador, El Salvador.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, and regional assemblies. In addition to the events listed above trustees and staff members visited Belarus, France, Greece, Guatemala, Japan, and New Zealand. We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, which carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 60 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our trust in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries.

The International staff member benefits from the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting

(WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.

- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Working closely with our Records Department to insure that our International A.A. Directory (for countries outside of the United States and Canada), which is published annually, contains updated contact information for G.S.O.s, central offices and intergroups, groups, foreign contacts and Loners around the world.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 63 languages, and additional translations are in progress.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Warren Stafford

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — The 2010 International Convention, held in San Antonio, Texas last summer, was a wonderful experience for the approximately 52,500 attendees. This Convention was larger than any past Conventions and once again members from around the world who were unable to make it to San Antonio had the opportunity to view an encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed broadcast of the Opening Flag Ceremony from G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Rick Walker, the Convention coordinator, other G.S.O. personnel, the Convention consultant and the San Antonio Host Committee combined to provide a truly international experience celebrating A.A.'s 75th Anniversary!

The purpose of the trustees' committee as it relates to International Conventions is to work on plans for each forthcoming International Convention. The objectives of the International Conventions are: to provide opportunities for a rededication of attendees to the primary purpose of A.A.; to enable attendees to witness the success and growth of the A.A. program around the world.; to let the world know that A.A. is alive, flourishing and available as a community resource, locally and internationally.

The committee acts and makes recommendations in order to fulfill the broad purposes of the General Service Board, as they relate to the strengthening of the Fellowship and the advancement of its message, through well-planned International Conventions. The detailed work inherent in putting on the Convention is executed by the Conference coordinator and a professional Convention Consultant.

Following the April 2010 Conference the committee discussed

the 2010 International Convention and agreed to the following:

- Adding a workshop on the Grapevine Digital Archive to the Convention schedule.
- Presenting the 30 millionth copy of *Alcoholics Anonymous* to the American Medical Association and a souvenir edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* to the daughters of Father Sam Shoemaker. (Fr. Shoemaker's daughters were unable to join us in San Antonio.)
- Approving the list of speakers for the Friday and Sunday Stadium meetings.

Additionally, the committee discussed a request for a special purpose meeting at the International Convention for A.A. members who are also members of the clergy. The committee declined to add this meeting to the schedule and noted that each of the currently-scheduled meetings for professions at the International Convention correspond to the "Special International Contact" listed in the A.A. Directories. It was also pointed out that although this will not be a formally scheduled meeting, those interested could still hold an informal meeting during the Convention.

At the July meeting the committee held a brief sharing session and reviewed lists of suggestions and comments regarding the International Convention. Committee members agreed to submit topics for further consideration at a future committee meeting. The committee extended its thanks to the local A.A. Host Committee and the City of San Antonio for their tremendous efforts in making everyone who attended the Convention feel welcome. Grateful thanks were also expressed to the Convention coordinator, the staff, Gregg Talley, the Talley Management Group and to everyone involved in the preparations for this event.

The committee reviewed and accepted revised Guidelines for Site-Selection for the 2025 A.A. International Convention, and also recommended to the General Service Board that Al-Anon be invited to participate in A.A.'s International Convention in 2015 in Atlanta, Georgia. Al-Anon's participation will be based on their participation in 2010 in San Antonio, 2005 in Toronto, and 2000 in Minneapolis. The committee also reviewed an invitation from the board of Al-Anon Family Groups and recommended to the Board that A.A. accept the invitation to participate in Al-Anon's 5th International Convention, July 5-7, 2013, in Vancouver, British Columbia, in a similar fashion to A.A.'s participation in Al-Anon's 4th International Convention in 2008 in Pittsburgh, PA.

At the October committee meeting, the committee agreed that G.S.O. send out a request for proposals (RFP's) and proceed with selection of the 2015 International Convention management firm. The RFP to provide convention management services for the 2015 Convention was sent to fifteen firms. Four firms submitted competitive bids, which were reviewed by G.S.O. management in consultation with the 2015 International Convention coordinator. The committee agreed with G.S.O. management's selection of the Convention consultant for the 2015 International Convention and that G.S.O. proceed with contractual arrangements with Talley Management Group, Inc.

Regional Forums — Since the 2010 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast regions. One "Additional" Regional Forum was held in the West Central region. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the General Service Board, General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine. Many in attendance were experiencing their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to exchange information between local trusted servants, A.A.s interested in service, trustees, directors and staff of G.S.O. and the Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experi-

ence, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service.

The committee discussed two Local Forum requests and recommended to the General Service Board that the request for a Local Forum to be hosted by Area 92, Washington East, on September 23-25, 2011, and the request for a Local Forum to be hosted by Area 40, Montana, in June 2011 be approved. Since the 2010 Conference, a Local Forum was held in San Diego, CA, August 22, 2010, and was hosted by the Spanish-speaking districts of Area 08, San Diego/Imperial, California.

Following each Regional Forum, the committee reviewed a summary of the Forum evaluation questionnaires. The committee will continue to review evaluation summaries of recent Forums at committee quarterly meetings and notes that the information in the summaries is more useful to the staff member in planning Forums.

In 2006, the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums recommended that Additional and Local Forums be implemented on a trial basis with an annual review/inventory for five years by the committee. Since the implementation of Local and Additional Forums there have been three Local Forums and two Additional Regional Forums.

The committee conducted its third annual review/inventory of the content and implementation of Local Forums and Additional Regional Forums. Following lengthy discussion on Additional Regional Forums and the need for clarification, the committee reaffirmed that Additional Forums continue to be formatted as Regional Forums. The committee also noted that Additional Forums are hosted by the General Service Board and are coordinated by G.S.O.

The committee discussed Regional Forums newsletters and final reports and agreed to shorten the newsletter distributed at Forums, which will include board and staff reports. The Final Forum Reports will be expanded to include the wonderful delegate's presentations that are presented at Forums. The committee noted that all registered Forum attendees receive the Final Forum Reports and attendees who provide an e-mail address receive it by e-mail rather than postal mail. The electronic distribution of the Final Forum Report versus postal mail distribution is increasing as more attendees prefer to receive the report by e-mail. Final Forum Reports continue to be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site as well.

The committee reviewed and accepted the schedule of board and staff participation at 2011 Forums, noting that the Forums' staff member works out the schedule and presents it to G.S.O. management and the committee for review. When scheduling Grapevine director participation at Regional Forums, the Forums coordinator will consult with the Grapevine Board chairperson. The following Forums are scheduled for 2011:

2011		
May 20-22	Northeast	Sturbridge, Massachusetts
August 19-21	Pacific "Additional"	Woodland Hills, California
September 9-10	West Central	Davenport, Iowa
October 7-9	Southwest	Wichita, Kansas
November 11-13	East Central	Miamisburg, Ohio

The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums the following discussion topic: Discuss ways to encourage interest in Forums and how areas communicate about upcoming Forums in their region.

El Nault, chairperson

Staff reports:

The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees — Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host — the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

Last July saw the successful culmination of years of work by then coordinator Rick Walker. Members of Alcoholics Anonymous and their families and friends from all over the world celebrated A.A.'s 75th Anniversary at the 2010 International Convention held July 1-4, in San Antonio, Texas. The theme of the Convention, "A Vision For You," resonated throughout this joyous weekend. It was a wonderful event, with meetings, panels, workshops, marathons and stadium events. The Convention began on Thursday evening with dances and beginning at midnight, marathon meetings got underway in all three official languages of the General Service Conference U.S./Canada — English, French and Spanish.

Opening ceremonies were held Friday night at the Alamodome stadium, complete with the Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. As approved by the 2009 Conference, the encrypted anonymity-protected video of the opening Flag Ceremony was streamed on G.S.O.'s Web site with unlimited access through Monday, July 5th. This broadcast was accessed 12,605 times in English, 531 in French, and 654 in Spanish. On Saturday night there was the Old-timers Meeting and on Sunday morning the customary Closing Meeting, both held at the stadium.

Local A.A. Host Committee volunteers numbered about 4,000 and did a fabulous job welcoming the many visitors to San Antonio. For family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen who accompanied us to San Antonio, daytime meetings, workshops, marathons and other events were offered at the Marriott Rivercenter. We trust that all attendees experienced a milestone event of gratitude and the language of the heart in wonderful, exciting, friendly San Antonio.

While still on the back burner, initial plans are under way for the next International Convention in Atlanta, Georgia, July 2-5, 2015. Big Meetings will be held in the Georgia Dome and other meetings will take place in the Georgia World Congress Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. Starting in 2014, there will be articles in Box 4-5-9, which is sent to the general service representative of every group listed with G.S.O. Information will also be accessible on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

Rick Walker

Regional/Local Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Additional Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. groups, members and trusted servants in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staff. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and regularly scheduled at the invitation of a particular region every two years. With the implementation of Additional Regional Forums, there is currently the opportunity for five Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes Regional Forum flyers to trusted service workers in the region that includes the registration form, and coordinates Forum details: hotel

arrangements, program, displays, on-site registration, etc. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the host contact who recruits volunteers to assist staff with hospitality, set-up and registration during the Forum weekend. The location for a Regional Forum is decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O., who also suggest presentations and workshops. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "early bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Final Forum Report to all who attend. Advance planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

In October 2006, the concept of Local Forums (LF) was approved by the General Service Board on a five-year trial basis. The purpose of Local Forums is to bring Forum information to A.A. members in remote, sparsely populated areas, urban neighborhoods or underserved A.A. communities. Any A.A. community or service entity may request a one- or two-day Local Forum. Unlike Regional Forums, the responsibility for Forum expenses, such as meeting room rental and miscellaneous expenses, are assumed by the Local Forum Committee. At their expense, the General Service Board will send two participants, one from the board and one from the General Service Office or Grapevine office, and will provide literature for display.

The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, and also serves as secretary to the Conference Report and Charter Committee.

Eva Sanchez

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2010 General Service Conference.

- *"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" pamphlet* — At their July 2010 meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee reviewed the 2010 Conference recommendation that "the revised 60th Conference draft pamphlet, 'The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs,' be returned to the trustees' Literature Committee for additional discussion and report back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature." The chair appointed a subcommittee to review and define the intent and scope of the pamphlet and present a report at the October 2010 meeting.

In October the committee reviewed the report from the subcommittee on the pamphlet, as well as the revised draft pamphlet. The committee agreed with suggestions of the subcommittee regarding the reorganization of the pamphlet and additions to clarify the purpose and scope of the pamphlet. The committee asked that a final edited draft be brought back to the committee at their January 2011 meeting for review. In January the committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature the final draft of the revised pamphlet for consideration.

- *Development of literature which focuses on spirituality* — At the July 2010 meeting, we reviewed the 2010 Conference recommendation that "the trustees' Committee on Literature develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous, and bring a draft or progress report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature." The chair appointed a subcommittee and asked that the subcommittee develop a plan on how to proceed and report back to the committee at their October meeting. In October the committee reviewed a report from the Subcommittee on the Development of Literature Which Focuses on Spirituality.

The committee agreed with the subcommittee's suggestion to request stories that reflect a wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members and to include them in a pamphlet format. The subcommittee agreed to continue to work on the development of the pamphlet and bring a progress report back to the committee at their January 2011 meeting. In January the committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature a report on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality for consideration.

- *"A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet* — At their July 2010 meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee discussed the 2010 Conference recommendation that "the trustees' Literature Committee update the pamphlet 'A.A. and the Armed Services' to include recent experiences from members on active duty and a section which focuses on veterans of the armed services, and that the range of experiences be reflected in the title of the pamphlet. The committee requested that a draft or progress report be brought back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature." The chair appointed a subcommittee to develop a work plan and present a report at their October 2010 meeting.

At their October meeting, the committee reviewed a report from the subcommittee on the pamphlet and agreed with the subcommittee's suggestion that the staff member on the Literature desk solicit new stories from A.A. members who got sober during or after active duty in the armed services. The subcommittee will continue to work on the revision of the pamphlet and provide a report in January 2011.

In January the committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature a progress report on the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services" for consideration. The committee also agreed to extend the story solicitations deadline until July 15, 2011 to encourage more submissions.

- *Living Sober Booklet* — At their July 2010 meeting, the trustees' Literature Committee discussed the 2010 Conference recommendation that "the trustees' Committee on Literature review the booklet, *Living Sober* and present a draft or report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature" and asked the Publications Department to undertake a review of the booklet focusing on outdated language or practices and present a draft or report at the next committee meeting in October.

In October the committee reviewed a report and editing suggestions from the Publications Department for revisions to the *Living Sober* booklet. The committee thanked the editorial staff for a comprehensive review that updates the language while preserving the style of the booklet. The committee provided several additional suggestions and asked that a revised draft be brought back to the committee for review at their January meeting. In January the committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Literature the final draft of the revisions to the *Living Sober* booklet for consideration.

Projects Ongoing:

- In keeping with the 2010 Advisory Action that the revised pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be approved, the revised pamphlet became available upon depletion of old inventory in February of 2011.

- In keeping with the 2010 Advisory Action that a paragraph regarding closed meetings be changed in the pamphlet "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.," the changes will be included at the next printing of the pamphlet (approximately May 2011.)

Projects forwarded to the 2011 Conference Literature Committee:

- Revised draft pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs."

- Progress report on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality.
- Progress report on the revision of the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services."
- Draft revision to the booklet *Living Sober*.

Requests discussed and forwarded to the 2011 Conference Literature Committee:

- Consider suggestion to replace the text under "When You're a G.S.R." in the pamphlet "G.S.R. General Service Representative."
- Consider a request to develop an item similar to the Self-support or "green card" to help promote the use of our literature as a Twelfth Step tool.
- Consider a request to reconsider the 2010 Conference Advisory Action that "the trustees' Literature Committee develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous."
- Consider a request to include the A.A. Preamble in the front inside pages of the Big Book.
- Consider a request to develop a publication about the General Service Office.

Roberta Linderman, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services Publications Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, and intergroup/central office literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 73 area, 246 district and 14 intergroup/central office literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with an approximate quarterly distribution of 63,000 copies in English, 2,200 copies in French and 3,400 copies in Spanish. A digital delivery service for *Box 4-5-9* has been added through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site www.aa.org. There are currently 7,500 subscribers to the service. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. G.S.O. always welcomes committee sharing on service from the Fellowship, which may be included in articles so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

Julio Espallat

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Nominating of the General Service Board was first appointed by the chairman of the

board in 1944. Primary responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review resumes of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the trustees' Committee on Nominating)

Since that time the trustees' Committee on Nominating generally has met three times each year, and, with the forming of the General Service Conference in 1951, the committee began to meet annually with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The responsibilities of the trustees' Committee on Nominating grew over time to encompass establishing criteria for all vacancies, whether in the ranks of trustees or among key service directors and staff members.

Activities of this committee in the past year:

Follow Up to 2010 General Service Conference: In response to an Additional Committee consideration, the committee forwarded a request and clarifying language from the 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees to the 2011 Conference Committee on Report and Charter to resolve inconsistencies in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding nominating a regional trustee and a trustee-at-large candidate in the same year.

The 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore benefits and liabilities of allowing the same person to be submitted as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large at the same Conference. The committee reviewed historical background and other sharing regarding possible benefits and liabilities and agreed to take no action on this subject, noting that the current process works sufficiently well. Regional trustees from both the East Central and Southeast regions, those regions having an opportunity to stand for only one of these positions every two years according to the current rotation schedule, as well as the U.S. trustee-at-large were in attendance and agreed that the current procedure of not allowing the same individual to be submitted as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large at the same Conference did not seem to be an issue in their regions.

The 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the three boards when unplanned Class A and general service trustee vacancies occur. The committee agreed that since Class As are not on a "rotation schedule" per se, there would not likely be a long vacancy and little negative impact with unexpected Class A vacancies. They reviewed the impact on Zonal meetings, World Service Meetings, etc. and agreed that in the event of such unexpected vacancies, coverage would take place as it does with other vacancies — the General Service Board would solve any emergencies on a case-by-case basis. They noted that while past vacancies may have caused inconveniences, such vacancies did not keep the Board from functioning effectively.

The 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the Board if a change in Regional Trusteeship were to occur. Noting the extensive work done by the 2007 and 2008 trustees' Committee on Nominating regarding "Unexpected Vacancies on the Board," the committee agreed that there was no overriding reason to change rotation and that there are sufficient contingency plans allowed in the Bylaws to cover unexpected vacancies.

The committee agreed that the lengthy and thoughtful process undertaken by the 1998, 1999, and 2006 trustees' and Conference Committees regarding the wording and placement of the "Diversity Statement" found in Nominating Procedures No. 2, 4, 11 and 12 was sufficient and therefore took no action to move or change the statement.

The committee reviewed all aspects of an area's suggestion to create a position of Alternate Trustee on the General Service Board. The committee took no action on this item and agreed that while having a full board is ideal, on the past occasions that the board has experienced unexpected vacancies, they were not critically hampered in the completion of their duties.

Regional and At-Large Trustee Elections: The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in May 2011, all candidates submitted for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and trustee-at-large/Canada elections.

Board Slates: The committee recommended slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2011, following presentation at the 2011 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures: In addition to the correction of typographical errors and a minor change in word order, the General Service Board approved the following recommendations to revise the language in the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedures: to clarify *which* committee report is sent to committee members; to change who interviews appointed committee members (A.C.M.s); to clarify which "boards" existing text refers to; to emphasize, in a certain procedure, which trustees are being referred to; to stress who it is that submits regional candidates, and to remove text in a Procedure to reflect current practice.

The committee recommended that:

- Rod Betonney serve as trustee director on A.A. World Services, Inc., following the 2011 Conference, to succeed Vic Phillips.
- Donald Cusson serve as a trustee director of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., following the 2011 Conference, to succeed Ken Brueggemann.
- Nancy Haynes serve as a general service trustee director on A.A. Grapevine, Inc., following the 2011 Conference, to succeed Dorothy Hurley.
- Michele Grinberg serve as a Class A trustee director on A.A. Grapevine, Inc., following the 2011 Conference, to succeed Frances Brisbane.
- The committee reviewed two resumes for nontrustee director to serve up to four years on Grapevine, Inc., following the 2011 Conference, and did not approve adding them to the slate. The committee also reviewed and approved the resume of A.A. Grapevine Board's candidate for executive editor/publisher.
- The committee approved the search for two new appointed committee members (A.C.M.s) for the trustees' Committee on Literature and approved the extension of one A.C.M. for the trustees' Committee on Public Information.

The committee agreed to continue to discuss: Nominating Procedure No. 9 "Guidelines for Hiring General Manager, G.S.O."; Nominating Procedure No. 10 "Hiring Procedures of AA Grapevine Executive Editor"; the selection process of the chairperson of the General Service Board; and a possible comprehensive plan for Class A recruitment.

John Kane, chairperson

Staff report: The staff member on this assignment is responsible to the trustees' Committee on Nominating, and to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. Since the last Conference, the staff member prepared background, minutes and reports for three quarterly trustees' committee meetings. The staff member also worked with the trustees' committee on vacancy announce-

ments, and coordinated the transcription and review of resumes for 36 regional trustee and trustee-at-large candidates who made their names available to participate in this year's Conference elections procedure.

For most of the year, this staff member also served as liaison for G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, responding to all inquiries, concerns and suggestions from A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and was responsible for maintaining the Web site in a professional manner, including keeping all information on the Web site current. For 2011 this staff member is the secretary to the A.A.W.S. Services Committee. In addition, the correspondent for the Southwest region of the United States is also the responsibility of this assignment, as is keeping A.A. Service Material up to date.

Mary Dargan

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on aa.org; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

Anonymity: The committee gave a thorough review to the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity," focusing on practical aspects of maintaining A.A. anonymity in the digital age. The committee also gave considerable time and effort to the project of drafting a policy regarding showing or not showing the faces of actors who are portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media. This policy was approved by the General Service Board on January 31, 2011 and has been forwarded as an agenda item to the Conference Committee on Public Information.

Communications with the Media — The committee reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, which was sent by e-mail and snail mail in May. The committee also updated the "A.A. Fact File," a major tool for the media.

Membership Survey — The committee reviewed draft distribution background for the 2011 survey of the A.A. Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada and has included on the Conference Agenda a request for an Advisory Action stating that the survey can be conducted.

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to aa.org, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2011 Conference Public Information Committee.

Television P.S.A.s — The committee chose West Glen Communications for distribution and tracking of the 2010 Television Public Service Announcement (P.S.A) "My World," in addition to the work done by local committees. All current A.A. TV P.S.A.s were reviewed and found to be relevant and useful.

The committee considered three 2010 Conference Committee on Public Information additional committee considerations on P.S.A.s and forwarded conclusions in the form of agenda items for the Conference Committee. The committee was also advised by

professionals in the field that an increase in the effectiveness of foreign language P.S.A.s depends on A.A. making new P.S.A.s in the native languages of the people we wish to reach and utilizing the services of firms staffed with personnel experienced both in producing material aimed at these particular demographic groups and distributing it to the appropriate TV stations (with contacts in the Hispanic and French broadcasting areas).

Utilizing New Media Platforms — The committee agreed to develop a comprehensive Public Information media plan. The committee used the new media platform of an Internet newsmagazine for an interview with Class A trustee Terry Bedient to highlight the P.S.A. "My World" and extend A.A.'s reach via a network of over 15 broadcast stations and more than 90 cable systems, with 86% of the 1,200 to 1,500 monthly airings occurring between 9 a.m. and 10 p.m.

Young People's Videos — The 2010 Conference-approved film submission for the A.A. Videos for Young Peoples project, "Animation," was made available October 10, 2010 for distribution in DVD format and streaming on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Also, A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, and La Vigne were contacted and asked to periodically post or print information about the project.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Pam Reising, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 950 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television and radio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In May 2010 it was e-mailed and mailed to over 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. The results of triennial surveys are published in pamphlet form and as a table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

Mary Clare Lynch

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Ten A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. The staff coordinator shares responsibility for corresponding with members from the Pacific Region, covering during the busy six months of the year for the Conference coordinator. In 2010, the staff received 63,031 pieces of correspondence by mail, e-mail and fax, an 18 percent increase over correspondence received in 2009. The staff also answers many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

G.S.O. staff members have the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

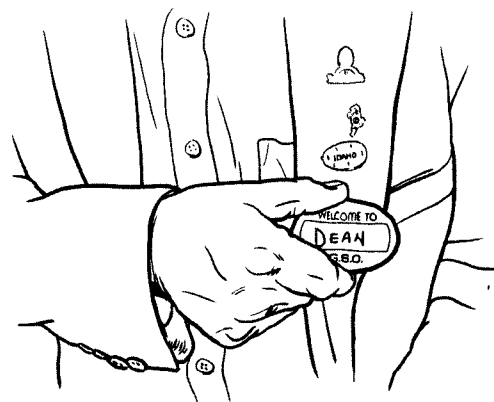
In 2010, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 2,114 individuals, in addition to English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

The staff coordinator serves as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Currently this assignment also serves as liaison to intergroup/central offices, providing shared experience upon request to these local service entities.

This staff member also serves as liaison for G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, responding to all inquiries, concerns and suggestions from A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, and is also the contact for maintaining the Web site in a professional manner, including keeping all information on the Web site current.

Rick Walker



■ Area Service Highlights— Panel 61 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alabama/Northwest Florida: Area 1 includes all of Alabama and the panhandle of NW Florida. There are 648 registered groups with over 9,500 members. One district is a linguistic district serving 13 Spanish-speaking groups located across the two states. Our area has grown and now has over 9,600 members. Area assemblies are held quarterly in Montgomery, Alabama, for two days. Usually 360 or more members participate, of which 195 are G.S.R.s. We also have translation equipment with a translator provided at no charge by the linguistic district. Our second quarterly is a Pre-Conference Assembly to discuss Conference Agenda items where all members are encouraged to attend. As a result our delegate is well-informed of the group conscience of the area. Each year the C.P.C. committee hosts a booth at the annual Professional Health Fair in North Alabama. Our other committees travel to districts to put on workshops when requested. Our Annual State Convention is usually held each year in September. Area 1 continues to grow, and at times experiences the pains of growing, but we will always remain humbly committed to carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous. I thank Area 1 for the honor and the privilege to serve as their Panel 61 delegate.—*Dennis Jaroslowski*

Arkansas: Area 4 includes the entire state of Arkansas. We have 246 active groups and 13 districts; 12 districts are geographic and one is linguistic and was just formed last year. We hold four two-day assemblies each year at a central location. Our state convention is the oldest A.A. Convention west of the Mississippi and is held each summer in historic Hot Springs, Arkansas. This year will be Old Grandad's 71st year. Our Archives is one of the finest and the committee takes pride in their restoration work. The corrections committee is active in coordinating meetings "behind the walls." The treatment facilities committee is active and has an established Bridging the Gap program. The Grapevine committee encourages subscriptions and has displays at all of our area assemblies and several conventions throughout the area. The Web site committee maintains a user friendly, service-oriented Web site. The C.P.C. and P.I. committees work closely together to inform our professional friends and the public about what A.A. is and what it is not. The Group Relations committee, comprised of the D.C.M.s from our 13 districts, shares experience and solutions from district to district. Our past delegates remain active and I rely a great deal on their experience. I am truly honored to have this opportunity to serve.—*Sunny Hill*

British Columbia/Yukon: Area 79 is approximately 900,000 sq. miles, which qualifies it as the second largest area in the Canada/U.S. service structure. Area 79 contains some districts that are the same size as the states of Mississippi and Maryland combined. From the southern most tip of British Columbia to the northern most tip of the Yukon Territories is a staggering 1,500 miles. BC/Yukon has 47 districts and 800 groups, many of which are serviceable only by ferry, small plane, boat or skidoo. A trip from Vancouver to Prince Rupert is just under 1/3 the length of Area 79 geographically, approximately 500 miles in a straight line. However, actual road travel, due to detours

around vast mountain ranges, rivers and lakes, extends the trip to approximately 20 hours and 950 miles, the equivalent distance from Vancouver to San Francisco. Challenges of distance, terrain and sparse population are met by the efforts of many, including an active Remote Communities committee. We have a number of meetings by telephone between groups and A.A. members in isolated communities, and a meeting has recently been established that links A.A. members in 14 isolated northern communities by video teleconference once a week. A recent upgrade to our area's Web site has added a password-secured portion through which our area committees can communicate with each other and with general service representatives. We have two quarterlies and two assemblies annually with 250-400 members attending. We have 95% participation by our districts. Locations for these meetings are chosen through a bidding process at our Pre-Conference Assembly. Area 79 participates in and hosts Forums and Western Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assemblies in our Western Canada Region, the most recent being a sold-out WRAASA in February this year.—*Scott Huyghebaert*

California (Central): Area 93 is now in its eleventh year. We have 26 active districts; 19 English and 7 Spanish. We have just reduced the number of our assemblies and area committee meetings from five to four, with an additional one-day pre-Conference workshop each year. Our committee chairs are appointed by the incoming area chairperson after conferring with the other elected officers. Districts place bids for our rotating area assemblies and our area committee meets in the same central location near Santa Barbara. Area 93 recently updated its old "Area Guidelines & Policies," which was adopted from Area 5 when we split, with a new "Area Guidelines," which should allow the area to grow for generations to come. Area 93's theme for Panel 61 is "The G.S.R.," with focus on improving communication between the G.S.R., the districts, the area, and the General Service Office. We have steady participation by our past delegates as they facilitate G.S.R. and D.C.M. sharing at each of our assemblies and maintain a (mostly) quiet presence waiting to be called upon when needed. Area 93 has an excess of 1,000 groups and we are quite diverse. From the coast to the mountains, high and low deserts to metropolitan suburbs, across cultural lines and many languages, we seek to be of service wherever possible in our own backyard.—*Ken Schmidt*

California (Northern Coastal): CNCA, Area 6, is a geographic area that extends over 500 miles, paralleling the Pacific Ocean from the California/Oregon border in the North to the Big Sur area in Monterey County in the South. Included within CNCA is a diverse landscape which includes majestic redwoods, coastal mountains, rolling hills, and, of course, the metropolitan San Francisco Bay Area with its 5-million-plus population. CNCA consists of over 2,000 A.A. groups. To serve them effectively, we use a district/subdistrict structure consisting of district committee member chairs that serve as the point of contact for the area. They then trickle information up from the D.C.M.s to the G.S.R.s and to the groups. We currently have 22 districts (including four Spanish-speaking linguistic districts), which in turn have 150 subdistricts. All of the subdistricts could have D.C.M.s, but only approximately half do. Our area committee meets monthly and hosts four assemblies per year. There are eight area officers in CNCA whose duties include visiting every district on a monthly basis. Within CNCA we have six standing committees that meet monthly as well: Finance, Public Information/Cooperation With the Professional Community,

Bridging the Gap, Interpretation and Translation, Web site and Archives. In the last two years we have faced many of the same challenges common to most A.A. service entities—stimulating interest, participation, and most recently, the big one: self-support. Our annual area budget is \$100,000. We're continually looking at ways to match our expenses to contributions. We annually spend \$14,000 for district travel, \$12,000 for Spanish translation at the area committee meetings and assemblies, \$11,000 for our monthly newsletter, and \$7,000 to house our archives.—*Ken Monson*

California (Southern): Area 5 has broadened our committee structure to better serve remote communities and those with special needs, as well as the average A.A. member. We've formed a very active standing committee on Cooperation With the Elder Community (CEC) that reaches out to seniors. Our new Panel 61 area officers have established an Ad-Hoc Corrections committee, tasked with investigating how our area assembly can cooperate with the local Hospitals & Institutions Intergroups, to better serve the large Southern California prison and jail population. Since Areas 5 and 93 split a decade ago, we have not undertaken a thorough inventory or discussion of dark districts, large districts, thinly populated districts, and the various combined district structures used throughout our area. Thus, we've tasked a new Ad-Hoc Structure Subcommittee to our Registration Standing committee to assure that all groups in Area 5 are appropriately represented by their districts and the area, "appropriately" being defined in whatever way the G.S.R.s decide. Area 5 stretches from Malibu to Pomona and from Pasadena to Inglewood along the Pacific Coast Highway and the Santa Monica Freeway. Our 33 districts are organized in a range of structures: 10 "stand-alone" districts each led by a D.C.M., two "combined districts" each led by a D.C.M.C. (our "Westside Combined" has recently grown from 13 to 15 districts and our "Hollywood-Downtown Combined" has shrunk from 5 to 3); and we have 5 "overlay" Spanish-language districts that cover the entire area and cooperate through an Interdistrict Committee meeting led by a D.C.M.C. Throughout our structure, Area 5 is blessed with many humble and hardworking trusted servants, carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Marcus Filipovich*

Colorado: Area 10 has 764 groups in 31 districts. We have a state-wide linguistic district for our Spanish-speaking members. Our Pink Can, which we pass for corrections literature, collected \$74,000 in 2010. On August 19th, we will celebrate our 70th anniversary of A.A. in Colorado. Notably, our growing districts finally figured out how to increase participation! First, by creating one-hour-a-month service tasks in the areas of P.I., Treatment, and Corrections. When members have done a couple of these one-hour service jobs, they catch fire. Even in small towns, we've seen district C.P.C. and P.I. committees grow to exceed 30 members! Secondly, by asking an older member to chair a committee, then filling that committee with young people, we get that truly miraculous combination of both clarity and energy, creating massively unforeseen effectiveness. Thirdly, we've seen that many times, the issues which are considered problems with Corrections are instead actually C.P.C. problems and can be resolved by increasing C.P.C. participation with Corrections professionals. Fourth, a local central office manager would get phone calls of people asking for meeting locations. She had the simple yet novel idea of asking if they'd ever been to A.A. before. Huge numbers of people said no, so we started sending someone out. As the result, in Denver we have increased the number of Twelfth Step calls by 400%. Finally, we

overcame the boundary fights so common among C.P.C. and P.I., Intergroup and general service and district and area. We put them in the same car and send them off to serve together. Then, participation, collaboration, and unity have all been greatly enhanced. Of course, not all is perfect. We struggle in a couple of areas: Between our traditionalists and our visionaries; when we rely too heavily on just one principle rather than looking to the 36 principles of the Three Legacies; conflict between those who want perfection now and those who see that we must grow toward it over time. In the final analysis though, Area 10, Colorado, is probably very much like your own areas: full of people who love A.A. with all of their hearts, saying only, "I owe my life to A.A. and am way behind on my payments."—*Tashi Gonpo*

Connecticut: Area 11 has ten districts, one of which is linguistic (Spanish-speaking) nongeographic. With 2,153 registered groups and about 40,000 members, we host many A.A.s in an area of only 5,543 square miles. Due to our geographic size, the delegate is able to visit all the districts regularly throughout the year to present reports, and obtain feedback from the groups. We host an area-wide Pre-Conference Assembly in April, where our members break out into round table groups, each discussing particular Conference Agenda items, reaching consensus and reporting back to the assembly. The results provide the delegate with a sense of the area's conscience for the Conference, ensuring wherever possible, A.A. group participation. We host an area-wide Spring Assembly for the purposes of reporting back the happenings at the Conference, as well as acting on other necessary area business. An area-wide Fall Assembly is held each November and in odd years all area officers are elected for the upcoming two-year terms. Our busy area service committee meets monthly 10 times a year for regular business meetings and twice for sharing sessions. Our 17 special service committees (five of which hold annual events) are all very involved and are getting the word of recovery from alcoholism out to the still-suffering alcoholic and the community at large. For more details of our area service committee please visit our awesome Web site ct-aa.org. Our newest committee is entitled Rompiendo Fronteras or Breaking Frontiers and is a day-long bilingual service event where both English and Spanish are spoken and translated simultaneously. I am honored and privileged to serve Area 11 as their delegate to the 61st General Service Conference.—*Christopher Shea*

District of Columbia: Area 13 encompasses groups in Washington, D.C., as well as Prince George's and Montgomery counties in Maryland. There are 483 groups, which includes three Hispanics districts: District 61 in Washington D.C.; District 62 in Virginia; and District 63 in Maryland. There are 48 Hispanics groups that are very active hosting service workshops throughout the year, including an annual Local Forum. We hold three assemblies and 11 committee meetings a year. We conduct an annual mini-Conference where area members, including the Latino community, discuss topics and agenda items of the annual General Service Conference, which gives the delegate the conscience of the area. The assembly also sponsors an Annual Gratitude Breakfast in November where the Seventh Tradition contribution is sent to the General Service Office. We are privileged to have 11 past delegates who serve as advisors to our committee chairs. We have maintained a great relationship with the Washington Area Intergroup Association. Our Grapevine committee is very active, attending service meetings and group anniversaries in the area. We also have one of the few La Viña committees in the country in District 63, Maryland. As Area 13 continues to grow, we try to keep in mind that the purpose of

every group and service meeting, including our General Service Conference, is to find a more successful way to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. I am really honored to represent Area 13 at the 61st General Service Conference. Visit us at our Web site, www.area13aa.org.—*Ricardo Castro*

Florida (North): Area 14 has over 800 registered groups as well as 19 groups "inside the walls." We hold four area assemblies a year, with an Area Inventory held in the even years. We have an active area Web site which contains our minutes in a password protected area, as well as what is going on in the area and a delegate's page to pass on information and schedules. We have 11 service committees to work with the districts in reaching the newcomer, those with special needs, those behind the walls and Spanish members of our Fellowship. We have enthusiastic support of the Grapevine and each assembly we give out many gift subscriptions. Our area is known in Archives as the "group history area," as we are actively working with the groups to document their history and traditions. We face the challenges of dark districts and are working on bringing back the sunshine to the Sunshine State.—*Cecilia M. Reid*

Florida (South), the Bahamas, U.S. and British Virgin Islands, Antigua, St Maarten, and the Cayman Islands: Area 15 stretches far beyond the map of Florida to several islands south of us. Our Remote Communities committee is still identifying other hard to reach populations such as the Seminole and Miccosukee Nations. Eighteen districts with 112 D.C.M.s representing 1,928 groups participate at four weekend quarterly assemblies each year. The Quarterly rotates within South Florida to districts who bid to host it. These weekends serve as a forum to share the ideas, plans, successes, and challenges of our very busy district-based committees. Our assemblies have both Spanish and American Sign Language (ASL) interpreters and an increasing number of sessions are also being interpreted at the Saturday committee meetings. The Linguistic Committee works to have all of our minutes and reports translated to improve communication. We have begun to post our minutes on the Area 15 Web site in a password protected area. There are also links to 15 Intergroup and several district Web sites to help carry the message of service and assist in finding meetings within our area. Our Young People have an active bid committee working hard to bring ICYPAA back to Florida. Our State Convention, with 2,000 to 4,000 in attendance joins Areas 14 and 15 for fun and fellowship. We are happy to have had over 1,000 members participate in the recent GV survey and hope to continue to encourage use of the Grapevine and La Viña in all of our committee work. I look forward to the coming months as I visit all of our districts to give a report of our 61st General Service Conference. We so often see a loving God in our group conscious giving us the assurance that we will continue to grow and thrive in the Sunlight of the Spirit in the Sunshine State. Thank you for the incredible and enormous privilege to serve Alcoholics Anonymous. —*Kathy Gutierrez*

Hawaii: Area 17 encompasses the whole of Hawaii, one of the most isolated island chains in the world. Our 14 districts serve six islands, each of which are separated by hundreds of miles of ocean. One of our districts serves the small islands of Lana'i and Moloka'i, plus the western section of Maui. We have three assemblies with two committee meetings in odd years and four assemblies with three committee meetings in even years. The location of each assembly or meeting is drawn by lot so that each district has a chance to host an event roughly every two

years. That keeps travel expenses high but goes a long way in fostering area unity. Unity within A.A. as a whole is achieved by participation at the biannual Regional Forum, at our annual PRAASA, and, of course, at the General Service Conference. Among the issues before the Panel 61 assembly is the approval of the revised workbook to be used by Cooperation With the Elder Community Standing Committee, translation of some of our literature into Tongan, and use of Internet Web-based conferencing for committee meetings. Hawaii is an ethnically diverse population that extends its Aloha to visitors from all over the world. Our state motto is The Life of the Land is Perpetuated in Pono—Guardianship with Honor and Decency. We think that motto fits together with the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous quite nicely.—*Linda McDole*

Illinois (Chicago): Area 19 has more than 2,800 weekly meetings and 23 districts, four of which are linguistic: one Polish district and three Spanish-speaking districts. We hold six assemblies a year with oral and written reports given by officers and committee chairs. Our groups, districts, and committees are active in hosting workshops, seminars and conferences. For example: our Archives committee will be working on a book to chronologically depict the history of Alcoholics Anonymous in the Chicago Area. The Public Information committee will have a cyberspace workshop and continue to work with media to get our public service announcements back on the air. Our Corrections committee has met with the director of the Illinois Department of Corrections, expressing the need for timely clearance of volunteers and providing information on what A.A. does and does not do as we carry our message into state facilities. This year Area 19 will host the Illinois State Conference with help from our neighbors in Areas 20 and 21. Our area newsletter, "Here's How," is published six times a year. Our 24-hour telephone answering committee has a member available for forwarded calls from 9:00 pm to 9:00 am. This year Chicago celebrates the 72nd Anniversary of its first group with the All Chicago Open. With attendance ranging from 7,000–10,000 it is clearly Chicago's largest meeting. The enthusiasm and participation in Area 19 continues to grow as we look forward to a bright future.—*Michael Hopkins*

Illinois (Southern): Geographically, Southern Illinois area encompasses the lower 2/3 of the state, approximately 38,000 square miles, and includes 17 districts with around 420 active groups. We have work ahead of us to restore communication and participation in the two districts that have been inactive and one whose engagement has been dimming. Our area assemblies are held every quarter, hosted by different districts. Area committee chairs hold a sharing session with district chairs and other interested parties and present a report to the group. Also, during the assemblies a G.S.R. workshop is held for the first-time G.S.R.s in attendance. Several past delegates are regular voting attendees at our area assemblies, and we benefit from their presence and experience. SIA's annual Corrections conference is going strong with participation from the other two Illinois Areas. The Corrections conference includes speakers and panels and provides a setting for exchanging ideas and raising awareness in and out of our Fellowship. Corrections personnel are encouraged to attend. The last Corrections conference was held in Springfield, in May 2010. Area 21 also hosts an annual Spring conference which was held in Fairview Heights, Illinois, March, 11 to 13 of this year. Activities included speaker meetings, A.A. and Al-Anon meetings and, of course, fellowship and fun.—*Fariba Murray*

Indiana (Northern): Area 22 consists of Northern Indiana, with boundaries just north of Indianapolis to the Michigan line, and the Illinois border to the Ohio border. It is comprised of 540 registered groups and 48 service districts, and ten standing committees that rotate chairpersons every two years. Area 22 has been a functioning area since 1986, when it split from Southern Indiana to better serve the groups as the numbers grew. The Area 22 assembly meets quarterly in February, May, August and November. The May assembly is on the Sunday following a weekend of service, fellowship and workshops and is dedicated to the delegate's report from the General Service Conference. Also, two D.C.M. conferences are held in March and October, with the March conference dedicated to getting feedback and a sense of the area's "voice" on agenda items for the General Service Conference, and the fall conference is dedicated to topics and presentations to help D.C.M.s in their tasks in the district and to help foster unity in the area. In July 2011, Area 22 will host the 58th Annual Indiana State Convention and East Central Regional Conference, with the theme of "Help, Hope and Happiness...Stay For the Miracle." The area now has a permanent repository for the Area 22 Archives. With the rotation and new area officers, the coming year promises to be an adventure and continued dedication in carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Ron Foor*

Iowa: Area 24 includes the entire state of Iowa, covering 56,276 square miles. The geographic center of Iowa is Ames; 42 miles east of Ames is Marshalltown, where our area committee meets three times annually—in January, March and August. At our January meeting, we have G.S.R. and D.C.M. orientations, service updates from our area chairs and officers, and typically a multi-person presentation on the Traditions, Concepts, or other relevant topic. During our March gathering, we review the General Service Conference Agenda items, giving our conscience to our delegate. We have two-day assemblies twice a year in June and October, which rotate to districts throughout the state based on bids brought before the area committee or assembly. These assemblies consist of G.S.R. and D.C.M. sharing sessions, committee workshops, voting sessions, a luncheon, banquet, a couple of speakers and an Area Officers Ask-It-Basket session. Area 24 currently has 607 active groups, 21 geographic districts and one Spanish-speaking linguistic district. Since District 22 began in 2009, it has expanded from a D.C.M. and a P.I. chair to a variety of chair positions, which is a promising sign. Our anticipated operating budget for the year is \$32,000. We currently have an ad-hoc committee reviewing our Assembly format to see if any changes are in order. Our Archives will be relocated to a storage facility in Marshalltown so it's centrally located and accessible for tours on the weekends of our committee meetings. I'm originally from Illinois, but God gave me new life through Alcoholics Anonymous in Iowa; it's an honor, privilege and pleasure to serve our Fellowship, particularly Area 24.—*Maureen Fordonski*

Louisiana: Alcoholics Anonymous is not only alive in Area 27, it is growing in many ways throughout the state of Louisiana. It is exciting to be a part of this growth. The 2010 *Conference Report* shows we have 491 registered groups with 9,686 members. These numbers reflect a 9% increase in the number of groups and a 3.5% increase in members from the 2009 *Conference Report*. Our area consists of 31 districts, with four central offices that currently serve the state. Due in part to the reconstruction of the Gulf Coast following hurricanes Katrina and Rita we've seen a large number of Hispanics move into our state. This past year we formed a linguistic district that encom-

passes the entire state and we now have nine registered Spanish-speaking groups with over 100 members. These newer members to our area are excited and eager to be involved in Alcoholics Anonymous. Many of their group members were present and able to participate in our assembly due to the area furnishing translation equipment and their district providing translators to assist with communication. In 2010, we opened an Archives Repository in Baton Rouge to preserve and display the history of Alcoholics Anonymous in Louisiana. We have quarterly assemblies each year, with an attendance ranging from 125-175 members, where those attending are young and old—oldtimers and newcomers who are motivated to participate in committees and stand for positions as officers and committee chairs. Our area supports an annual state convention, which rotates every two years around the state. We are pleased to announce that Louisiana will host the 2012 Southeast Conference August 9-12, in conjunction with our state convention in New Orleans.—*Randy Hale*

Massachusetts (Eastern): In Eastern Massachusetts, Area 30 has 2,200 meetings weekly. The immediate needs of the alcoholic who is looking for help are served by our one Spanish-speaking and five English-speaking intergroup/central offices. Formed in 1945, the Boston Central Service is home to our joint committee meetings, and also one of the General Service Office's top purchasers of Alcoholics Anonymous literature. Teaching hospitals, treatment centers, schools, prisons, and professionals are served by our seven Conference committees. Our Massachusetts State Convention, Internet, special needs, group updates, newsletters, and service seminars are taken care of by our six standing committees. Accessibility to area officers and committee chairs is gained through five area assemblies per year, twelve monthly area committee meetings, area road shows, and district outreaches. Continuing its reputation as the Hub, Area 30, together with Area 31, Western Massachusetts, will be the home of the 2011 Northeast Regional Forum. And both Areas will also co-host the 2012 Northeast Regional Delegates Meeting. From Sturbridge to Boston, the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous is alive and well in Eastern Massachusetts.—*Kevin Nangle*

Michigan (Central): Area 32 is in service to 1,099 registered A.A. meetings in 14 districts in an area spanning 300 miles north to south and up to 125 miles east to west at our widest point. We assemble as an area six times each year, rotating assemblies among our districts. A large number of A.A.s are invested in service in Area 32 to ensure that the hand of A.A. is in place for those now in, or yet to join, our Fellowship. Area committees include Cooperation With the Professional Community, Corrections, Literature, Public Information, Treatment, Special Needs, Grapevine, Web site and others. Area committees provide appropriate support for local district A.A. services. We are grateful for the fine support by the General Service Office. Dedicated area officers, archivist, registrar and others provide for our area organizational needs. Area 32 is blessed by decades of experience shared by our past delegates and past committee chairs and officers who continue to attend area assemblies and share their experience with our committees and attend our many district workshops and special events. We do our best in unity to put forth the hand of A.A. in the most effective and appropriate service in all of our affairs, including fellowship in service with other areas and organizations. We seek the preservation and growth of A.A. services in Area 32 for the grace that we have all received as a result of the A.A. Fellowship in our lives. We want all, both in or yet to join the Fellowship of A.A., to find

the pathway to Recovery on their journey to sobriety in our groups. The Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts of Service continue to be guidelines for services throughout Area 32. We adhere to the principles of the A.A. recovery program and Fellowship, that have so freely been given to us by our founders and others who preceded us in service to Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Art Mohr*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33, located in Southeast Michigan, includes Detroit and the five surrounding counties. We have roughly 814 active groups with 20,764 members. There are 24 geographic districts and one language district, #701. We participate in a Statewide Service Committee with Area 32, Central Michigan, and Area 34, Western Michigan. Together, Areas 32, 33 and 34 host an annual State Convention. We also conduct a Mock Conference to help educate and inform our delegates and other members on Conference procedures and select agenda items. We meet monthly at a fixed location where G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, committees and officers share reports and conduct the business of Area 33. Our assemblies are open to all members and I have seen attendance from as few as 60 to as many as 200. We hold a March Round-up, which funds many area activities, including the delegate's expenses for this Conference. Area 33 has 14 standing committees. Our Special Needs committee distributed Grapevine subscriptions to nursing homes and homebound alcoholics this year and is reaching out to Veterans of Foreign Wars, the Deaf and Hard of Hearing, alcoholics that have trouble reading and non-English-speaking members. Our Corrections committee acquired and distributed \$10,934.00 worth of A.A. literature and Grapevines to jails and prisons last year and has developed online tools to organize volunteers and coordinate outreach to every state- and county-run facility in the area. The Archives committee recently presented a report at area chronicling early A.A. in Detroit, showing media support and its effect in the growth of A.A. in Detroit, which is still drawing comments and generated a lot of interest. Our Web chair, registrar and secretary are working together to contact new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, welcoming them to our area. Our Treatment, Corrections, C.P.C. and P.I. chairs cooperate with our Special Events chair to host an annual Professional Luncheon. We have a Film committee, Literature and Grapevine committees, a Finance committee and a large standing committee for the March Round-up, as well as several Liaison positions for local intergroup offices and MYCPAA. Area 33's past delegates are active and were instrumental in our successful bid to host the International Convention. See you in the D in 2020.—*Fred Crandel*

Minnesota (Southern): Area 36 is identified as the southern half of Minnesota, including the Twin Cities of St. Paul and Minneapolis. Our 27 districts serve roughly 1,100 registered groups, including our Spanish-speaking linguistic district. We hit the ground running in our new rotation this year, starting with our annual "Recovery, Unity and Service Conference" using the theme and presentation topics from this year's General Service Conference, followed soon after by the "Trusted Servant Leadership Training," geared toward group, district and area service, offering something for everyone. We hold three full-day assemblies, four area committee meetings and the delegate's workshop, where the General Service Conference agenda items are discussed by the standing committees, and others attending have an opportunity to share on each of the items. In alternate years we hold an Area Inventory. All of our area committees are very busy reaching out and coordinating the efforts of the districts. Our Archives committee sent a committee member to the

National A.A. Archives Workshop in Macon, Georgia. Both the Temporary Contact Program and Correctional Facilities Contact Program have been successfully connecting people coming out of treatment and correctional facilities with A.A. members. Our Remote Communities committee is actively reaching out. Our C.P.C. committee participated in six major conferences, three of which were National Conferences with a focus on Social Service workers and Family Physicians. Our Public Information committee, in conjunction with Northern Minnesota Area 35, staffs the Minnesota State Fair P.I. booth for 12 days each year. Moving the P.I. booth from the Grandstand to the Educational Building saw more visitors requesting information. Many districts participate in local county fairs in our area as well. Even if all A.A. members were involved in General Service, there would be more work to do. I am most grateful for the love and support of my area and the opportunity to be Southern Minnesota's contribution to the General Service Conference as a Panel 61 delegate.—*Angie Ellison*

Missouri (Eastern): Area 38 is a geographically and ethnically diverse area with a rich A.A. service history, including the 1955 International Convention held in St. Louis when A.A. "Came of Age." We currently serve 544 groups with 9,089 members from 23 districts, and encompass 32,000 square miles. Roughly half of our districts are in the St. Louis metro area, with the other half in small outlying cities and rural counties. The area holds four one-day assemblies per year in St. Louis, with a two-day election assembly in which we invite special guests, such as G.S.O. staff members, regional trustees, and Class A trustees emeriti. We also co-host an annual state convention along with Area 39, Western Missouri, a well-attended event which not only provides fellowship for the two areas, but also emphasizes the service structure and how to get involved. All but two of our districts are represented at the area, and all ten of our standing committees are actively carrying the message. Our annual budget has increased by nearly 50% in the past 10 years, a reflection of the overall growth and increased participation in Area 38. After many years in cramped offices over a local car dealership, the Eastern Area Office and Archives recently moved to a wonderful new location, along with the St. Louis Intergroup and Al-Anon Family Group offices. The ribbon-cutting ceremony and open house this past July brought all three service entities and both Fellowships together for a great celebration and time of reflection and gratitude for blessings received. It is both an honor and a privilege to serve the Fellowship and Area 38 as delegate.—*Laura Vandivort*

Missouri (Western): Area 39 covers approximately 34,443 square miles of drunkenness. Area 39 is vigorously trying to carry the message to every square mile of our area through our corresponding Conference committees and our area subcommittees. It is our goal to pinpoint the problems in our area and devise a solution to better carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic through our 220 registered groups that make up our 16 districts, and through our two central offices, one in Kansas City and the other in Springfield. Our four two-day assemblies meet in January, March, June, and September in the centrally located town of Sedalia. On Saturday of our assembly we start the day off with announcements, then we break into our G.S.R. sharing session, which is chaired by our area alternate chairperson and our D.C.M. sharing session, which is chaired by our alternate delegate. Saturday afternoon we have our standing committee and subcommittee meetings. Saturday evening is reserved for our area officer reports followed by our past delegate comments. Sunday morning is the business portion of our assembly. We

have the reading of the minutes of the last assembly followed by our treasurer's report. Then, we address any old business, followed by any new business. Our area has the privilege of unity in working with our counterpart, Area 38, Eastern Missouri, in putting on the Missouri State Convention, held usually in July in Jefferson City. Area 39 also has a function called Institutions Weekend where we invite professionals that correspond with our area standing committees to participate on workshop panels with our A.A. members to better carry the message. In the fall we have the Western Area of Missouri Convention held in Branson, Missouri. I cannot tell you how much of a privilege and honor it is to serve as delegate of the Western Area of Missouri, Area 39. If there is anything that I or our area can do to help you or your area, please do not hesitate to ask.—*Steve Price*

Montana: Area 40 encompasses about 144,500 square miles of the state of Montana and a little bubble up near the Northwest corner that is part of Washington State East, Area 92. Our area has a total population of less than a million people, or about seven people per square mile. We have 14 districts and around 292 registered groups. Our Web site lists 858 meetings a week across our far-flung area. From the Tobacco Valley Group in Eureka, near the Northwest corner of our area, to the Baker Group down in Southeastern Montana, it is a 670-mile drive. From the Lima Traveler's Group deep in Southwestern Montana to the Plentywood Group in the Northeastern corner of our area, it is a 663-mile drive. Our area also contains seven Federal Treaty Reservations, peopled by over a dozen recognized tribes and quite a number of Native Americans with other tribal heritages, together with non-Indians who also live and work on the reservations. In terms of cultural and linguistic diversity, and pretty much every other kind of diversity, we have lots of challenges in assuring that the hand of A.A. is always there whenever any alcoholic reaches out for help. Each year we have a spring assembly, before the General Service Conference, and a fall assembly, both always held in the center of our area, and over the last ten years (five rotations), all 14 of our districts have participated in seven out of the ten assemblies, with only one district missing the other three assemblies. We've averaged about 105 voting members at each assembly, with around 37 nonvoting members also present, from newcomers coming with their sponsors to past delegates. We are currently preparing for a two-day Local Forum this coming June, with a day each in Great Falls and Miles City, Montana. Then we have a National Archives Workshop coming to Helena, Montana's state capital, in September 2011. We are also preparing to host the 2012 West Central Regional Service Conference in Billings, March 2-4 next year. Come and see us anytime. The coffee is hot and the lights are on.—*Terry Spear*

Nevada: Area 42 consists of the state of Nevada plus the Eastern part of California. The area serves two major population centers, one North and one South, separated over seven hours by car. Our physical geographic dispersion has led to a somewhat odd service structure. We have separate service structures for North, South and the area overall. Elections are held in even years for all positions, with area positions filled half from the North and half from the South. We also have overlapping positions—for example, an alternate Area 42 delegate will also serve as the chair, either North or South, depending on where they reside. Each of the service groups, North, South and Area are supported by separate treasuries and we have separate intergroup/central offices. Our structure ensures that A.A. is supported throughout our area, especially in rural/remote places. We obviously suffer from operational inefficiencies, but we also have more than the

usual number of service positions, which helps optimize involvement. I am unaware of any unique issues in our area—neither any “causes” nor “loving discussions.” We experience the 80/20 phenomenon—20% of our members do 80% of A.A. service work. Our financial position is good. Area activities include an annual Round-up over Thanksgiving weekend with some 2,000+ attendees, two area assemblies (March and September), a regular newsletter and an interactive Web site in both English and Spanish. We will host the Young Peoples Conference in 2012. We are proud of having provided two regional trustees, Ruth J. and Julian R., and especially proud to have Roberta L. currently serving as one of the general service trustees. I look forward to continuing my journey over the balance of the week plus sharing and exchanging ideas with all participants here at the General Service Conference.—*Byron Ford*

New Jersey (Northern): Area 44 has 42 districts serving approximately 1,225 groups. The groups are represented by 37 D.C.M.s, with five of our districts being clustered. Districts are grouped into six sections, each with a coordinator. We have two active Spanish-speaking districts and a permanent committee on Translations. Five of our seven standing committees, and two special committees, are jointly chaired and jointly funded in cooperation with Northern New Jersey Intergroup. We hold six area committee meetings a year, three assemblies and one Mini-Conference. The area recently voted that the June assembly be dedicated as a comprehensive Post-Conference Report. We conduct a year-end inventory at our annual three-day Work Weekend. Area highlights include our G.S.R. Mid-Winter Luncheon in February, our annual Convention in September, and committee workshops held throughout the year. Attendance at area events has been improving dramatically as we work to make assemblies recovery events, using workshops and presentations in addition to the business agenda. I am humbled to be an active participant and trusted servant of the area and of A.A. as a whole, and I am grateful for the opportunity to give back to the Fellowship that saved my life.—*Wayne Ross*

New York (Central): Area 47 is comprised largely of the Finger Lakes region of New York State, although we do represent A.A.s as far north as the St. Lawrence River and, in the south, a small population of groups in northern Pennsylvania. To drive from one end to the other, either North-South or East-West, will take about three hours. Our assembly meets at a different location each time; districts are asked to host the assembly, the reason being exposure. It is not required that they provide a meal, but it seems that there is always a fine spread, and no one leaves hungry. We have new observers at each assembly. There are eight cluster districts with the city of Rochester being a district all its own. Of these districts we have 24 registered district committee people and their alternates. We have seven officers on the Area Committee, ten committee chair people, an Archivist and a sound person. Also, eleven past delegates serve, when they are called upon, to support us. We meet eleven times a year as an assembly, and once at our Central New York Convention, which is held soon after the Conference for the purpose of the delegate's Conference report. If I were to guess an average, I would say about 80 members attend our meetings, and 150 at our conventions. Some of the things that our area has done since I have been coming have been: The “Corrections Connection,” a joint meeting with people from the New York State Department of Corrections and members of Alcoholics Anonymous; there has been talk at the Treatment committee of doing a similar thing with staff from the many treatment facilities in our area. We now have a very nice Web site. A.A. literature is available at our

assemblies at a reduced cost, the result of volume buying, and a hard-working literature representative. We share responsibility for the New York State Convention and the Informational Workshop with the other three areas in New York State, as this event moves each year to another area, and in recent years our delegates have spent time with the other New York State delegates discussing some common problems and helping with their solutions.—*Tom Terry*

New York (Southeast): Area 49, Southeast New York, stretches from the tip of Long Island in the South to Sullivan County in the North. We have over 2,000 groups, of which 1,827 are registered. We consist of twelve counties, as well as a very active nongeographical Spanish district. Area 49 holds five full-day assemblies per year, with workshops in the morning and full assemblies in the afternoon. We also hold seven committee meetings annually, which are held independently of our assemblies. We hold a Delegate's Day of Sharing each year, which is a full-day event and includes presentations on the Conference Agenda items. This Day of Sharing allows our G.S.R.s to have more complete information when presenting the delegate's questionnaire to their groups, ensuring a more informed group conscience. Our Translation committee members provide English to Spanish translation at all of our area committee meetings, assemblies and conventions and are available for translation at area Share-a-Days, workshops and unity breakfasts. Our minutes, area newsletter "The LINK," and other written materials are translated from English to Spanish. Additionally, for the first time we offered Polish and Russian translation at our November 2010 assembly. Our Archives committee has recently completed our updated Area 49 History Book. Our Accessibilities/Special Needs committee continues to stay in the forefront of special needs service, and our C.P.C. committee continues to facilitate the Doctor's Program. SENY holds an annual area convention, except in the year we host the New York State Convention. We also participate in an annual Informational Workshop with the other three areas of New York State, where all four areas share how they continue to do their Twelfth Step work. Area 49 continues to carry the message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic as widely and inclusively as possible.—*Susan Flynn*

North Carolina: The infamous Area 51 is commonly known as the most secretive place in the United States, but not to us alcoholics who have already been rocketed into the fourth dimension of existence. No, it is the beautiful Tarheel State of North Carolina—Home of Krispy Kreme Doughnuts! Area 51 is comprised of 1,076 groups and 17,000 plus members; English-speaking districts serve 1,040 groups. We also have three Spanish linguistic districts serving 36 Spanish-speaking groups. Area 51 has 56 active Corrections groups and hosts an annual Corrections conference, Freedom from Bondage. We have active coordinators for P.I./C.P.C., Treatment, Grapevine, and Literature. The area committee meets four times a year, one of which is a mock conference. Our area assemblies occur twice a year, where G.S.R.s have full participation with a vote. Our state runs from the beautiful Blue Ridge Mountains to the gorgeous Outer Banks. There are three distinct geographic areas: the Coastal Plains, the Piedmont, and the Mountains. These areas host annual pre-Conference events to involve Area 51 members and to inspire leadership in service. We celebrate our sobriety at our annual State Convention. This year it will be held in conjunction with the 67th Southeast Regional Convention. When I came to A.A. I wanted to be so different that I tried to separate myself from you. It was through your pain that I was brought out of isolation,

into my first home group, and was presented with a solution that offered me freedom. In Area 51 we experience many victories and many struggles, just like many of your areas do, but through God's Grace we have a unified message that keeps us from isolation. Words alone cannot begin to express my gratitude and love for Alcoholics Anonymous and to have the opportunity to serve with you all this week in ensuring the continued unity of Alcoholics Anonymous and the message of recovery. Area 51 does not wish to be a secret; we alcoholic aliens have been well-prepared by great leadership to welcome you with Love and Service.—*Jennifer Davidson*

North Dakota: Area 52 has over 3,300 members in 163 groups within its 12 districts. It covers the entire state of North Dakota, nearly 70,000 square miles, and includes a few groups along Minnesota's western border. The most recent past delegate chairs two schools for our G.S.R.s each year. They meet the first two Saturdays in February, the first time in the western part of the state and the second time in a more central location. The area committee, G.S.R.s, and other trusted servants meet at three assemblies each year. The first is held the third weekend in March, the second is the first weekend in June and the final one is the third weekend in September. At our March assembly the Finance committee works hard to prepare a budget for the year with full assembly approval. Before the weekend concludes, an audit committee, made up of three members of the Finance committee, recommends closure on the treasurer's books for the previous year, provided they find them to be in order. The area service conference is also held this weekend, discussing the General Service Conference Final Agenda items. The March assembly is alternated yearly between two central locations. The June assembly is held in cities too small to host the State Roundup. The September assembly is held the same weekend as the State Roundup. Area elections are held every other year. Friday night's workshop at last year's State Roundup featured an informative session about Anonymity and the Internet. Traffic on our area Web site: aanorthdakota.org, is growing each year. Opportunities to extend the hand of A.A. to newcomers, helping new groups get started, and a number of other services for existing members, are growing right with it. I am extremely honored to serve Area 52 as their Panel 61 delegate.—*Neil Faber*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: I bring greetings from your A.A. friends in "The Far East" (Eastern Canada). Area 82 encompasses the provinces of Nova Scotia and Newfoundland/Labrador with a population of 2 million spread over 115,000 square miles. Travel is a real challenge for our 3,400 members in 225 groups and 17 districts, as we are separated by the 90 mile-wide Cabot Strait. Service weekends, in Newfoundland and Nova Scotia in May, are timed for the delegate's Conference report. The delegate's final Conference report is presented at area assembly in October and copies given to the D.C.M.s for distribution to their groups' G.S.R.s, and the five area officers give reports at the service weekends and area assembly, and along with past delegates conduct workshops and sharing sessions. Some 20 Provincial and District Round-ups are held in the area each year fostering unity and a M.C.Y.P.A.A. (Maritime Conference of Young People in A.A.) takes place in May, with area funding and support. The theme "We Are All on the Same Journey." The Archives committee is digitizing our area history and the Remote Communities committee is making real progress reaching out to our Native communities in Labrador by conference calls, and translating material into the Inuit and Inuk languages. Area 82 is blessed with a very dedicated group of

trusted servants who through our active area committees are committed to carrying the message of Hope and Sobriety to the still-suffering alcoholic. I am truly humbled and grateful to be here this week as their delegate.—*Don Fitzpatrick*

Ohio (Central/Southeast): Area 53 encompasses 38 counties in central and southeast Ohio, with 773 registered groups in 34 districts and three intergroup offices. An ad hoc committee on redistricting recommended, and the assembly approved, the consolidation of districts in the greater Columbus area (Franklin County) that reduced the number of districts from 42 to 34. Assemblies are held quarterly and area committee meetings are also quarterly in the month following the assembly. The March assembly is held in conjunction with our mini-Conference where attendees are made aware of current Conference issues and discuss those issues in committee, then present their recommendations to the mock Conference. Our standing committees of C.P.C./P.I., Group Services, Grapevine, Treatment Facilities, Archives and, the most recent addition, Special Needs/Accessibility are actively serving the community with displays and literature. Using money from their "Change for Change" jug program, the C.F.C. committee purchased over \$16,000 worth of Conference-approved material in 2010 for distribution to inmates in the correctional facilities in our area and to some outside our area. The C.P.C./P.I. committee distributes literature to the professional community, as well as the public, and the committee cooperates with our Treatment Facilities committee and the P.I. committee from one of the intergroup offices. The area continues to serve on the state convention planning committee with members from the three other areas in Ohio. It is indeed an honor and a privilege to serve Area 53 as their delegate and to take part in the 61st General Service Conference.—*Glen Peden*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 is bordered on the north by Lake Erie, by the Pennsylvania border at the east, at the west by Sandusky, Ohio, and by Massillon, Ohio, at the south. We take great pride that we are in the birthplace of Alcoholics Anonymous. We celebrate in Akron, Ohio, Founders Day every second weekend in June. Visitors arrive from all over the world. We serve approximately 1,200 active groups and have another 700 that are inactive or unknown. We total approximately 2,000 groups in our history. We enjoy a membership of approximately 23,000. We serve and cooperate with eight intergroups and central offices in our area, and hold four assemblies and four committee meetings per year. We have an Open House Picnic in the summer and a Gratitude Banquet in November. Since 1975, just prior to the General Service Conference, we hold the Area 54 Mini-Conference, which allows every attendee to be a delegate-in-training—discussing, debating and voting on agenda items. We are blessed to have benefited from the four Absolutes, which were passed on to us. We are still embedded deeply in sponsorship. Since we adapted the G.S.R. School from Area 53, we have had an increase in participation. We have held three G.S.R. workshops throughout the area over the last 12 months. We have more interest, including volunteering on committees on the district level, as well as on the area level, of general service. I am blessed to be serving with people who are totally committed to the Third Legacy of Service.—*Bob Denihan*

Oklahoma: Area 57, the entire state of Oklahoma, has approximately 7,100 members, 383 groups and eight districts, with 19 to 79 groups per district. We have quarterly area committee meetings where our 48 D.C.M.s (six per district) vote and make motions, and one area assembly. Each group's G.S.R. and alter-

nate G.S.R. has a vote at the area assembly and at their quarterly district meetings. This past year our "modified" voting procedures for our one-day area assembly were modified to be closer to Third Legacy voting procedures. Because our groups want to keep our one-day area meetings and assembly, we have three rounds (instead of five) before going to the hat. Our Hispanic groups have developed a subdistrict within our District 20 and their service efforts are growing rapidly. We are continuing to work on better communication with all our groups through our Web site, e-mails and D.C.M. visits. Our state-sponsored workshops help reach the rural areas of the state. Fun in the Fellowship, a mini-service conference, is continuing to emerge as a vehicle to attract more service participation. Many of our rural areas have dealt with being overrun with court appointees by coming up with a more structured beginners meeting format, and our urban areas are continuing the P.I. information/BTG type sessions with those being sent to us through the DUI/Drug Court system. It has been very interesting to see all the sharing by members on the topics of the Grapevine survey and the issues surrounding anonymity and the positive uses of Facebook and A.A. in our electronic age. Area 57 is also seeing a rise in the number of people with longer sobriety getting back into service work, which is awesome!—*Alan Hennesy*

Ontario (Eastern): Area 83, Eastern Ontario International, is comprised of approximately 580 registered groups (including 20 correctional groups) in 28 districts spread across 35,000 sq. km in South Eastern Ontario and North West New York State. We have one linguistic district that serves an active Spanish population in our area. Service to Alcoholics Anonymous is strong in our area as evidenced by the number of members letting their name stand for area positions. We had 10 to 12 people on the ballot for almost every position. We hold two assemblies each year supplemented by seven area committee meetings over the two-year term. Approximately 40% of the groups in Area 83 are represented at each of our assemblies, while almost all districts are represented at our area committee meetings. We have one dark district. Our area also meets once a year, prior to the General Service Conference, with the other three areas in Ontario at our Ontario Delegates Committee Meeting. All members are welcome to attend and be a part of the sharing of all four delegates and their alternates about service in Ontario. We are also an active member, via our alternate delegate, of the Remote Communities workgroup that was formed last year and includes the majority of the delegate areas in Canada, as well as Area 2 Alaska. At our January Area Committee Meeting this year we appointed a new Area Archivist as well as a new Area Webmaster. Alcoholics Anonymous is alive and well in Area 83 and I am honoured to have a small part in the large picture that is carrying our message of hope to those who are still suffering.—*Robb Watson*

Ontario (Northeast): We have seven districts: Nipissing-Parry Sound, Sudbury West, Algoma, Temiskaming Cochrane, North Shore, Manitoulin, and Sudbury East. This vast area extends from the southern shores of Hudson Bay, and serves such communities as Fort Albany and Moose Factory to the northern shores of Lake Huron, where our smallest district, Manitoulin Island is found. Fort Albany and Moose Factory have often had entire communities evacuated and moved to safety because of floods or fires. We have French, English, Ojibwa, and Cree speaking groups. We have 232 groups with 98 of them inactive. There is an estimated 1,200 to 1,500 A.A. members. Committees working with Remote Communities have begun to help some of our dark districts become active. Most C.P.C., P.I.C., T.F.C. and Corrections are active in our seven districts. A New Medical

School in North Bay is a major focus of our largest two district population centre. Most Treatment Centres, Penal Institutions, and Psychiatric Centres are home to at least one A.A. meeting. In North Bay, doctors' offices recently accepted and currently display A.A. pamphlets, and some have called to let us know when they needed to be replenished. Area 84 committee meets three times a year (February, June, November) aside from the General Sharing Session (April) and the Area Assembly (September). There is also much activity and fun to be had. The 43rd Annual Northeast Ontario Area 84 Convention was celebrated October 8, 9, 10, 2010 in Sault Ste. Marie. North Bay will hold it in 2011, and Sudbury in 2012. Also in 2011, District 4 Convention, in May, Timmins, Ontario; District 5, Heritage Weekend in February, Elliot Lake; District 6, Round-Up, in May in Manitoulin.—*Gerrie Dubien*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 consists of seven districts, 83 groups and approximately 1,600 members. We hold two assemblies, one in the spring and one in the fall. We presently do not hold area committee meetings but we do communicate online through the Internet when the need arises with the executive committee. As delegate, I have chosen to meet with the chair of our area and the alternate delegate at least once a month. I have contacted District 1, Thunder Bay Area, concerning the presentation of a brief report at their meetings, when need be. Every three months we are involved with the Inter Canadian/Alaska Remote Communities work group, which is done by teleconference with our Remote Community chair. These meetings are designed to be able to help or ask questions and find ways we can help each other to reach out to our remote communities. The first meeting for 2011 took place January 17th and was well represented. Area 85 held an election at our Fall Assembly and presently we have four positions open, which we hope to have filled soon. Thank you for allowing me to give the highlights of Area 85, Northwest Ontario.—*Gerry Goulet*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 comprises the eastern half of Pennsylvania—23,000 square miles. It is home to over 1,500 A.A. groups and more than 32,000 members. We hold one annual assembly, combined with a convention. In November 2010 we had nearly 1,000 attendees and almost 600 voters. Our method of conducting business is modeled on that of the General Service Conference. The area committee, made up of 48 D.C.M.s and six area officers, meets quarterly and operates primarily via the work of eight standing subcommittees and two ad hoc committees. Every D.C.M. is assigned to one of these committees, with a chair appointed by the delegate. Besides the quarterly business meetings, we hold a number of other service events and an annual Pre-Conference Sharing Session—open to all A.A. members, which advises the delegate on selected Conference agenda items; an annual mini-assembly at which the delegate reports back to the Fellowship on the Conference, Share-A-Days with several of our 12 Intergroups and Central Offices; an Area Day late in the Panel to inform the Fellowship about general service and to generate enthusiasm for it; a mid-panel area inventory; a D.C.M. Orientation early in the panel; and if the D.C.M.s so choose, a mid-panel D.C.M. sharing session. During the last two years, Area 59 established a procedure to fill vacancies in the alternate delegate position; created a position for an assistant archivist; along with Area 60 (Western Pennsylvania), hosted a hospitality suite at the 2010 International Convention; was awarded the hosting of NERAASA 2013, to be held in Lancaster; and enhanced the area Web site by making it bilingual, putting the delegate's Conference report online and redesigning the entire site.—*Hugh D. Hyatt*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 has approximately 850 registered groups in 41 districts. Our yearly calendar consists of four quarterly meetings, three assemblies and an annual Get Away Weekend that culminates in our Pre-Conference Assembly, where we hear presentations and have discussions on selected Conference Agenda Items. Six to eight Days of Sharing, hosted by one or more districts working together, offer opportunities for fellowship and generate enthusiasm among the membership. Area coordinators have traveling displays that are taken to various functions when invited. Our Area Web site (www.wpaarea60.org) simplifies access to information about activities of interest. Area 60 enjoys a lengthy history with Alcoholics Anonymous, beginning with our first meeting in Pittsburgh, which was held December 13, 1940, in the Henry Hotel; Bill Wilson spoke at the first anniversary dinner of that meeting and Dr. Bob Smith spoke at the second anniversary when over 500 were in attendance. Area 60 is committed to encouraging participation in service. It is an honor and a privilege for me to serve Area 60 and the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as the Panel 61 delegate.—*Jean Martin*

Quebec (Northeast): It is with great pride and pleasure that I introduce Area 89 to you. It is located in the Northeastern part of the Province of Quebec, in Canada. At the heart of our area is Quebec City to the Northeast, the North Shore—the most remote part of our area, a 10-hour drive from Quebec City—to the North is the Saguenay-Lac-Saint-Jean region, to the West, the Mauricie, and just South of Quebec City is Lévis, on the South shore of the St. Lawrence River. Our area has 23 districts. Our Area committee meets four times per year and we hold two general assemblies each year. All our districts are represented at our Area committee meetings, and our general assemblies are attended by more than 50% of the G.S.R.s. What distinguishes us is that our groups are almost all unilingual French. Of our 298 groups, 286 are French-speaking, four are English-speaking, two are bilingual, and six are Native North American. We now have our first Native G.S.R., which makes us very happy. Our seven service committees are very active, among them a Seminar committee that, over the years, has presented workshops on the Traditions, the Concepts, the Seventh Tradition and Spirituality, on the function of the G.S.R., and on Sponsorship. All of this provides our area with better-informed members and servants. For those of you wishing to learn more, there was a story about this committee in the April-May 2009 issue of *Box 4-5-9*. This year, we were fortunate to host the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in Trois-Rivières, attended by 788 members wishing to meet G.S.O. representatives and to learn more about our fraternity. I am privileged to serve in an area that respects the A.A. principles and Traditions, a very healthy area. And it is with gratitude that I represent my friends, the A.A. members, and I thank them for giving me the opportunity to live this experience.—*Estelle Falardeau*

Quebec (Southeast): Area 88, Quebec Southeast, covers a vast territory. Created in December 1974, it is bordered to the West by Lac St-Pierre, to the East by the Magdalen Islands, to the North by the St. Lawrence River, and to the South by the U.S. Border. In September 2010, our Area had 18 districts representing 172 groups. There are 200 meetings with 2,070 registered members. Each year, we hold three area meetings and one general assembly to elect our trusted servants. Our area can rely on the important contribution of five service committees: Public Information, The Vine, C.P.C., Web, and Archives. In addition, we participate in three interarea meetings with the other Quebec areas. Our new structure will allow us to focus on participation

and communication. To do so, we organize seminars to introduce our members to the A.A. structure and tell them about the importance of the G.S.R.s. We hold two Gratitude Dinners each year, the proceeds of which are sent in their entirety to G.S.O. to help the still-suffering alcoholic. It is a nice way to show our gratitude for A.A. A few months before the Conference, each district holds a sharing day about the General Service Conference workshop to give the delegate a sense of the groups' conscience. I wish to express my gratitude towards our wonderful fraternity and the trusted servants who accompany me on my progression. May God enlighten and protect us all.—*Guy Lafontaine*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 consists of the Province of Saskatchewan, with a land mass of slightly more than 650,000 sq. km., or 250,000 sq. mi., and a population around the 1,000,000 mark. We have approximately 275 groups and a membership of about 3,300. Our area has 20 districts, mostly rural, with only two urban centres with multiple districts. We hold two area assemblies annually and one separate area committee meeting. Approximately 35-40% of the groups are represented at each of our assemblies, with usually 100% of the D.C.M.s being present. Our assembly funds the D.C.M.s as well as the table officers and committee chairs to attend every area meeting. We have committees for Bridging the Gap, District Development/ Remote Communities, Corrections and Archives, as well as a Web servant. Each committee chair and elected or appointed position has a table officer assigned to work with them. Our Corrections contact is aided in his task by our Pink Can Fund, providing the monies necessary to get A.A. Conference-approved literature into our federal and provincial penal institutions. District Development/ Remote Communities attempts to carry the message of general service to the far reaches of our area, assuring the folks who are somewhat isolated distance-wise that they are not alone, we are here to assist. Bridging the Gap was formed about five years ago, and appears to work well for the treatment clients who want it. Our penal system does not lend itself to allowing offenders access to that program. Our area stretches from the 49th parallel to the 60th parallel, so not only are we challenged in carrying the message of recovery over huge distances throughout the area, we also face the challenges of cultural and language barriers, especially in the North. We have a great area committee in place to face these challenges.—*Bob O'Reilly*

Texas (Northeast): Stretching from Abilene on the west Texas plains, to Longview, Tyler, and the piney woods to the east, with Waco to the south and Sherman, Wichita Falls and the Red River to the north, Area 65, Northeast Texas, is truly a diverse area with 29 districts, including five linguistic (Spanish-speaking) districts and 24 geographic districts. There are just under 500 groups, ranging from traditional once-a-week meetings in a church to large urban groups with 35-40 meetings per week. Our area covers over 70,000 square miles with the Dallas/Ft. Worth metroplex at its center. We are home to some 20,000 recovering alcoholics. We conduct four area assemblies per year, plus a service oriented convention in conjunction with our fall assembly. The winter assembly includes orientation and Conference theme workshops and our spring and summer assemblies focus primarily on the General Service Conference. The spring assembly includes mock committees with everyone participating to discuss the upcoming agenda. The summer assembly is primarily dedicated to the delegate's report on the Conference. Our eleven standing committee chairpersons work with their committees to provide information and support to the area groups and members, which include workshops, mini-conferences, and

presentations. The area also provides workshops based on the Conference theme and other requested A.A. topics throughout the area at districts and groups. We are fortunate to have strong leadership and active participation with our standing committee chairpersons and most of our district committee members. The principle of commitment is very strong. All work diligently with the delegate to help facilitate communications between the delegate and districts/groups and help to carry the message of our Three Legacies throughout the area. We continue to reach out to A.A. groups and districts that seem to fall below the radar and try to find out how we can be of service to them. Our goal is to have as many groups as possible to participate at all levels of service within the structure of A.A. I am grateful to have been given the gift of sobriety through Alcoholics Anonymous. It is a privilege to represent the Northeast Texas Area where service, participation and A.A. history is significant. Using our Traditions as the guiding principals and being mindful of why Alcoholics Anonymous needs to stay strong for the still-suffering alcoholic, I serve with gratitude, and pray that in my small role in the Conference process I am guided in the best interest of our Fellowship and A.A. as a whole.—*Jim Campbell*

Texas (Southeast): Area 67 encompasses the southeast portion of the state, covering about 30,000 square miles. We have 519 active groups, 61 of which are Spanish, divided into 13 English districts and four Spanish districts. There are three quarterly assemblies during the year in Houston and the fourth during our annual convention held in January, which rotates between Houston, Galveston, Beaumont and Bryan College Station. This year's Convention, held in Galveston, had the theme "The Fellowship You Crave." We also have a self-supporting annual Gratitude Dinner. Our C.F.C. committee hosts an annual multilingual C.F.C. conference. Our Multilingual committee stays busy helping with Spanish translations for our area, as well as regional events. Our Spanish districts want to get more involved in service and we are having service workshops to address this need and desire. We are also in the process of redistricting our Spanish districts to better serve the community and A.A. as a whole. Our biggest news is the result of two ad hoc committees: First, the Archives committee, with much dedication and commitment, has acquired a new office that is in a very suitable location, which will preserve, store and display the historical material of Area 67. We look forward to being in our new home. The second comes from our recently elected trusted servants on the IT committee, this committee has given us a secure webmail to use for area business; we are getting in the habit of using our new e-mail addresses now. All of this comes from hard-working ad hoc committee members, as someone stated at an assembly meeting; these are the best examples of Bill's description of "Alcoholics in Action." What a gift and an honor it is to serve Southeast Texas Area 67.—*Deborah De Bram*

Utah: I am honored and privileged to serve as the Panel 61, Area 69 delegate. Utah is a medium-sized state dominated by majestic red rock landscapes in the south and high rugged mountains in the north, that have some of the greatest snow on earth. Within this gorgeous landscape are over 330 active groups carrying our message of recovery. These alcoholics come from a wide variety of backgrounds, including Native American, Mormon settlers, and people from all over the world. We are strongly unified in our primary purpose, both in large groups with hundreds of members in our cities, and in small groups of three or four members in our isolated rural communities. These groups are divided into 11 geographic districts and one borderless, Spanish-speaking district. Our local

service structure mirrors the General Service Conference, employing nine standing committees that convene in three assemblies, three workshops, and two committee meetings annually. Active discussions by G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area standing chairs/officers, and all interested A.A.s during these committee meetings create an informed group consciousness with the Utah Area. A few years ago we established a vibrant and active Bridging the Gap program co-chaired by our treatment and correction area standing chairs. This BTG program organizes our local A.A. members as temporary sponsors to get these potential alcoholics from institutions to their first A.A. meetings within the critical 24 to 48 hours period after release. Our newly elected Pacific regional trustee, Rod B., is from Area 69 Utah. We are incredibly proud of this graceful member of our Fellowship. He is the first Native American elected as trustee to the General Service Board. He has asked all of us to be mindful about carrying our message to the Native American population; in this regard it is my personal goal to get the pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American" into all home groups through our area, region, and Fellowship. May we all walk in beauty as we pursue our happy, joyous and free lives in the Fellowship of the spirit.—*Keith Montgomery*

Virginia: Area 71 is comprised of over 39,594 square miles of the Commonwealth of Virginia and the Guantanamo Bay Naval Base in Cuba. We also have groups in West Virginia and North Carolina. Virginians are proud of their heritage and their place in history. During both the Revolutionary War and the Civil War there were significant battles within our borders. History buffs also know that both wars ended with surrenders at Yorktown and Appomattox, respectively. Our state is nicknamed the "Mother of Presidents," as eight U.S. Presidents were born here. We have large Military bases along with a large number of manufacturing and agricultural towns. We vacation in the beautiful Shenandoah National Park, at the Eastern Shore, in the Blue Ridge Mountains, on the Chesapeake Bay and at Virginia Beach. The area has 44 active districts that support 1,150 registered groups who hold over 2,400 meetings. We have 11 standing committees and seven special assignment coordinators. The Virginia Area Committee (the VAC) meets twice a year and the entire assembly meets twice a year to serve our area. Within our area, we have 13 intergroups who support multiple districts and one district that has two intergroups. We have had an Area Web site since 1999. The VAC sends out a newsletter to all groups three times a year, providing an opportunity for committees and districts to highlight their service activities. We have an archives office with a nonrotating archivist. We hold an annual State Convention, Archives Open House and Corrections Workshop. We are excited because in November, along with three other areas, we are hosting the First annual Southern States Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly in Fairfax, Virginia. It is an honor and a privilege to serve Alcoholics Anonymous as the delegate and to give back as much as I can to the Fellowship that has given me a life I never dreamed possible.—*Cindy French*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has over 1,400 groups spread throughout the 41 districts, two of which are Spanish-linguistic districts, which have 27 active groups participating at the District level. Our area geographically encompasses west of the Cascade Mountains to the Pacific Ocean and from the Canadian Border south to the Oregon Border. We have full district participation at our three quarterly meetings with our Area Committee. These meetings are where we discuss Area Business and prepare motions that will be presented to the G.S.R.s for our area assembly held in October. Our area holds six pre-Conferences in March to go over the agenda items that the delegate selects. The G.S.R.s give panel discussions on each agenda item and return to their groups with that information for their input. The G.S.R.s then return their input to the delegate so they can get a sense of their area. Our area holds six pre-assemblies in August to go over the motions that the G.S.R.s will be voting on at our area assembly in October. These pre-assemblies are similar to our pre-Conferences, with panel discussions by the G.S.R.s. Our Spanish-linguistic districts have recently formed a P.I. committee at the district level. They have taken their Spanish Big Books into the libraries in Snohomish County, as well as taking literature into the Sea Mar Treatment Center and attending Spanish-speaking A.A. meetings. They have also attended the area P.I. Committee for the first time in our area's history this past February. We have seven Area standing committees that hold quarterly meetings, as well as our newsletter. The Web committee and the Finance committee meet on a regular basis. I am honored to serve Area 72 as their 32nd delegate at the General Service Conference.—*Debbie Apple*

West Virginia: Area 73 has 296 groups registered with the General Service Office. We probably have an equal number of meetings that are not associated with any registered group. Area 73 encompasses the entire state of West Virginia with groups included from Ohio, Kentucky, Pennsylvania, Maryland and Virginia. We have 16 districts arranged into seven regions. We hold spring and fall assemblies and a summer convention. Both the assemblies and the convention rotate among the regions and typically each district has representation at each of these functions. Area 73 will hold an Additional Regional Forum in 2013 at the Charleston House, August 16–18. The sole purpose of Area 73 remains to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers. The area committee does this by providing literature and supporting the district with assistance in presenting workshops, working with professionals and the public as well as carrying the message into correctional and treatment facilities. Our Web site, www.aawv.org, maintains statewide meeting schedules, information on area events and much more. It is an honor and a privilege to be given the opportunity to serve Area 73 as delegate.—*Jim Seering*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 covers the southern half of the state of Wisconsin. We have 32 districts, including one Spanish linguistic district, over 1,000 registered groups and a membership of almost 20,000. We hold four all-day service assemblies, plus our annual spring conference assembly to share the delegate's report. Our conference is hosted by different districts and moves within the area. D.C.M. and G.S.R. attendance at area assemblies has improved, yet we continue to struggle with dark districts. We have adopted a procedure to reach out to these districts and offer assistance. We alternate with Area 74, Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan, to host a well-attended corrections workshop. We continue to be invited to a "re-entry fair" at a state correctional facility and we are working to connect with other facilities. Our young people host a lively annual A.A. convention. Our "A.A. at the VA" conference in Milwaukee has opened the door for presentations by our area C.P.C., P.I., and Treatment chairs to the VA medical staff. We hold an area inventory at our Fall Service Assembly in nonvoting years and our spirited round-table discussions of questions chosen by the assembly members have raised many an issue, but have also created positive ideas for change. We have active area standing committees and together we are committed to carrying A.A.'s message. It is truly an honor and a privilege to serve as Area 75's Panel 61 delegate.—*Nancy Horan*

■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee discussed a request from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to consider reducing the number of presentation/discussion topics planned for the 2012 General Service Conference and agreed to reduce the number of presentation/discussion topics to two for the 2012 General Service Conference.
- The committee considered a request that the trustee's Committee on the Conference meet annually with the Conference Committee on Agenda to address matters concerning the Conference agenda. Following a lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Conference meet/confer with the Conference Committee on Agenda prior to the winter Quarterly Board meeting to address matters concerning the Conference week agenda.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions, including a minor change to the Research Application Form and a new section, "Tools and Suggested Activities For Archives Committees," which will provide sharing and suggestions for Archives committees.
- The committee requested that the G.S.O. Archivist solicit new material and stories for the "Shared Experiences" section of the Archives Workbook, by contacting area archivists and area Archives Committee chairs via a memorandum, with a copy to area delegates, so that this section can be updated in a future printing of the Workbook. The committee also requested that the "Shared Experiences" section be updated every five years.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop an informational piece on basic archival preservation procedures intended to provide guidance to local archivists responsible for maintaining the physical and intellectual integrity of the collection.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee agreed that the concept of combining the A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community DVD with a compilation of C.P.C. literature would be very useful in C.P.C. service work. The committee requested the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore replacing the current A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community DVD with a new DVD compilation that includes the following existing material:
 - Table of contents
 - Introduction letter that includes references to aa.org and the resources available for professionals on the Web site

- "If You are a Professional ..."
- Information on Alcoholics Anonymous
- "A.A. Membership Survey"
- "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community"
- *About A.A.* — Newsletter for Professional (3-4 selected issues)
- "Is A.A. for Me?"
- A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community videos

The committee requested that the trustees bring back a report and draft product to the 2012 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.

- The committee discussed a draft sample letter to professionals on how they might use the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne and took no action.
- The committee reviewed a draft service piece regarding use of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in C.P.C. endeavors and suggested including the piece in the C.P.C. Kit with minor edits suggested by the committee.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That a list of goals and project suggestions for C.P.C. committees be added to the C.P.C. Workbook.
 - The committee reviewed the Fellowship sharing on formats for one-on-one contact with professionals. The committee requested that a summary of shared experience from C.P.C. committees and professionals for one-on-one C.P.C. contact with professionals be included in the C.P.C. Workbook.
 - The committee suggested adding two bullets on page 20 of the C.P.C. Workbook regarding suggested elements in C.P.C. letters:
 - Invitation to accompany professionals or students to open A.A. meetings.
 - Invitation to present on what A.A. is and is not.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on revising the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee particularly agreed with the suggestion already forwarded to the Publications Department to include content in the draft revision that would appeal to the young incarcerated alcoholic. The committee looks forward to seeing a full draft of the revised pamphlet at the 2012 General Service Conference, and encourages the Publications Department to consider a more standard pamphlet-sized format, if feasible, while still preserving the elements of the existing easy-to-read format.
- The committee discussed the possible need for a comprehensive survey of A.A. program activities in Correctional Facilities similar to the one conducted in 1990, and requested the trustees' Committee on Corrections explore the need for such a survey and report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Corrections.
- The committee reviewed the Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' Committee on Corrections regarding content. The committee requested that a process be established for updating the Workbook at each printing, which will ensure accurate references to items such as page numbers, A.A. publications, current terminology and statistical information. The committee also suggested that new Corrections chairs be informed that new A.A. material may be available that is not yet reflected in the current catalogue.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the Seventh Tradition stories received to date and encouraged that the collection process continue. The committee suggests that the trustees or office can use any stories received to date if the occasion arises.
- The committee discussed a request that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a Finance Workbook and felt a workbook was not necessary at this time as there is a wealth of information currently available.
- The committee discussed a request that the trustees' Finance Committee convert the Self-Support packet F-19 to a comprehensive Self-Support Kit. The committee requested that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a draft Self-Support Kit to be brought back to the 2012 Conference Finance Committee for review. The kit would include, but not be limited to:

- M-21 *I Am Responsible* wallet card
- M-23 *Final Conference Report* (current year)
- MG-15 A.A. Guidelines on Finance
- P-16 "The A.A. Group" pamphlet
- P-43 "Twelve Traditions Illustrated"
- P-44 "A.A.'s Legacy of Service"
- MS-20 Traditions Checklist from the A.A. Grapevine
- F-42 Self-Support Green Card
- FR-2 A.A. Group Contribution Envelope
- FR-5 A.A. Birthday Contribution Envelope & Birthday Plan Cover letter
- FV-19 Self-Support Packet — with updated flyers
- SMF-176 Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S.

- The Conference Finance Committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee prepare a simple document of Self-Support/Financial Talking Points to be used by the Fellowship, made available on G.S.O.'s Web site, in the G.S.R. and D.C.M. packets, and in the Self-Support Kit.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered permitting A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to accept contributions, limited to the same General Service Board contribution policy, to be used for operation expenses with excess funds continuing to be forwarded to the Reserve Fund and agreed to take no action. The committee noted that the current financial structure is appropriate.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook with appreciation.
- The committee discussed at length and agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2012 or later:
 - Working the Program (working title)
A collection of AA Grapevine stories on recovery from alcoholism
 - Happy, Joyous, and Free (working title)
A collection of AA Grapevine stories reflecting experience, strength, hope and humor
 - Young and New to AA (working title)
A collection about getting sober young from those who have done it

- In order to adhere to our spiritual principle of self-support, the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine suggests that the A.A. Grapevine Board only propose balanced operating budgets to the General Service Board.

- A single issue of Grapevine, La Viña and/or La Vigne magazine be included, with an introductory letter that offers AAGrapevine.org information, in the GSR packet for all new G.S.R.s. Format and costs are to be determined jointly by A.A. Grapevine and A.A.W.S.
- Encourage each home group to purchase a minimum of two annual subscriptions.
- The A.A. Grapevine Board look at distribution techniques of journals similar to the Grapevine, including La Vigne, as well as other General Service structure journals.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee accepted the reporting on the 2010 International Convention and noted that the financial results of the Convention showed a profit of \$844,545.
- The committee expressed appreciation to the 2010 International Convention coordinator, Rick Walker, for coordinating a successful event celebrating A.A.'s 75th anniversary in San Antonio, Texas. Gratitude was also expressed to the volunteers of the local Host Committee.
- The committee discussed the importance of Regional Forums and how Forums foster unity, enhance communication and provide a unique opportunity for local A.A.s to meet Board members, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff and trusted servants from the region. The committee noted that in 2010, over 1,500 first time Forums attendees were welcomed at Forums.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Forums and how areas communicate about upcoming Forums. The committee noted that flyers for upcoming Forums are being sent electronically from G.S.O. to delegates and D.C.M.s, and the information is accessible through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. In addition to announcements in local A.A. newsletters, bulletins, at assemblies and meetings, and local distribution of Forum Flyers, some local A.A. Web sites include the Forum Flyer or hyperlink to Forum information and registration on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report from the trustees' Literature Committee on the revision of the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services." The committee expressed appreciation for the work done by the trustees and provided several suggestions for the development of the pamphlet, and asked that a draft pamphlet or report be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for review.
- The committee reviewed the draft revisions to the *Living Sober* booklet forwarded by the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee expressed appreciation for the revisions suggested, and requested that the trustees' Literature Committee continue to review the booklet *Living Sober*, focusing on outdated language and/or practices, and provide a new revision to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration.
- The committee considered a request to develop an item similar to the Self-support card or "green card" to help promote the use of

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

our literature as a Twelfth Step tool and took no action. They noted that when an item to promote the use of A.A. literature as a Twelfth Step tool is needed, the language and format of this tool is generally best decided by each A.A. service committee or entity, based on their needs and experience.

- The committee considered the request to reconsider the 2010 Conference Advisory Action that “the trustees’ Literature Committee develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous,” and after thoughtful discussion agreed to take no action. The committee noted that the trustees’ Literature Committee’s report on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality clarifies that the pamphlet under development will reflect a wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members.
- The committee considered a request to develop a publication about the General Service Office and agreed to take no action at this time. The committee noted that Conference-approved materials describing the General Service Office are currently available.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee noted that Donald Sheets, the former Panel 61 delegate for Area 22, Northern Indiana, resigned. In February 2011 Ron Foor was elected as the new Panel 61 delegate for Area 22. Therefore, no recommendation from the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions was required in order to seat him as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference.
- The committee had lengthy discussion on a request to change the deadline for the submission of Conference Agenda items, and took no action. Acknowledging the challenge of communicating about agenda items within a short time frame, the committee noted that many delegates are taking advantage of current technology in order to facilitate timely distribution of background within their areas.
- The committee discussed a request that a formal relationship be developed between the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and the trustees’ Conference Committee to address matters of policy relating to the General Service Conference and took no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2010 Annual Report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site.
- The committee expressed support for the trustees’ Public Information Committee development of a comprehensive media plan.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. T.V. public service announcements and agreed with the trustees’ Public Information Committee’s report that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee suggested that “The A.A. Fact File” be revised and updated every three years.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee explore alternative packaging of the Public Information Kit and report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information including cost information.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2011-2012 Edition, and the 2011 General Service Conference Final Report.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions. The committee suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider adding examples to clarify what “other entities” refers to on page S74 in the last paragraph under FINANCIAL SUPPORT.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publications Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered the request to change the phrase “new kid on the block” with “a first year Delegate” on page S52 under Personal Experience in section “Preparing for the Conference” in *The A.A. Service Manual* and took no action. The committee agreed that this quote from a past delegate should not be altered and it adequately expresses the sentiment.
- The committee briefly discussed the A.A. Directories and noted that there were no requests for changes to the A.A. Directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee suggested that when the pamphlet for alcoholics with special needs is created, formats for alcoholics who are deaf, blind, or have learning challenges be produced as soon as fiscally possible.
- The committee requested that the term “treatment facilities” be replaced with a more appropriate reference such as “Treatment Committee,” “Treatment Committee Kit,” “A.A. Guidelines on Treatment Committees,” etc. wherever it appears in service material.
- The committee considered removing one line of dialog from the video “Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous” and took no action. The committee requested instead that the trustees’ Committee review the entire script of the video, taking into consideration concerns expressed by the Conference Committee, and return a progress report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee:
 - Expressed appreciation for the slimmer, less fragile, DVD case to be used for the videos in the Kits in place of the current DVD casings at no additional cost.
 - Suggested that the section on “Carrying the Message Into Noncorrectional Youth Facilities” in the Workbook be reviewed by the trustees’ Committee for appropriate emphasis on the safety of the A.A. members and the youths involved.
 - Reviewed the two suggested Bridging the Gap forms, one for A.A. members requesting a temporary contact to help them connect to A.A. on the outside, and one for A.A. members willing to serve as temporary contacts, and accepted them with minor editorial changes.

- Upon review of the Special Needs Kit and Workbook, the committee:

- Hoped that there will continue to be A.A. Grapevine issues that include stories from A.A. members with special needs.
- Expressed appreciation for the recent repricing of the American Sign Language (ASL) DVDs of the books *Alcoholics Anonymous* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and hopes that special needs formats will continue to be priced in accordance with their corresponding standard formats wherever fiscally possible.

TRUSTEES

- The committee requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee examine the impact of the Conference disapproving a recommended slate and bring a report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

GRAPEVINE

- After extensive review and discussion of the results of the surveys conducted per the 2010 Conference Advisory Action, the Committee recommended that, in order to encourage unity and to support A.A. Grapevine, Inc., the A.A. Grapevine Board establish an ad hoc committee to review and determine actionable items from the A.A. Grapevine Fellowship Sharing Report and that the ad hoc committee have a proportional representation similar to the General Service Conference and be chaired by the chair of the General Service Board.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the A.A. Preamble be added to the front inside pages of the Big Book and asked that the trustees' Literature Committee provide a report that includes sample placement options, and any other consideration, to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for review.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a request to "address and remedy the inconsistencies" between the Current Conference Charter and the Original Conference Charter—1955 as found in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee recommended acceptance of the un-footnoted editorial changes and updates that exist in the Current Conference Charter as found in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee recommended that the following 1988 Advisory Action be reaffirmed:

"The Conference Charter appear in its original 1955 form in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*, with General Service Conference Advisory Action amendments and editorial changes indicated by footnotes, followed by the current version of the Charter."

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that the General Service Board take action to improve communication and cooperation among all its Boards and bring a report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Trustees.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- To allow the committee secretary to have a laptop, projector and a screen in committee meetings. This would allow for real time editing of documents/ manuscripts that are agenda items. This would afford committee members to view changes as they make them to ensure the document is truly an accurate presentation of their work and enable a faster turnaround time in making the documents available to Conference members prior to presentation on the Conference floor. **(Not approved)**
- Reinstate the full slate of nine directors as constituted by the Grapevine Nominating Committee. **(Ruled out of order)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Conference not meet/confer with the Conference Committee on Agenda prior to the winter Quarterly Board Meeting until such time as an Advisory Action has been approved by the General Service Conference recommending that such a meeting/Conference occur. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- The "Current Conference Charter," (United States and Canada) as presented in Appendix C to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 2010-2011 edition, is hereby accepted as the current Conference Charter, and all changes to the original Charter contained therein are hereby ratified and confirmed. Footnotes to the Conference Charter as printed in *The A.A. Service Manual* are not part of the Conference Charter itself, and are included in *The A.A. Service Manual* for information purposes only. **(Not approved)**



The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2010 (with comparative totals for 2009)

	General Service Board of A.A.								
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2010	Consolidated 2009
ASSETS									
Cash	\$ 3,038,221	\$ 1,162,782		\$ 67,717		\$ 1,346,632	\$ 280,609	\$ 5,895,961	\$ 5,263,498
Accounts and interest receivable		59,434				197,400	66,232	323,066	434,989
Intercompany balances	(3,120,394)	(1,786,700)				3,127,860	1,779,234	-	-
Inventories									
Books, pamphlets, etc.						1,450,672	258,099	1,708,771	2,248,717
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.						338,432	2,300	340,732	26,967
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		12,432,911		1,300,406				13,733,317	13,897,192
Property and Equipment (net of accumulated depreciation - 2010 - \$4,433,144; 2009 - \$4,305,204) (Note 2)			\$ 714,969			355,793	19,213	1,089,975	1,139,178
Deferred charges and deposits	18,519					78,465	52,010	148,994	149,084
Prepaid conventions	120,667							120,667	720,200
Total Assets	57,013	11,868,427	714,969	1,368,123	\$ -	6,895,254	2,457,697	23,361,483	23,879,825
LIABILITIES									
Accounts and accruals payable						\$ 652,901	\$ 189,693	\$ 842,594	\$ 474,644
Deferred income									
- Orders and subscriptions, etc.	\$ -					19,926	1,920,317	1,940,243	1,977,208
- 2010 Convention								-	2,889,883
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 4,277,145				4,277,145	3,962,434
Accrued pension benefits					\$ 5,930,399			5,930,399	6,712,386
Total Liabilities	-	\$ -	\$ -	4,277,145	5,930,399	672,827	2,110,010	12,990,381	16,016,555
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	11,868,427	714,969	(2,909,022)	(5,930,399)	6,222,427	347,687	10,371,102	7,863,270
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	57,013	11,868,427	714,969	1,368,123	-	6,895,254	2,457,697	23,361,483	23,879,825

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Exhibit B

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2010 (with comparative totals for 2009)

	General Service Board of A.A.					A.A. Grapevine, Inc.			Consolidated 2010	Consolidated 2009
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	Pension Benefits	A.A. World Services, Inc.	Grapevine	La Viña		
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE										
Gross Sales						\$ 12,470,712	\$ 3,047,695	\$ 120,151	\$ 15,638,558	\$ 16,924,290
Less: Discounts						286,801	116,067	-	402,868	404,432
Net Sales						12,183,911	2,931,628	120,151	15,235,690	16,519,858
Cost of Literature Distributed										
Printing						(2,823,478)	(438,789)	(34,335)	(3,296,602)	(4,074,919)
Royalties on books						(38,812)	-	-	(38,812)	(58,803)
Direct shipping and warehousing						(1,457,751)	(712,010)	(34,494)	(2,204,255)	(2,315,745)
Gross Profit from Literature						7,863,870	1,780,829	51,322	9,696,021	10,070,391
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$ 6,408,421								6,408,421	6,296,110
2010 International Convention (Net of direct expenses of \$4,368,105) (Schedule 1)	844,545								844,545	-
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	555	\$ 132,518		\$ 121,093		559	38,800	-	293,525	187,409
Total Income	7,253,521	132,518		121,093		7,864,429	1,819,629	51,322	17,242,512	16,553,910
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)										
Program	5,455,178			-		2,608,776	1,352,915	126,803	9,543,672	9,620,607
Supporting services	3,186,934		\$ 89,371	63,711	\$ (824,875)	1,767,228	865,751	-	5,148,120	4,919,700
Total Expenses	8,642,112	-	89,371	63,711	(824,875)	4,376,004	2,218,666	126,803	14,691,792	14,540,307
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,388,591)	132,518	(89,371)	57,382	824,875	3,488,425	(399,037)	(75,481)	2,550,720	2,013,603
Change in pension liability - nonoperating	-	-	-	-	(42,888)	-	-	-	(42,888)	831,082
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS										
Pension liability	-	6,712,386	-	-	(6,712,386)	-	-	-	-	-
GSB La Viña support	(75,481)	-	-	-	-	-	-	75,481	-	-
Other Transfer	1,464,072	(188,000)	-	-	-	(1,864,072)	588,000	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	6,656,904	(89,371)	57,382	(5,930,399)	1,624,353	188,963	-	2,507,832	2,844,685
NET ASSETS										
Beginning of year	57,013	5,211,523	804,340	(2,966,404)	-	4,598,074	158,724	-	7,863,270	5,018,585
NET ASSETS										
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	11,868,427	714,969	(2,909,022)	(5,930,399)	6,222,427	347,687	-	10,371,102	7,863,270

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2010 (with comparative totals for 2009)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña Grapevine	Supporting Services	2010 Total	2009 Total
Salaries	\$ 668,064	\$ 892,331	\$ 177,771		\$ 104,937	\$ 129,957	\$ 1,321,923	\$ 545,462	\$ 88,996	\$ 2,194,908	\$ 6,124,349	\$ 5,989,722
Payroll taxes	51,449	66,090	13,882		8,846	8,411	97,414	47,278	7,008	172,394	472,772	467,488
Health and group insurance	94,880	121,931	25,612		15,960	15,521	179,722	116,414	7,739	486,736	1,064,515	1,056,017
Retirement expense - funding	238,709	305,622	64,197		40,117	38,015	450,477	115,636		740,342	1,993,115	2,003,984
Other program printing	247,616	63,590	69,943	10,295		29,111	344			-	420,899	397,143
Mailing labor	119,276	6,656	2,467			654	42			-	129,095	123,193
Postage and express	248,508	54,984	44,057	1,097		40,309	14,663	5,339	141	34,264	443,362	446,739
Writers' fees	15,650	8,094	3,680	2,948		1,989	3,460			-	35,821	136,006
Foreign literature assistance		93,672								-	93,672	114,472
Selling expenses							177,900	90,915	6,199	62,663	337,677	417,070
Professional fees		1,279					-		360	286,352	287,991	217,165
Contracted services	50,843	157,146	31,308	29,413	4,183	29,832	100,187	225,364	11,918	395,607	1,035,801	1,119,327
Occupancy	93,286	125,315	9,720		7,214	6,353	175,549	81,106		340,235	838,778	834,291
Telephone	15,996	17,586	2,736	455		1,810	14,133	24,449		70,878	148,043	124,290
Equipment maintenance	747	5,012	48		48	47	5,989			77,914	89,805	103,940
Furniture and equipment depreciation	32,151	20,348	2,941		1,773	3,875	39,274		952	59,788	161,102	137,301
Stationery and office supplies	79,274	4,158	7,489	5,682		3,310	4,757	50,476		72,677	227,823	208,106
Office service and expense	5,312	9,809	18,494	14,735	129	13,246	18,932	50,476	537	212,866	344,536	330,112
Travel, meals and accommodations	23	38,330	481,455	225,408		65,304	4,010		2,484	480,623	1,297,637	1,195,967
Bad debts									469	39,902	40,371	49,745
Delegate fees			(230,903)	(84,440)							(315,343)	(210,611)
Total Operating Expenses	1,961,784	1,991,953	724,897	205,593	183,207	387,744	2,608,776	1,352,915	126,803	5,728,149	15,271,821	15,261,467
Severance benefits										91,764	91,764	65,625
Postretirement health benefits										63,711	63,711	(275,261)
Retirement expense adjustment										(824,875)	(824,875)	(558,531)
Capital projects depreciation										89,371	89,371	47,007
Total Expenses	1,961,784	1,991,953	724,897	205,593	183,207	387,744	2,608,776	1,352,915	126,803	5,148,120	14,691,792	14,540,307
Allocation of supporting services to activities	904,492	918,401	334,218	94,790	84,469	178,771	1,767,228	865,751	-	(5,148,120)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,866,276	2,910,354	1,059,115	300,383	267,676	566,515	4,376,004	2,218,666	126,803	-	14,691,792	14,540,307
Services	\$2,866,276	\$2,910,354	\$1,059,115	\$300,383	\$267,676	\$566,515					\$ 7,970,319	\$ 7,996,977
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 4,376,004				4,376,004	4,475,347
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$2,218,666	\$126,803		2,345,469	2,067,983
											14,691,792	14,540,307
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2009	\$2,883,009	\$3,044,190	\$ 1,248,607	\$1,411	\$ 353,298	\$466,462	\$4,475,347	\$1,963,105	\$104,878	-	\$14,540,307	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2010
 (with comparative totals for 2009)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2010</u>	<u>2009</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 2,507,832	\$ 2,844,685
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(5,909)	183,213
Amortization of bond premiums	21,169	34,122
Depreciation	250,473	184,308
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	111,923	87,413
Inventories	226,181	397,269
Deferred charges and other assets	599,623	(390,228)
Accounts and accruals payable	367,950	(498,594)
Deferred income	(2,926,848)	2,922,091
Postretirement health benefits obligation	314,711	(3,534)
Accrued pension benefits	(781,987)	(1,389,613)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided By Operating Activities</u>	 <u>685,118</u>	 <u>4,371,132</u>
 FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(201,270)	(614,010)
Proceeds from sales of investments	6,008,570	11,251,521
Purchases of investments	(5,859,955)	(11,830,962)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used) By Investing Activities</u>	 <u>(52,655)</u>	 <u>(1,193,451)</u>
 Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	 632,463	 3,177,681
 Cash, beginning of year	 <u>5,263,498</u>	 <u>2,085,817</u>
 Cash, end of year	 <u><u>5,895,961</u></u>	 <u><u>5,263,498</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

■ Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 21, 2011

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015

Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2010 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2009 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 31, 2010, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2010 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming an opinion on the basic financial statements taken as a whole. The schedule of Direct Income and Expenses of the 75th Anniversary convention (Schedule 1) is presented for purposes of additional analysis and is not a required part of the basic financial statements. Such information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the basic financial statements and, in our opinion, is fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the basic financial statements taken as a whole.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2010

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-

profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. by-laws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND — This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND — This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND — A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$1,561,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND — A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND — This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unre-

stricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2010 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$3,030,367	\$ 89,371	\$2,315,397
Furniture	8 Years	741,260	10,311	724,319
Computers	3 to 5 Years	809,043	84,349	706,297
Software	5 Years	942,449	66,442	687,131
		<u>5,523,119</u>	<u>250,473</u>	<u>4,433,144</u>

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

The Corporations follow Accounting Standards Codification 820, Fair Value Measurements. It establishes a framework for measuring fair value, and expands disclosures about fair value measurements. Investments are now classified into one of three categories.

Level 1 — Quoted prices are available in active markets for identical investments as of the reporting date.

Level 2 — Pricing inputs are other than quoted prices in active markets, which are either directly or indirectly observable as of the reporting date, and the fair value is determined through the use of models or other valuation methodologies.

Level 3 — Pricing inputs are unobservable for the investment and include situations where there is little, if any, market activity for the investment.

All of the securities held by the Corporations at December 31, 2010 and 2009 have been valued at either Level 1 or Level 2.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity and certificates of deposit.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to assist in reaching the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50 % of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2010, investments were comprised as follows:

	Cost	Fair Value	Level 1	Level 2
Reserve Fund				
Certificate of deposits	\$6,533,398	\$6,533,398	\$6,533,398	\$ -
U.S. Treasury	5,711,045	5,899,513	5,899,513	-
Totals	<u>12,244,443</u>	<u>12,432,911</u>		
Postretirement Medical Fund				
Bond funds	446,927	454,195	-	454,195
Equity funds	815,141	846,211	-	846,211
	<u>1,262,068</u>	<u>1,300,406</u>		
Totals	<u>13,506,511</u>	<u>13,733,317</u>	<u>12,432,911</u>	<u>1,300,406</u>

Investment income for 2010 and 2009 is comprised of the following:

	2010	2009
Interest and dividends	\$ 308,639	\$ 387,933
Realized gains	36,623	(15,804)
Change in unrealized appreciation	(30,714)	(167,409)
Investment expenses	(21,023)	(17,311)
	<u>293,525</u>	<u>187,409</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including staff services, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present

and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Subsequent Events: In connection with the preparation of these consolidated financial statements, Management evaluated subsequent events after the balance sheet date of December 31, 2010 through March 21, 2011 which was the date the financial statements were able to be issued.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with ASC 715 which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, ASC 715 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under ASC 715 is recorded as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2010:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 16,156,825
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>22,087,224</u>
Funded status	<u>(5,930,399)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 5,930,399</u>
Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	5.75 %
Expected return on plan assets (based on expectations of future returns)	8.5 %
Rate of compensation increase	4.5 %
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$ 18,734,524
Benefit cost	860,125
Employers' contributions	1,685,000
Benefits paid	903,549
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 1,685,000
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(824,875)</u>
	<u>860,125</u>

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2011	\$ 1,067,834
2012	1,134,510
2013	1,189,125
2014	1,219,158
2015	1,330,424
2016 - 2020	7,604,683

The employers' contributions for 2011 are currently budget to be \$1,685,000.

Plan assets at December 31, 2010 were composed as follows:

Domestic Equity Mutual Funds	51.5 %
International Equity Mutual Funds	11.6 %
Bond Mutual Funds	29.4 %

Cash and equivalents	7.5 %
	<u>100.0 %</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2010, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$775,450 yearly office rental leases at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 2009 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2010 is \$6,200,000 as follows:

2011	\$ 775,000
2012	775,000
2013	775,000
2014	775,000
2015	775,000
2016 to 2018	<u>2,325,000</u>
	<u>6,200,000</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 5.75% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B.

Prior to 2006 the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2010:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$4,277,145
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 171,746</u>
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 486,457</u>
Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities	\$ 422,746
Postretirement Medical Fund	<u>63,711</u>
	<u>486,457</u>

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2011	\$ 182,051
2012	192,974
2013	204,552
2014	216,825
2015	229,835
2016 - 2020	1,373,340

Note 6 Tax Status: The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

Management has determined that the Corporations had no uncertain tax positions that would require financial statement recognition. The Corporations are no longer subject to audits by the applicable taxing jurisdictions for the periods prior to 2007.

The General Service Board of A.A. Inc.

Direct Income and Expenses of 75th Anniversary Convention

San Antonio, Texas, July 1st to 4th, 2010

INCOME

Registrations		\$5,096,437
Literature sales	\$172,165	
Less: Purchases and costs	<u>(47,609)</u>	124,556
Dormitory revenue	125,086	
Less: Direct costs	<u>(133,429)</u>	<u>(8,343)</u>
Total Income		<u>5,212,650</u>

EXPENSES

Convention consultants' fees and expenses	438,857
Public relations, legal and accounting fees	51,638
Stadium production	1,030,473
Entertainment	66,956
Printing, signs, supplies	127,037
Busing costs	939,693
Host committee expense	59,775
Registration expense	286,684
Simultaneous translation expense	115,551
Rentals (convention center, equipment, booths, etc)	650,570
Al-Anon	30,231
Pre-convention travel	38,148
Transportation, subsistence, hotels	131,599
Meals, insurance, telephone and sundry	400,893
Total Expenses	<u>4,368,105</u>
Excess of Income (Expense) (Exhibit B)	<u>844,545</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Office 2011 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2010 Budget	2010 Actual	2011 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$14,300,000	\$12,470,712	\$12,800,000
Discounts allowed	350,000	286,801	285,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	13,950,000	12,183,911	12,515,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,700,000	2,823,478	3,000,000
Royalties	70,000	38,812	38,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	10,180,000	9,321,621	9,477,000
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,727,150	1,457,751	1,529,200
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	8,452,850	7,863,870	7,947,800
Contributions Received	6,350,000	6,408,421	6,500,000
Interest Income	1,000	1,113	1,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	14,803,850	14,273,404	14,448,800
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	5,457,000	5,224,078	5,586,500
Payroll taxes	409,000	395,526	405,000
Insurance	962,500	881,198	979,100
Retirement expense	1,804,000	1,828,976	1,841,700
Other program printing	424,700	420,899	437,500
Mailing, labor, etc.	110,500	129,095	129,500
Postage & express	450,500	437,881	453,800
Writers' fees	66,500	35,821	36,550
Other literature assistance	174,000	93,672	100,000
Selling expenses	268,650	240,562	348,150
Professional fees	151,500	130,800	154,500
Contracted services	1,073,600	798,519	1,001,600
Occupancy	740,700	723,652	784,700
Telephone	97,810	111,446	111,450
Equipment maintenance	96,270	60,788	83,895
Furniture & equipment	157,000	153,952	164,700
Stationery & office expense	172,700	177,346	172,100
Office service & expense	317,525	274,990	293,775
Travel, meals, & accommodations	851,400	890,558	1,014,200
Bad debts	10,000	8,356	10,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	13,795,855	13,018,115	14,108,720
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	<u>\$1,007,995</u>	<u>\$1,255,289</u>	<u>\$340,080</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2011 BUDGET

	GRAPEVINE ENGLISH			LA VIÑA SPANISH		
	2010 Budget	2010 Actual	2011 Budget	2010 Budget	2010 Actual	2011 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>92,000</u>	<u>93,104</u>	<u>88,235</u>	<u>9,300</u>	<u>8,741</u>	<u>8,517</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$2,156,000	\$1,985,953	\$2,036,017	\$80,918	\$80,746	\$81,926
Single copies and back issues	107,155	41,008	42,379	12,584	10,812	10,813
Digital Archives Project subs	50,987	47,312	51,628			
Audio Grapevine	26,096	23,135	26,083			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>2,340,238</u>	<u>2,097,408</u>	<u>2,156,107</u>	<u>93,502</u>	<u>91,558</u>	<u>92,739</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>932,958</u>	<u>851,876</u>	<u>843,586</u>	<u>70,401</u>	<u>62,916</u>	<u>68,277</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,407,280</u>	<u>1,245,532</u>	<u>1,312,521</u>	<u>23,101</u>	<u>28,642</u>	<u>24,462</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	929,957	834,220	771,584	30,498	28,592	25,733
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>313,627</u>	<u>298,923</u>	<u>266,782</u>	<u>5,702</u>	<u>5,912</u>	<u>5,321</u>
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>616,330</u>	<u>535,297</u>	<u>504,802</u>	<u>24,796</u>	<u>22,680</u>	<u>20,412</u>
Total Gross Profit	<u>2,023,610</u>	<u>1,780,829</u>	<u>1,817,323</u>	<u>47,897</u>	<u>51,322</u>	<u>44,874</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	406,108	361,375	356,995	65,394	63,144	69,120
Payroll taxes and benefits	217,057	188,928	147,063	12,290	11,100	13,858
Occupancy costs	74,156	73,605	75,813			
Office supplies and expenses	31,372	32,071	28,033	271	537	537
Magazine Redesign						
Product development & Web	109,559	81,019	83,560			
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>838,252</u>	<u>736,998</u>	<u>691,464</u>	<u>77,955</u>	<u>74,781</u>	<u>83,515</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	442,350	449,900	367,341	23,400	25,852	30,200
Payroll taxes and benefits	240,709	221,027	214,349	2,907	3,647	8,825
Fulfillment	194,500	144,345	113,212	13,300	11,918	11,185
Occupancy costs	78,240	78,118	80,462			
Office supplies and expenses	70,408	68,881	65,947			
Selling expense-regular	176,604	79,610	140,289	15,175	6,199	19,605
- GvR program	17,800	11,305	19,600			
Postage	6,733	5,339	5,499	265	141	141
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>1,227,344</u>	<u>1,058,525</u>	<u>1,006,699</u>	<u>55,047</u>	<u>47,757</u>	<u>69,956</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Employee's Severance		91,764	39,152			
Computer Consulting	30,000	29,017	27,760			
Insurance	6,129	6,328	6,518			
Professional fees	81,900	156,832	60,000	285	360	300
Meetings and conferences	75,000	89,252	54,000	3,500	2,484	3,500
Furniture and equipment	6,669	6,199	21,500	180	952	1,800
Canadian exchange and other	18,966	2,670	4,000			
Bank service charges	11,614	9,535	19,000			
Bad debts	19,377	31,546	20,000	1,488	469	500
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>249,655</u>	<u>423,143</u>	<u>251,930</u>	<u>5,453</u>	<u>4,265</u>	<u>6,100</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>2,315,251</u>	<u>2,218,666</u>	<u>1,950,093</u>	<u>138,455</u>	<u>126,803</u>	<u>159,571</u>
Interest earned	45,900	38,800	38,800			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>(\$245,741)</u>	<u>(\$399,037)</u>	<u>(\$93,970)</u>	<u>(\$90,558)</u>	<u>(\$75,481)</u>	<u>(\$114,697)</u>

2010 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	439	214	48.7 %	\$45,318.50	8,919	\$5.07	1,009	500	221		\$47,048.77	\$5.28
2.	Alaska	188	94	50.0	\$19,623.86	3,022	6.49	2,491		544		\$22,658.84	\$7.50
3.	Arizona	1,066	451	42.2	\$107,014.85	24,504	4.37	4,156	75	3,490	180	\$114,915.92	\$4.69
4.	Arkansas	252	133	52.7	\$29,388.85	4,450	6.59	339		6,160		\$35,887.81	\$8.06
	California												
5.	Southern	1,252	383	30.5	\$92,957.25	44,373	2.08	10,691	3,040	2,380	2,251	\$111,319.52	\$2.51
6.	N. Coastal	1,926	1,134	58.8	\$273,791.67	57,551	4.76	13,723	3,000	2,905	855	\$294,275.05	\$5.11
7.	N. Interior	921	458	49.6	\$80,464.61	27,449	2.93	8,280	1,000	3,182	152	\$93,078.34	\$3.39
8.	San Diego/Imp.	964	417	43.2	\$80,426.64	27,625	2.91	6,745	350	1,250	70	\$88,841.37	\$3.22
9.	Mid-South.	1,938	780	40.2	\$160,791.63	60,578	2.65	9,841	714	3,179	518	\$175,043.07	\$2.89
10.	Colorado	805	444	55.2	\$116,586.97	18,786	6.20	10,135	144	27,061	445	\$154,372.49	\$8.22
11.	Connecticut	1,641	614	37.3	\$130,583.79	40,031	3.26	11,344	3,633	39,805	744	\$186,110.05	\$4.65
12.	Delaware	237	124	52.2	\$34,983.66	3,661	9.56	106	55	1,234	75	\$36,453.86	\$9.96
13.	D.C.	488	237	48.5	\$52,514.35	15,051	3.49	1,478	249	1,894	10	\$56,146.06	\$3.73
	Florida												
14.	North	968	439	45.3	\$89,775.39	19,625	4.56	5,023	50	17,599	150	\$112,597.67	\$5.74
15.	South/	1,865	884	47.4	\$179,045.31	39,604	4.52	12,430	3,009	57,469	143	\$252,096.29	\$6.37
16.	Georgia	732	456	62.3	\$105,863.89	17,828	5.94	3,730	253	30	198	\$110,074.59	\$6.17
17.	Hawaii	326	169	51.7	\$31,334.19	5,287	5.92	1,269		3,746		\$36,349.27	\$6.88
18.	Idaho	246	112	45.5	\$21,142.49	4,681	4.51	453	236	1,312	45	\$23,187.52	\$4.95
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,320	327	24.8	\$77,713.71	29,846	2.59	3,444		12,516	352	\$94,025.56	\$3.15
20.	North	1,146	494	43.1	\$65,621.22	22,551	2.90	5,535		20,347		\$91,503.13	\$4.06
21.	South	486	164	33.6	\$28,353.83	8,804	3.21	1,132	143	300	79	\$30,006.76	\$3.41
	Indiana												
22.	North	662	273	41.2	\$40,299.20	9,763	4.13	1,568	1,347	2,692	40	\$45,945.85	\$4.71
23.	South	680	308	45.3	\$40,396.29	12,321	3.28	569	100	250	120	\$41,435.29	\$3.36
24.	Iowa	659	301	45.7	\$52,795.24	13,897	3.79	1,374	250	100	115	\$54,634.24	\$3.93
25.	Kansas	406	172	42.4	\$38,230.52	10,060	3.79	402	2,325	6,443	20	\$47,420.48	\$4.71
26.	Kentucky	680	329	48.3	\$73,137.01	11,216	6.52	4,429	200	2,540	234	\$80,540.89	\$7.18
27.	Louisiana	526	180	34.1	\$41,634.78	10,591	3.92	1,204	200	20		\$43,058.28	\$4.07
28.	Maine	531	186	34.9	\$20,879.32	8,515	2.44	934	8,441		65	\$30,318.99	\$3.56
29.	Maryland	1,053	408	38.6	\$81,379.04	16,497	4.92	4,399	500	1,918	100	\$88,295.54	\$5.35
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,443	529	36.6	\$123,093.80	47,081	2.60	7,967	2,000	1,555	388	\$135,003.80	\$2.87
31.	West	306	176	57.4	\$23,252.88	5,241	4.43	713	-	1,333	20	\$25,319.17	\$4.83
	Michigan												
32.	Central	637	269	42.1	\$40,210.68	13,358	3.01	4,871	200	388	60	\$45,729.68	\$3.42
33.	Southeast	937	292	31.1	\$46,579.18	21,311	2.19	1,498	60	100		\$48,237.18	\$2.26
34.	West	609	218	35.7	\$40,372.70	12,715	3.17	1,587	285	3,272	150	\$45,666.70	\$3.59
	Minnesota												
35.	North	577	244	42.3	\$29,126.63	8,735	3.32	2,798	74	300		\$32,298.63	\$3.70
36.	South	1,132	448	39.6	\$90,834.84	27,251	3.33	1,409	43	7,960	116	\$100,363.19	\$3.68
37.	Mississippi	250	101	40.4	\$22,364.66	4,863	4.60	76	500	967		\$23,908.13	\$4.92
	Missouri												
38.	East	562	241	42.8	\$50,784.06	9,095	5.58	1,849		2,008	112	\$54,753.84	\$6.02
39.	West	249	125	50.1	\$22,925.13	7,163	3.20	339		1,127		\$24,391.15	\$3.41
40.	Montana	302	126	41.6	\$27,195.51	5,654	4.81	629		2,061		\$29,885.50	\$5.29
41.	Nebraska	716	308	42.9	\$47,649.40	16,256	2.92	2,538		811	22	\$51,020.17	\$3.14
42.	Nevada	578	188	32.5	\$38,661.69	14,080	2.74	1,986		1,263		\$41,910.25	\$2.98
43.	New Hampshire	607	275	45.3	\$37,744.93	11,033	3.42	2,247		3,234	66	\$43,292.75	\$3.92
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,325	555	41.9	\$121,800.53	33,009	3.68	14,015		7,671	93	\$143,579.08	\$4.35
45.	South	534	249	46.6	\$69,004.25	9,030	7.64	1,050	150	1,559		\$71,763.25	\$7.95
46.	New Mexico	419	191	45.5	\$33,158.55	7,193	4.60	2,418	52	1,883		\$37,511.55	\$5.22
	New York												
47.	Central	752	299	39.7	\$48,546.89	11,013	4.40	4,214	229	2,325	242	\$55,556.39	\$5.04
48.	H./M./B.	735	317	43.1	\$29,114.24	10,893	2.67	988		1,420	337	\$31,858.74	\$2.92
49.	Southeast	1,812	760	41.8	\$239,995.80	58,621	4.09	13,487	3,561		2,267	\$259,310.98	\$4.42
50.	West	364	103	28.2	\$18,244.71	5,827	3.12	306	1,350	2,780		\$22,681.06	\$3.89
51.	N. Carolina	1,071	563	52.5	\$120,279.09	18,571	6.47	10,069	3,025	3,766	80	\$137,219.02	\$7.39
52.	North Dakota	153	76	49.6	\$11,922.65	3,345	3.55	187		2,052		\$14,161.71	\$4.23
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	777	214	27.5	\$28,387.99	10,705	2.65	1,297	50	280	25	\$30,039.99	\$2.81
54.	Northeast	1,496	353	23.6	\$39,418.98	19,755	1.99	2,202	140	8,208	75	\$50,044.49	\$2.53
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	317	110	34.6	\$12,392.44	4,444	2.78	40	1,000	24		\$13,456.44	\$3.03
	Oklahoma												
56.	S.W. Ohio	582	257	44.1	\$42,846.90	10,688	4.00	3,320		1,001	50	\$47,218.26	\$4.42
57.	Oklahoma	384	194	50.4	\$36,515.03	7,771	4.69	852		643		\$38,009.59	\$4.89
58.	Oregon	1,080	408	37.8	\$86,677.94	21,100	4.10	1,943		4,925	360	\$93,905.94	\$4.45

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,547	775	50.1	\$170,887.35	32,667	5.22	4,530	50	6,011	196	\$181,673.65	\$5.56
60.	West	886	395	44.6	\$58,040.74	12,128	4.78	1,915		820		\$60,775.74	\$5.01
61.	Rhode Island	277	124	44.7	\$26,077.37	5,592	4.65	1,111		3,001		\$30,189.55	\$5.40
62.	South Carolina	361	213	58.9	\$48,678.64	8,921	5.45	1,631	500	9,983	35	\$60,827.90	\$6.82
63.	South Dakota	175	69	39.4	\$10,807.27	5,142	2.09	132	838			\$11,777.46	\$2.29
64.	Tennessee	560	254	45.3	\$48,798.84	12,415	3.93	6,912		70	235	\$56,015.84	\$4.51
Texas													
65.	Northeast	474	201	42.3	\$93,056.96	19,452	4.78	3,314		6,109	16	\$102,495.96	\$5.27
66.	Northwest	245	74	30.1	\$16,034.74	5,253	3.04	332	40	2,025		\$18,431.83	\$3.51
67.	Southeast	608	272	44.7	\$79,191.39	16,796	4.70	7,120	300	2,692		\$89,303.54	\$5.32
68.	Southwest	594	245	41.1	\$79,143.97	14,251	5.54	1,686	500	3,524	445	\$85,299.37	\$5.99
69.	Utah	328	157	47.8	\$31,168.16	6,431	4.85	475		1,250	40	\$32,933.16	\$5.12
70.	Vermont	292	129	44.1	\$19,291.22	5,042	3.83	3,335		579	50	\$23,254.72	\$4.61
71.	Virginia	1,331	705	52.9	\$125,685.02	24,195	5.18	11,931	75	2,914	559	\$141,163.62	\$5.83
72.	Western Washington	1,383	610	44.1	\$131,781.79	29,517	4.45	7,554	6,100	7,403	620	\$153,458.47	\$5.20
73.	West Virginia	321	145	45.2	\$13,291.07	3,506	3.79	272	332	900	15	\$14,810.07	\$4.22
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	708	262	37.0	\$31,199.25	10,501	2.96	858	65	849	10	\$32,981.06	\$3.14
75.	South	1,051	477	45.4	\$57,129.96	19,405	2.94	2,845	1,000	1,797		\$62,772.07	\$3.23
76.	Wyoming	121	58	47.9	\$11,482.70	2,143	5.35	626		520		\$12,628.45	\$5.89
77.	Puerto Rico	121	73	60.3	\$7,248.41	1,231	5.89	120		149	44	\$7,560.79	\$6.14
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	514	263	51.2	\$74,167.60	8,536	8.69	615		6,220	42	\$81,043.76	\$9.49
79.	B.C./Yukon	775	406	52.4	\$107,078.68	14,745	7.25	9,520	2,013			\$118,611.39	\$8.04
80.	Manitoba	159	44	27.7	\$9,412.23	3,972	2.37	10				\$9,422.12	\$2.37
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	194	99	50.9	\$16,645.86	3,456	4.82	104		822		\$17,571.58	\$5.08
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	243	110	45.3	\$22,483.43	3,187	7.05	125		3,351	100	\$26,058.73	\$8.18
Ontario													
83.	East	582	271	46.5	\$77,924.41	14,522	5.36	1,385	197	23,135	1,317	\$103,958.10	\$7.16
84.	Northeast	164	65	39.5	\$15,927.20	1,837	8.67	135		841		\$16,903.01	\$9.20
85.	Northwest	58	18	31.0	\$4,475.60	1,100	4.06	152		234		\$4,862.16	\$4.42
86.	West	588	258	43.9	\$70,929.74	11,392	6.23	151		25,251	132	\$96,463.73	\$8.47
Quebec (3)													
87.	Southwest	530	477 E	89.9	\$16,783.28	12,684	1.31	1,534	12,880			\$31,197.14	\$2.46
88.	Southeast	194	151	77.8	\$1,237.90	2,798	0.43	1,538		3,706		\$6,482.16	\$2.32
89.	Northeast	314	264	84.0	\$1,352.72	6,004	0.22	1,097		31,724	30	\$34,203.50	\$5.70
90.	Northwest	362	344 E	94.9	\$4,895.09	6,414	0.75	1,747	12,617			\$19,259.37	\$3.00
91.	Saskatchewan	291	128	44.0	\$25,151.23	3,370	7.46	752	10	7,571	222	\$33,706.41	\$10.00
92.	Washington East	430	211	49.1	\$32,897.30	5,413	6.07					\$32,897.30	\$6.08
93.	Central Calif	983	401	40.8	\$77,808.86	26,776	2.90	2,859	45	2,026	240	\$82,978.02	\$3.10
	Total U.S./	62,873	27,622	43.9	\$5,409,316.12	1,373,681	3.94	\$293,545.22	\$53,758.67	\$467,317.09	\$15,772.76	\$6,239,709.86	\$4.54
	Canada												
	Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				\$363,076.65								
	Specials				\$467,317.09								
	Total for U.S. & Canada				\$6,239,709.86								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
	On Line and Telephone Meetings				\$2,657.46							\$2,657.46	
	Correctional & Hospital facility groups				\$10.00							\$10.00	
	Foreign, WSM, other				\$163,612.62							\$163,612.62	
	Internationalists				\$495.00							\$495.00	
	Loners				\$700.60							\$700.60	
	Birds of a Feather				\$1,235.50							\$1,235.50	
	Grand Total				\$6,408,421.04							\$6,408,421.04	

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2010-2009 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC		
U.S. & Canada 2010	62,873	27,622	43.9%	\$5,409,315.12	1,373,681	\$3.94	\$4.54		
U.S. & Canada 2009	61,613	27,995	44.3%	\$5,377,714.72	1,358,879	\$3.96	\$4.50		
Increase (Decrease)	1,260	(373)	-0.4%	\$31,601.40	14,802	(\$0.02)	(\$0.04)	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	
								2010	2009
								\$6.29	\$6.46

(1) A Special contribution is one that comes from any number of entities that is not an AA Group. For example, a Conference, a Committee, an Area, a District, an Intergroup, etc.

(2) A Special Meeting is a meeting that does not want to be a group but does want to contribute to the General Service Board.

(3) Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas).

The Budget Highlights

2011 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office—A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation), the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2011 budget projects gross sales of \$12,800,000. Unit sales are expected to be slightly higher anticipating purchases from large buyers who may not have made significant purchases during 2010 as the result of their stocking up prior to the 2009 price increase. While reviewing and recommending the 2011 budget the A.A.W.S. Board considered that revenue and expense assumptions ultimately affect the long-term fiscal health of the General Service Board and its Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 6% higher than 2010 but still lower than the 2010 budget. While there may be some slight increases, our Publications department does not anticipate significant increases in paper or manufacturing costs. There will be additional costs based on anticipated additional sales. Royalties are budgeted at \$38,000 this year. There is only one remaining royalty recipient. Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 5% higher than the 2010 results but 11% less than the 2010 budget. We anticipate an increase in smaller shipments as well as possible increased shipping costs in the event that truckers begin to pass along fuel increase costs as they did several years ago.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$7,947,800 or 63.5%. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$84,000 greater than 2010. The 63.5% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2011 compares with 64.5% for 2010. It should be recognized that as we continue to strive to have literature available throughout our Service Structure in the Spanish and French, as well as English, lower print runs in non-English languages usually result in higher production costs. We strive to have the same selling prices regardless of the manufacturing cost, therefore lower gross profit margins for low volume items affect the overall gross profit percentages.

The table below reflects the Gross Profit Percentages from 2007 through the 2011 budget.

2007	2008	2009	2010	2011 Budget
56.8%	55.9%	61.1%	64.5%	63.5%

Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream so as to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions: Contribution revenue had shown positive movement for several years, however, 2008 and 2009 were down years. On a positive note, total contributions for 2010 were \$6,408,421, or \$58,400 greater than budgeted and \$112,300 greater than 2009. Perhaps we have turned a corner. For 2011 we have budgeted an increase of approximately 1%.

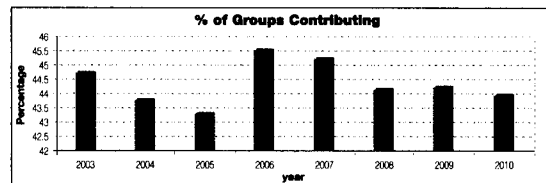
During 2010, contributions from groups and individuals (as distinguished from those received for the World Service Meeting literature efforts) of \$6,278,900 were \$63,900 (1%) greater than budget and \$115,900 (1.8%) greater than 2009. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund amounted to \$129,518, approximately \$4,000 less than 2009. Total contributions as noted above were just over \$6,408,400.

The chart produced below reflects the approximate percentage of the A.A. groups that choose to list with the General Service Office that have participated in the Seventh Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.

Total Operating Revenue for 2011 is anticipated at \$14,448,800, an increase of approximately \$175,400 due to a slight increase in sales and improved contributions.

Total Operating Expenses for 2011 have been budgeted at \$14,108,720, approximately \$1,090,000 or 8% greater than 2010 expenses and approximately two and three tenths percent greater than the 2010 budget.

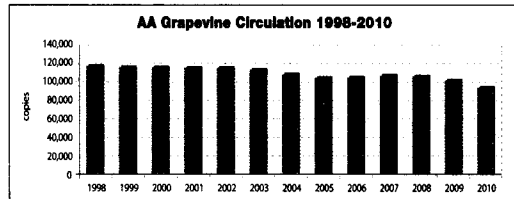
The 2011 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$340,080 and is at a level that is beginning to concern trusted servants at G.S.O. because excesses assist in maintaining the Reserve Fund. This compares with an excess of revenue of \$1,255,289 for 2010, \$1,273,500 for 2009, and a loss of \$275,000 for 2008.



2011 Grapevine Budget

The 2011 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation 88,235. This anticipates 3,765 fewer copies than the 2010 budget and approximately 4,869 copies less than the 2010 average paid circulation of 93,104. Circulation for the last several years is depicted in the chart below.

Income: Magazine income of \$2,156,107 is expected, \$58,699 greater than 2010. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$771,584, \$62,636 less than 2010.



Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,817,323 is budgeted for 2011. This compares with \$1,780,829 achieved for 2010 and the 2010 budget of \$2,023,610.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2011 are budgeted at \$1,950,093, \$268,573 less than the 2010 expenses of \$2,218,666 and \$365,158 less than the 2010 budget.

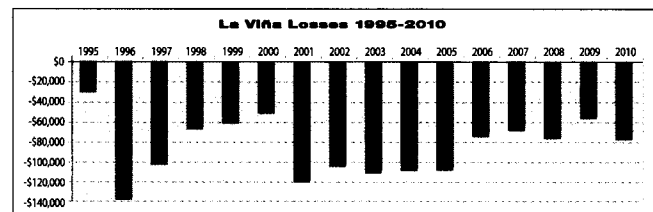
Net Income (loss): For 2011 the Grapevine anticipates a loss of \$93,970. This compares with a 2010 budgeted loss of \$245,741 and an actual loss from operations of \$399,037.

2011 La Viña Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards were to review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The General Service Board recommended, and the 2001 Conference approved, that the La Viña magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Service Boards General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2011 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$24,462 compared with \$28,642 achieved in 2010. Circulation for 2011 is estimated at 8,517 approximately 224 fewer than the 8,741 average for the year 2010 and 783 fewer than the 2010 budget. Other Publishing Income is estimated at \$25,733, which after deducting cost of product of \$5,321 expects to contribute \$20,412 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$159,571 for 2011, \$32,768 more than 2010. The 2011 budget projects a net loss of \$114,697, \$39,216 higher than the 2010 loss of \$75,481. You may recall 2010 Conference Actions that added costs to La Viña production.

The Chart below reflects the La Viña magazine losses since inception (1995). To date losses of approximately \$1,340,480 have been incurred.



2011 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Ricardo Castro
Linda Clough
Neil Faber
Estelle Falardeau
²Steve Hildeman
¹Mike Hopkins
Spencer Richie

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Jon Curphy
¹Deb Domack
Maureen Fordonski
Keith Montgomery
Bob O'Reilly
Mike Rogers
Mel Catherine
²Cate Wittig

Secretary: Mary Cumings

Corrections

Debbie Apple
²Suzette Cottrell
Bob Denihan
Mike Donnelly
¹Ino Fernandez
Don Fitzpatrick
Dennis Jaroslawski
Jean Martin

Secretary: Jim Malone

Finance

Nancy Bagley
Deborah DeBram
¹Joy Flynn
Guy Lafontaine
Ken Monson
Chris Shea
Ron Foor
²Allen Wharton

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Dean Bahr
Jean-Claude Cromier
Jennifer Davidson
Gerrie Dubien
Alan Hennesy
²Richard Purtell
Alicia Rosselot
Jim Seering
¹Jamie Shropshire

Secretary: Amber Eden

Literature

Byron Ford
Gerry Goulet
Nancy Horan
²Chip Kronoff
¹Patty Lavelly
Virginia Rogers
Jules Roussy
Loren Uhlenkott
Laura Vandivort

Secretary: Julio Espallat

Policy/Admissions

Don Autry
Tim Bryson
¹Gregory (Coop) Cooper
Darryl Dunphy
Marcus Filipovich
Susan Flynn
²Angela Heuer
Art Mohr
Cecilia Reid

Secretary: Rick Walker

Public Information

Richard Boisvert
²Joel Castellaw
Cindy French
Tom Kepner
¹Mel Lawson
Elaine McAndrews
Fariba Murray
Kevin Nangle
Steve Price

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Report and Charter

Louie Bellner
¹Char
²Chazz Collette
Angie Ellison
Kathy Gutierrez
Tashi Gonpo
Scott Huyghebaert
Tom Terry

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Treatment Facilities/ Special Needs-Accessibilities

Jim Campbell
Linda McDole
Glen Peden
Wayne Ross
Terry Spear
²Marsha Slane
¹David Thatch
Dean Thrasher
Melody Tolmie

*Secretary: Gayle Solheim
Riese*

Trustees

Leon Arps
Fred Crandel
Randy Hale
Sunny Hill
Hugh Hyatt
¹Anne Meader
²Ray Mengler
Ken Schmidt
Frank Ziemba

Secretary: Mary Dargan

³Archives

Ricardo Castro
Char
¹Linda Clough
Joy Flynn
Maureen Fordonski
²Ray Mengler
Bob O'Reilly
Mel Catherine

Secretary: Michelle Mirza

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Debbie Apple
¹Darryl Dunphy
Neil Faber
Don Fitzpatrick
Hugh Hyatt
²Virginia Rogers
Marsha Slane
David Thatch

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

2012 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson
Agenda	Ricardo Castro, Washington, DC
³ Archives	Maureen Fordonski, Iowa
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Keith Montgomery, Utah
Corrections	Debbie Apple, Western Washington
Finance	Chris Shea, Connecticut
Grapevine	Jennifer Davidson, North Carolina
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	Don Fitzpatrick, Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland Labrador
Literature	Laura Vandivort, Eastern Missouri
Policy/Admissions	Cecilia Reid, North Florida
Public Information	Cindy French, Virginia
Report and Charter	Tashi Gonpo, Colorado
Treatment	Wayne Ross, Northern New Jersey
Trustees	Randy Hale, Louisiana

Alternate

Neil Faber, North Dakota
Bob O'Reilly, Saskatchewan
Maureen Fordonski, Iowa
Dennis Jaroslawski, Alabama/NW Florida
Ken Monson, Northern Coastal California
Jim Seering, West Virginia
Hugh Hyatt, Eastern Pennsylvania

Byron Ford, Nevada
Marcus Filipovich, Southern California
Kevin Nangle, Eastern Massachusetts
Scott Huyghebaert, British Columbia/Yukon
Jim Campbell, Northeast Texas
Sunny Hill, Arkansas

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2011 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 61st General Service Conference.

2011 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Dorothy Hurley, *chairperson*
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Frances Brisbane
Donald Cusson
Joe Downey
Michele Grinberg
Nancy Haynes
Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

John Kane, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Ken Brueggemann
George Martin
El Nault
Don Meurer, *secretary*

Compensation

Don Miller, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
George Martin
Pam Reising
Don Meurer, *consultant*
Eugene O'Brien, *consultant*
Olga Mesonjnik, *secretary*

Conference

Vic Phillips, *chairperson*
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Rogelio Flores
Dorothy Hurley
Roberta Lindeman
Don Miller
El Nault
Bill Noonan
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities/ Special Needs-Accessibilities

Conley Byrd, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Rod Betonney
Frances Brisbane
Corliss Burke
Donald Cusson
Rogelio Flores
John Fromson
Albin Zezula
Mary Cumings,
secretary — C.P.C.
Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*
*— Treatment Facilities/
Special Needs-Accessibilities*

Corrections

Rogelio Flores, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Frances Brisbane
Donald Cusson
John Fromson
Bill Noonan
*Diane Olsen
Pam Reising
Jim Malone, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Terry Bedient, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Nancy Haynes
George Martin
Don Massey
El Nault
Bill Noonan
Vic Phillips
Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Jo-Anne Lowenberger, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Rod Betonney
Corliss Burke
John Fromson
Don Massey
Don Miller
Warren Stafford, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

El Nault, *chairperson*
Ken Brueggemann
Conley Byrd
Joe Downey
John Kane
Roberta Lindeman
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Don Miller
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Literature

Roberta Lindeman, *chairperson*
Andrea Barthwell
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Rob Betonney
Joe Downey
Michele Grinberg
Albin Zezula
Valerie O'Neill, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

Nominating

John Kane, *chairperson*
Terry Bedient
Conley Byrd
Dorothy Hurley
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Don Massey
Vic Phillips
Pam Reising
Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Public Information

Pam Reising, *chairperson*,
*Tom Becherer
Corliss Burke
*Darren Floyd
Michele Grinberg
Nancy Haines
John Kane
George Martin
Albin Zezula
Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Don Massey, *chairperson*
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Ward Ewing
First vice-chairperson
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Second vice-chairperson
Dorothy Hurley
Secretary
John Kane
Treasurer
Terry Bedient
Assistant secretary
Doug Richardson
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
is given on page 10



* Denotes appointed committee members

** Ward Ewing is an ex officio member on all committees; Phyllis Halliday is an ex officio on all committees except the Audit Committee, Compensation Committee and the Nominating Committee.

■ 2011 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Ward B. Ewing, D.D. (P.O. Box 6, Ten Mile, TN 37780) was elected chairman of the board in 2009, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he served as dean and president from 1998 until his retirement in 2010. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. He has been involved as a friend of A.A. since the mid-'70s.

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected Class A trustee and treasurer in May 2008. Currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York, his 30+ year career has included various executive positions, including hospital CEO. He has served on 12 nonprofit boards including the New York Lawyer Assistance Trust, which oversees substance abuse programs for attorneys and judges. Terry is a Fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and serves on the International, Nominating and Audit Committees.

Frances L. Brisbane, Ph.D. (53 Rustic Ave., Medford, NY 11763) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. A graduate of Columbia University School of Social Work, she received a doctorate in Organization Development from Union Graduate School and University, Cincinnati, Ohio. Frances is the author of five books and over 60 articles and has over 100 major presentations, nationally and internationally, on topics relating to substance abuse prevention and people of African ancestry. She is currently dean and professor, School of Social Welfare, S.U.N.Y. at Stony Brook, New York. Frances serves on Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, and Corrections Committees and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Corliss Burke, B.Ed. (11 Hayes Place, Whitehorse, Yukon Y1A 0E1) was elected a Class A trustee in 2009. During her 26 years in the addiction field, Corliss has worked as a counselor, trainer, director and Deputy Minister. Throughout this time, she has always been involved with Alcoholics Anonymous, attending open A.A. meetings in many countries and working to implement the Bridging the Gap program in Alberta and in the Yukon. Currently, her consulting business focuses on addictions program design and development, as well as on counselor training. Corliss serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities, Public Information, and International Committees.

The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores is now the Senior Judge on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara County in Santa Maria, California. He presides over various collaborative court calendars, including Drug Court and Mental Health Court, and is on the Board of Directors of the National Association of Drug Court Professionals. Rogelio chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities and Conference Committees.

John A. Fromson, M.D. (221 Winslow Rd., Waban, MA 02468) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. He is a graduate of New York Medical College and is a board certified addiction specialist. John is an associate director of postgraduate medical education, Dept. of Psychiatry, Massachusetts General Hospital, and teaches at Harvard Medical School. He is the author of many articles and lectures widely. John serves on the Corrections, International, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Michele Grinberg, J.D. (4111 Staunton Ave., SE, Charleston, WV 25304) was elected Class A trustee in April 2010. A 1985 graduate of West Virginia University College of Law, where she now teaches a legal writing course as an adjunct instructor. Michele is a practicing attorney with a concentration in health policy and medical staff relations. She is co-editor of *Women and the Law*. Michele serves on the Archives, Literature and Public Information Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Rod Betonney (6553 Elmcrest Dr., #13F, Salt Lake City UT 84107) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 47 delegate, Rod graduated from the Univ. of Utah with an MSW degree and currently works as a licensed clinical social worker in a substance abuse treatment program. He serves on the Literature, International and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

Kenneth Brueggemann (6111 Belvedere Blvd., Omaha, NE 68111-1274) was elected West Central regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 48 delegate, Ken looks forward to the time when he can return to his area and learn the role of elder statesman. When he served as area remote communities chair he was instrumental in having A.A. literature translated into Nuer for the Sudanese population, and for 28 years has worked with groups in prisons and jails. Having taught high school for 32 years, Ken continues to substitute teach. He chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Audit, Compensation, International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

***Conley F. Byrd, Jr.** (Box 3, 1506 S. Hwy. 365, Redfield, AR 72132) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 43 delegate, Conley is active in his group, district and area. A graduate of LSU School of Veterinary Medicine, he is owner and sole practitioner of a Veterinary Hospital. Conley chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Donald Cusson (520 Joseph-Guay, Terrebonne, Quebec J6W 4S9) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2010. A former Panel 54 delegate Don is active in his district and area and is owner of a pest control company. He serves on the Archives, Corrections and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees.

*Rotating at end of the 2011 Conference.

***Dorothy L. Hurley** (304 Donna Dr., Plymouth Meeting, PA 19462) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. Dorothy served as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board (2004-2007) and has been active in groups, general service, and intergroups in three areas. Dorothy is a university professor with a professional background that includes organization development, administration, and educational leadership. She chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Conference and Nominating Committees, and on the Grapevine Board.

***John J. Kane, Jr.** (549 Grant Ave., Collingswood, NJ 08107-1926) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 46 delegate, he served on committees in Area 45 and is an active sponsor. A mechanical engineer by profession he retired on December 31, 2009. John serves as secretary to the General Service Board, chairs both the Audit and Nominating Committees and also serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Public Information Committees.

Roberta S. Lindeman (3487 Long Drive, Minden, NV 89423) was elected general service trustee in April 2010. Roberta served as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board, 2006 to 2010. With a background in teaching, counseling, and school district administration, she currently owns an educational consulting firm. Roberta chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

***Jo-Anne Lowenberger** (303 Regal Ave., Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 2007. A Panel 52 delegate, Jo-Anne spearheaded the Canadian Archives Display for the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming in St. Louis. A present and active member in her area, Jo-Anne is always happy to participate, when asked, to do and be part of any service activity, and loves being with the Fellowship wherever that may take her. She retired in January 2009 after nearly 30 years as a department manager for an International food chain. Jo-Anne chairs the International Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

George G. Martin (209 East Liberty St., Milford, MI 48381) was elected general service trustee in April 2009, having previously served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. World Services Board. An attorney, his law practice primarily involves representation of nonprofit corporations in finance and business transactions. This year George has chaired the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Public Information, Finance & Budgetary, Audit and Compensation Committees.

Don Massey (3928 Uri St., Metairie, LA 70002) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2009. Don was a Panel 55 delegate from Area 27 (Louisiana) and today is an active sponsor who also facilitates group, district and other A.A. entities inventories. An attorney, Don has served as an adjunct professor, University of New Orleans and is an active member of various civic and legal organizations, including the Louisiana Lawyers Assistance Program, of which is presently chairperson. He chairs the Sharing Sessions and serves on the International, Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Don Miller (P.O. Box 270389, Louisville, CO 80027) was elected general service trustee in April 2009. Don, a Panel 49 delegate, served on the A.A. World Service Board as a nontrustee

director, 2003-2006. He is involved in project management and organizational development for new businesses. Don chairs the Compensation Committee and serves on the Conference, International and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Eleanor (El) W. Nault (588 Crowe Mountain Rd., Walhalla, SC 29691) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2009. A Panel 56 delegate, El remains active not only in her home group, but in many area and district service functions. El's professional background is in city and regional planning; she recently retired as a teacher and administrator of a four-year research university. El chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Audit, Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Victor Phillips (Suite 204, 516 Cedar Crescent SW, Calgary, AB T3C 2Y8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 54 delegate, Vic currently serves as a director on the A.A. World Services Board, attends service events in his region, and goes to several regular A.A. meetings per week wherever he travels. Vic's professional background is in finance and management. He chairs the Conference Committee and also serves on the Nominating and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Pamela Reising (31829 Sheridan Dr., Beverly Hills, MI 48025) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2009. A former Panel 45 delegate, Pam is now facilitator of her area's monthly G.S.R. orientation. Pam's background is in the criminal justice field and she teaches at a state university. She chairs the P.I. Committee and serves on the Corrections, Compensation, and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2011 Conference

Nancy Haynes (P.O. Box 151, St. Helena, CA 94574) was elected general service trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate, Nancy served as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Board. She is president and CEO of a coffee roasting company.

Barbara Kelly (752 Skyline Rd., RR #1, Oakwood, ON K0M 2M0) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2011. Barb was a Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Canada and remains active in her area, as well as in community affairs. Now retired, her most recent position was as mayor of Kawartha Lakes.

J. Gary Lutz (2210 13th St., Bethlehem, PA 18020) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2011. A Panel 55 delegate from Eastern Pennsylvania, J. Gary is a university professor of education, specializing in educational research methodology and currently serving as vice provost for Institutional Research.

Clayton Vandivort (316 S. Kings Highway, Sikeston, MO 63801) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2011. A former Panel 49 delegate from Eastern Missouri, Clayton is active in his area and region. He is an attorney in private practice.

A.A. World Services Directors

George Martin, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Roberta Lindeman, *general service trustee*
 Andrea Barthwell, *director*
 Bill Noonan, *director*
 Joe Downey, *director*
 Vic Phillips, *regional trustee*
 Phyllis Halliday, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Pam Reising, *regional trustee*
 Rick Walker, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Ken Brueggemann, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Nancy Haynes, *director*
 Ginger Rhoades Bell, *director*
 Dorothy Hurley, *general service trustee*
 Frances Brisbane, *Class A trustee*
 Don Miller, *general service trustee*
 Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 El Nault, *regional trustee*
 Albin Zezula, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Phyllis Halliday, *general manager*
 Mary Clare Lynch
 Doug Richardson, *director of staff services*
 Jim Malone
 Adrienne Brown
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Mary Cummings
 Eva Sanchez
 Mary Dargan
 Warren Stafford
 Julio Espallat
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Ami Brophy, *executive editor/publisher*
 Amber Eden, *managing editor*
 Irene Donoso, *La Viña editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish-language editor*
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennon, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Frank Lama, *GV circulation manager*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Renee Martin, *support services*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *archivist*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Valerie O'Neill, *publications director*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Joselin Pichardo, *GV asst. production editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Jason Seder, *artist, Conference Report*
 Frank Segui, *finance secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *controller*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *Conference staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Summer Edition Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Leonard Blumenthal
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 61st Conference includes Panel 60 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 61 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	61	Dennis Jaroslawski 1314 Stanford Rd. Dothan, AL 36503
Alaska	2	60	Loren Uhlenkott 2440 E. Tudor Rd. PMB 1115 Anchorage, AK 99507
Arizona	3	60	Suzette Cottrell 7315 W. Villa Rita Ave. Glendale, AZ 85308
Arkansas	4	61	Sunny (Sonya) Hill 12201 Teton Forest Dr. Little Rock, AR 72212
California Southern	5	61	Marcus Filipovich 1124 Fifth Ave. Venice, CA 90291
Central	93	61	Ken Schmidt 101 Palm Dr. Oxnard, CA 93030-4923
Northern Coastal	6	61	Ken Monson 98 Auburn Court Vacaville, CA 95688
Northern Interior	7	60	Melody Tolmie 9767 Deep Water Lane Stockton, CA 95219
San Diego/Imperial	8	60	Joel Castellaw 4239 Collwood Lane San Diego, CA 92115
Mid-Southern	9	60	Linda Clough 1873 Parkview Circle Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	61	Tashi (Gelong Tashi) Gonpo Box 108 Ward, CO 80481-0108
Connecticut	11	61	Christopher (Chris) Shea 917 Merwins Lane Fairfield, CT 06824
Delaware	12	60	Frank Ziernba 1 Lindsay Lane Ocean View, DE 19970
District of Columbia	13	61	Ricardo Castro 3510 Greenly St. Silver Spring, MD 20906
Florida North	14	61	Cecilia Reid 728 West Ave. Cocoa, FL 32927
S. Florida/Bahamas/ V.I./Antigua/St. Maarten/ Cayman Islands	15	61	*Kathy Gutierrez 8240 Linger Lodge Rd. Bradenton, FL 34202
Georgia	16	60	Patty Lavelly 202 Lee Blvd. Savannah, GA 31405
Hawaii	17	61	Linda McDole 454 Kuamoo St., #C Honolulu, HI 96815
Idaho	18	60	Angela Heuer 1381 Avon Lane Idaho Falls, ID 83401-3792

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	61	Terry Spear 412 N. Rodney Helena, MT 59601
<i>Chicago</i>	19	61	Michael (Mike) Hopkins 9057 S. Loomis Chicago, IL 60620	Nebraska	41	60	Leon Arps 410 N. 85th St. Omaha, NE 68114
<i>Northern</i>	20	60	Ray Mengler 13415 Rockton Trail Huntley, IL 60142	Nevada	42	61	Byron Ford 2091 Cotton Valley St. Henderson, NV 89052
<i>Southern</i>	21	61	Fariba Murray 102 Warner St. Bloomington, IL 61701	New Hampshire	43	60	Richard Purtell 6 Pete's Way Pelham, NH 03076
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	61	*Ronald (Ron) Foor 311 Island Dr. La Porte, IN 46350	<i>Northern</i>	44	61	Richard (Wayne) Ross 542 Charlestown Rd. Hampton, NJ 08827
<i>Southern</i>	23	60	Virginia Rogers 1708 Maynard St. Indianapolis, IN 46227	<i>Southern</i>	45	60	Elaine McAndrews 318 E. Third Ave. Runnemede, NJ 08078
Iowa	24	61	Maureen Fordonski 3705 Urbandale Ave. Des Moines, IA 50310	New Mexico	46	60	Marsha Slane Box 321 Cloudcroft, NM 88317
Kansas	25	60	Michael (Mike) Rogers 2849 N. Woodland St. Wichita, KS 67204-5159	New York			
Kentucky	26	60	Joy Flynn 236 Pindell Court Lexington, KY 40515	<i>Central</i>	47	61	Thomas (Tom) Terry Box 162 Harford, NY 13874-0162
Louisiana	27	61	Randy Hale Box 51701 Lafayette, LA 70505	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	60	Debra (Deb) Dornack 385 Dewitt Mills Rd. Kingston, NY 12401
Maine	28	60	Spencer Richie Box 502 Brunswick, ME 04011	<i>Southeast</i>	49	61	Susan Flynn 86 East 4th St., #9 New York, NY 10003
Maryland	29	60	Nancy Bagley 312 Landis Rd. Hagerstown, MD 21740	<i>Western</i>	50	60	**Michael (Mike) Donnelly 60 Commonwealth Ave. Lower Buffalo, NY 14216
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	61	Jennifer Davidson 1722 Orange St. Wilmington, NC 28403
<i>Eastern</i>	30	61	Kevin Nangle 59 Hawthorn St. Lowell, MA 01851	North Dakota	52	61	Neil Faber Box 1058 Stanley, ND 58784
<i>Western</i>	31	60	Charles (Chip) Kronoff 577 Suffield St. Agawam, MA 01001	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central/Southeast</i>	53	61	Glen Peden 2855 Pine Dr. Circleville, OH 43113
<i>Central</i>	32	61	Art Mohr Box 588 Howell, MI 48844	<i>Northeast</i>	54	61	Robert (Bob) Denihan Box 8 Orwell, OH 44076
<i>Southeast</i>	33	61	Fred Crandal 417 S. Huron St. Ypsilanti, MI 48197	<i>Northwest</i>	55	60	Louie Bellner 4435 May Dr. Maumee, OH 43537
<i>Western</i>	34	60	Melanie (Mel) Lawson 9769 Division Dr. Ceresco, MI 49033	<i>Southwest</i>	56	60	Alicia Rosselot 603 Terrace Ave. Cincinnati, OH 45220
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	61	Alan Hennessy 502 SW Sapp Circle Lawton, OK 73505
<i>Northern</i>	35	60	Jon Curphy 509 15th St. N Virginia, MN 55792	Oregon	58	60	Anne Meader 12460 Crisp Dr. Oregon City, OR 97045
<i>Southern</i>	36	61	Angela (Angie) Ellison 21900 Meadow Wood Ct. Jordan, MN 55352	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	60	Thomas (Tom) Kepner 105 Club Place Madison, MS 39110	<i>Eastern</i>	59	61	Hugh Hyatt 128 Bellwood Rd. Upper Holland, PA 19053
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	61	Jean Martin 3825 Wiestertown Rd. Export, PA 15632
<i>Eastern</i>	38	61	Laura Vandivort 1205 Fairfield Ave. Sikeston, MO 63801				
<i>Western</i>	39	61	Steve Price 9303 W. Farm Rd. 76 Willard, MO 65781				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	60	Gregory (Coop) Cooper 3363 Post Rd. South Kingstown, RI 02879
South Carolina	62	60	David Thatch 202 Atherton Way Greer, SC 29650
South Dakota	63	60	Dean Bahr 217 First Ave., #5 Ipswich, SD 57451
Tennessee	64	60	Donald (Don) Autry 2165 Night Shade Dr Germantown, TN 38139
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	61	Jim Campbell 1282 Antioch Dr. Rockwall, TX 75087
<i>Northwest</i>	66	60	Timothy (Tim) Bryson 4205 Crestgate Ave. Midland, TX 79707
<i>Southeast</i>	67	61	Deborah DeBram 1131 Chantilly Lane Houston, TX 77018
<i>Southwest</i>	68	60	Char 12601 Sandtrap Lane San Antonio, TX 78217
Utah	69	61	Keith Montgomery Box 147 Moab, UT 84532
Vermont	70	60	Charles (Chazz) Collette 675 Rt. 4A West Castleton, VT 05735
Virginia	71	61	Cynthia (Cindy) French 11735 Fairfax Woods Way 6201 Fairfax, VA 22030
Washington			
<i>State East</i>	92	60	Jamie Shropshire 3032 Mayfair Dr. Lewiston, ID 83501-4268
<i>Western</i>	72	61	Debbie Apple 8315 49th St. East Puyallup, WA 98371
West Virginia	73	61	Jim Seering 527 N. Highland Dr. Beckley, WV 25801
Wisconsin			
<i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	60	Steve Hildeman 2400 Palisades Dr. Appleton, WI 54915
<i>Southern</i>	75	61	Nancy Horan 268 Hartford Sq. Hartford, WI 53207-1973
Wyoming	76	60	Allen Wharton 811 E. 23rd St. Casper, WY 82601
Puerto Rico	77	60	Inocencio (Ino) Fernandez Box 9983 San Juan, PR 00908-9983

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	60	Darryl Dunphy 3912-23 Ave. SW Calgary, AB T3E 0J8
B.C./Yukon	79	61	Scott Huyghebaert 2169 Tranquille Rd. Kamloops, BC V2B 3M9
Manitoba	80	60	Catherine (Cate) Wittig 301 Wildwood Park Winnipeg, MB R3T OE5
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	60	Jean-Claude (Charlie) Cormier 24 Chemin Chartersville Dieppe, NB E1K 1K1
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	61	Don Fitzpatrick Box 130 Margaree Center, NS B0E 1Z0
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	61	*Mel Caterine 26 Wright Ave. Toronto, ON M6R 1K8
<i>Northeast</i>	84	61	Geraldine (Gerrie) Dubien 646 Bartleman St., #106 Timmins, ON P4N 4X4
<i>Northwest</i>	85	61	Gerry Goulet 350 Cornwall St. Thunder Bay, ON P7B 1T3
<i>Western</i>	86	60	Dean Thrasher 21-273 Elgin St. Brantford, ON N3S 5B2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	60	Jules Roussy 5, rue Marcel Dubé Blainville, PQ J7C 4W4
<i>Southeast</i>	88	61	Guy Lafontaine 2723 Rue Bernier Magog, PQ J1X OR3
<i>Northeast</i>	89	61	Estelle Falardeau 1743 Ave. Maufils Quebec, PQ G1J 4J3
<i>Northwest</i>	90	60	Richard Boisvert 409, rue du Rhone Lachenaie, PQ J6W 5M3
Saskatchewan	91	61	Robert (Bob) O'Reilly 1016 Rorison Ave. Moose Jaw, SK S6H 6W5

